

"十二五"普通高等教育本科国家级规划教材

NEW HORIZON COLLEGE ENGLISH

第四版 FOURTH EDITION

新视野大学英语

总主编：郑树棠

读写教程 2

READING AND WRITING

思政智慧版

外语教学与研究出版社



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前　言

党的二十大擘画了全面建成社会主义现代化强国、实现第二个百年奋斗目标的宏伟蓝图，指明了以中国式现代化全面推进中华民族伟大复兴的发展道路，从“实施科教兴国战略，强化现代化建设人才支撑”的高度，将教育、科技、人才进行统筹部署，并指出以高水平对外开放推动高质量发展，构建人类命运共同体。

面对新形势与新要求，我国高等教育必须全面贯彻党的教育方针，坚持为党育人、为国育才，全面提高人才培养质量，才能开拓教育新局面。作为高等教育的重要组成部分，大学外语教育应与时俱进，立足我国现代化发展全局，深化改革、探索创新，扎根中国、融通中外，为党和国家培养更多高层次国际化人才，讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音，为引领中国更好走向世界、世界更好了解中国作出新贡献。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材正是在这样的时代背景下设计编写而成。

《新视野大学英语》是一套根据国家高等教育教学质量要求和改革精神、针对全国普通高等院校非英语专业学生编写的通用英语教材。自 2001 年首次出版以来，以其独到的教学理念、创新的教学模式得到高校师生的广泛好评。为服务新时代国家战略发展需求，《新视野大学英语》编写团队认真学习最新政策文件，广泛收集教材使用反馈，持续进行系统的修订与完善。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）在继承原有特色的基础上，深入落实课程思政，全面优化教材设计，深度融合先进技术，进一步提升教材的思想性、科学性与时代性，体现我国高等外语教育发展的新趋势与新要求。

编写依据

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）以党的二十大精神为引领，以新时期高等外语教育改革和人才培养方向为指导，参照最新政策文件要求，通过先进的教学理念、科学的教学设计、数智化的教学手段，全方位支持大学英语教学，助推中国式教育现代化。

在教学目标上体现课程思政，落实立德树人根本任务

培养什么人、怎样培养人、为谁培养人是教育的根本问题。育人的根本在于立德。第四版教材全面贯彻党的教育方针，以落实立德树人根本任务为核心指导思想，深入践行《高等学校课程思政建设指导纲要》，内容设计寓价值塑造于知识传授和能力培养之中，致力于培养德智体美劳全面发展、堪当民族复兴大任的社会主义建设者和接班人。

在教学内容上实现工具性与人文性有机结合

第四版教材充分体现大学英语教育兼具工具性和人文性的特点，依据《大学英语教学指南（2020 版）》“基础目标”和“提高目标”的教学要求进行设计，有机衔接《普通高中英语课程标准》和《中国英语能力等级量表》。教材编写遵循语言学习规律，着力培养学生英语听、说、读、写、译等语言技能，全面提高语言综合应用能力。同时，通过主题丰富、视角多元、语料真实的选材以及生动多样的活动设计，帮助学生在探索世界的过程中传递中国声音，提高跨文化交际能力和思辨能力，实现综合发展。

在教学理念上体现“以教师为主导，以学生为主体”

第四版教材依据“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，结合当代大学生的心理特征、学习特点与教师的教学需求，设计讨论式、探究式、项目式等学习活动，提供科学实用、深入浅出的策略讲解。上述设计既有利于学生锤炼语言，提升能力，进行自主学习和合作学习，也便于教师灵活指导，有效组织教学，启发学生深度思考，使教学活动真正调动“教”和“学”的双向主动性与积极性。

在教学模式上依托先进技术重构数智教学新生态

第四版教材依托全新升级的“U 校园智慧教学云平台 3.0”（以下简称“U 校园 3.0”），为教、学、测、评、研提供一站式教学解决方案。通过科学智能的教学管理平台、高效便捷的备授课工具、丰富立体的教学资源与无缝对接的多终端支持，推动院校更新教学理念、创新教学模式、重构教学流程，加快数字化转型；帮助教师将课内课外、线上线下有机结合，优化教学流程，丰富教学设计，同步开展教学研究，实现教研相长。灵活多样的学习资源满足学生在多模态环境下的个性化学习需求，优化学习体验，实现智慧学习。

教材特色

价值引领，深化课程思政

教材从主题设定、素材选择和活动设计等方面入手，全方位融入党的二十大精神与社会主义核心价值观，弘扬正能量，深化爱国主义、集体主义、社会主义教育，将价值塑造、知识传授和能力培养融为一体，以润物无声的方式帮助学生提升政治觉悟、思想水平、道德修养，树立正确的世界观、人生观、价值观，成为担当民族复兴大任的时代新人。

选材丰富，彰显中国文化

话题选材强调经典性、时代性与趣味性的结合，使学生在学习语言的同时，开阔视野，了解世界，探索人与自我、人与社会、人与自然的关系。教材多维度彰显中国文化，将社会主义先进文化、革命文化和中华优秀传统文化有机融入到选材、练习活动与单元任务中；不同分册还专设特色板块，集中呈现中国相关内容，帮助学生坚定文化自信，厚植爱国情怀。

因材施教，促进全面发展

在对大学生英语水平和大学英语教学现状广泛调研的基础上，教材优化主题内容，合理调整难度梯度，满足不同水平学生需求，同时注重培养多元能力，系统提升练习活动的丰富性、应用性与思想性。一方面，遵循语言学习的内在规律，提高常用词汇的覆盖率与复现率，确保语言技能讲解与训练环环相扣，既提供单项技能训练，夯实基础语言能力，也设置综合语言运用活动，引导学以致用。另一方面，活动设计注重思维培养，通过批判性问题启发学生深度思考、进行跨文化反思，通过场景真实的产出任务培养学生讲好中国故事以及解决实际问题的能力。

数智创新，赋能智慧教学

教材充分体现信息化时代的最新技术变革，通过完善的服务体系、先进的数字平台、优质的线上资源，智能驱动外语教学创新模式、提质增效。U 校同 3.0 实现升级迭代，完善备课功能，实现教学课件、试题库与其他教学资源的有效融通；优化授课与测评功能，提供灵活多样的授课工具与智能测评手段，多维度收集学生学习数据，支持完善的全景化数据分析，实现教评研一体化发展。教材还配备数字课程、微课视频、随身学、“外研 U 词”小程序和伴学数字人等丰富的学习资源与工具，助力学生主动学习、个性化学习，创新学习模式，提升学习效果。

教材构成

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材包含 1—4 级，供两个学年使用。每一级别包含《读写教程》（配教师用书）、《视听说教程》（配教师用书）、《综合训练》和《长篇阅读》。教材提供教学管理平台、数字课程、微课视频、移动学习应用、教学课件、试题库等立体丰富的教学资源。不同课程、不同媒介资源之间紧密联系，互为补充，共同构建立体化、个性化教学环境。

《读写教程》以价值塑造为导向，以夯实语言基础为核心，提供角度多元、内涵丰富的选篇以及循序渐进的练习活动，在着重提高学生读、写、译能力的同时，坚定理想信念，锤炼思维品质。新增 Stories of China 板块，集中展现中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的成就，培养家国情怀，提升民族自豪感。

《视听说教程》改编自培生教育出版集团的经典教材 *Speakout*，视听资源生动地道，文化信息丰富，交际场景真实，帮助学生在轻松愉快的学习氛围中提升听说能力和跨文化交际能力。特别增设 Listening to China 板块，引导学生讲好中国故事，传播好中国声音。

《综合训练》与《读写教程》紧密相联，对标学业考试最新要求，提供相关词汇、语法、阅读、翻译和写作等方面的练习，形式多样、可操作性强，助力学生巩固语言知识，提高语言能力。

《长篇阅读》通过科学训练，帮助学生掌握阅读策略，提高在快速阅读中获取、理解关键信息的能力。每单元新增一篇中国选篇，引导学生在阅读中了解中国，在思考中融贯中西。

使用建议

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）遵循“分类指导、因材施教”的原则，设置不同级别与不同分册，配备丰富立体的教学资源，为各校教学提供广阔的选择空间。第四版教材的编写基于对全国高校大学生英语水平和大学英语教学情况的调研，起点词汇约为3200词。覆盖的词汇有大学通用英语阶段应该掌握的词汇，尤其是搭配能力强、词义多重、使用面广的词汇，也有与学生专业学习或未来工作密切相关的词汇。中学阶段已经学过的重要词汇在教材中也有复现和巩固，体现语言学习必要的重复和循环。

认真学习《新视野大学英语》（第四版）1—3级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“基础目标”教学要求；学习1—4级，能够达到通用英语阶段的“提高目标”教学要求。院校可根据人才培养目标、课程设置方案以及学生起点水平，对教材进行个性化选择和灵活搭配。教师也可根据不同的教学目标和课时情况，自主选择教学材料、教学方法和教学模式，落实有效教学。

编写团队

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）教材总主编为上海交通大学郑树棠教授。来自上海交通大学、同济大学、中国人民大学、西北工业大学、郑州大学等全国数十所高校的几十名专家学者和中青年骨干教师参与了系列教材的设计与编写。

自本世纪初第一版出版以来，《新视野大学英语》始终不忘初心，担当使命，服务国家战略需求与高校外语教育发展。《新视野大学英语》（第四版）诞生于全面建设社会主义现代化强国的关键时期，教材坚持正确政治方向，落实立德树人根本任务，体现思想性与科学性相统一，力争更好地服务新时代高校大学英语教学改革创新，为广大师生打开新思路、开启新视野。欢迎各位专家、教师和同学在审阅与使用教材的过程中，多提宝贵意见，以使教材不断更新与完善。

编写及使用说明

《读写教程》是《新视野大学英语》（第四版）系列教材的主干教材之一。本教程充分考虑新时期国家人才需求以及当代大学生的学习特点和兴趣，以《大学英语教学指南（2020版）》为指导，对接《中国英语能力等级量表》，充分融合先进信息技术，帮助学生在夯实语言综合运用能力的基础上，锤炼道德品质和思维能力，落实立德树人根本任务。

编写重点

本教程在秉承第三版教材特色的基础上，对原有内容结构进行全面优化和调整，篇幅上适当减少，质量上进一步提升，整体设计更贴近当前大学英语教学改革需求。本次编写重点如下：

融合课程思政要求，落实立德树人

教材全方位、多维度融入党的二十大精神和社会主义核心价值观等关键议题。单元开篇即点明单元蕴含的思政要素，提炼并阐述选篇蕴含的价值观念和精神内涵，如爱国、富强、敬业、和谐、友善等。同时，教材将价值塑造有机融于话题素材、练习设计、思辨论点、单元任务之中，在润物细无声中达到立德树人的目的。

凸显中华文化元素，充满时代气息

教材在保留原有优秀内容的基础上，新增多个全新话题与选篇，生动体现当今时代发展与文明进步，特别反映中国在经济、社会、文化、科技与生态文明建设等方面的最新成就。每册均有数篇课文与中国紧密相关，涉及航天成就、英雄人物、智慧城市、新时代青年等。每单元单设阅读板块 Stories of China，集中讲述中国故事，帮助学生增强文化自信，厚植家国情怀。

合理调整教材内容，设计循序渐进

根据语言难度和认知规律，重新编排各册话题与选篇，调整阅读、写作、构词等技巧讲解的顺序和详略程度，确保梯度呈螺旋式上升。同时，语言练习和单元任务设计等紧贴学习需求，注重搭建脚手架，在夯实语言基础的同时，引导学生举一反三、学以致用，提高语言综合应用能力。

技术深度赋能教学，创新教学模式

对教材内容、教学平台和资源进行一体化设计，打造纸质教材与数字产品深度融合的新形态。基于U校园3.0，实现线上教学管理、课堂互动、智能评测、大数据分析等功能，推动教学提质增效。数字课程突出思政育人与思辨培养，提供丰富的微课视频与相关练习，实现价值观培养与语言能力提升。“外研U词”小程序为学生提供移动单词学习工具，支持随时随地背单词，拓展学习空间，提升学习成就感。

单元结构

《读写教程》设置 1—4 级，每级包含 6 个单元。每单元内容围绕特定主题展开，层层深入。单元结构具体如下：



Quotation

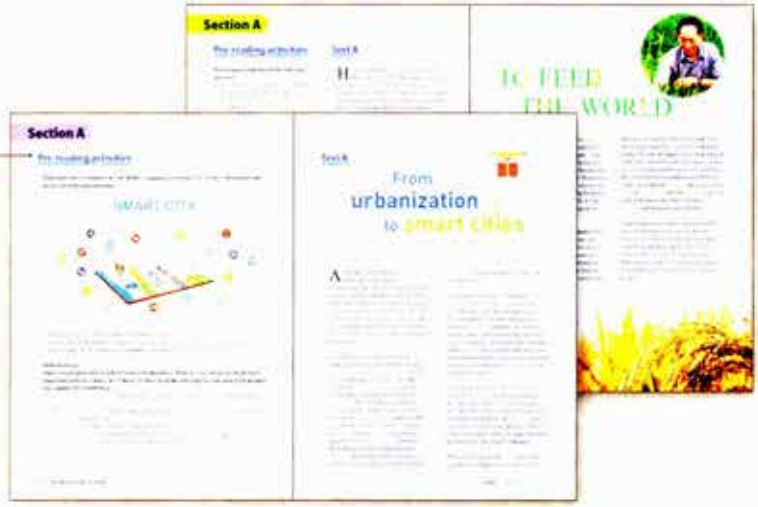
精选与单元主题相关的中外名言警句，凸显主题内涵。

Preview

由一段简洁生动的文字引出单元主题，点明单元蕴含的思政要素，同时以启发式的问题激发学生学习兴趣和深入思考。

Section A

单元主要学习板块，包括一篇课文（Text A）、写作技巧讲解和相关练习。



Pre-reading activities

通过听力理解、图片讨论、调研问卷、信息匹配等生动有趣的活动，引出文章主题和思政要素，激活知识储备，为深入学习文章做好铺垫。

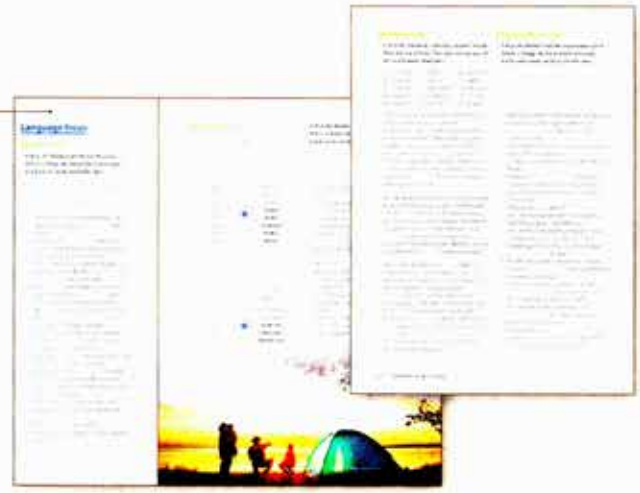


Reading comprehension

- Understanding the text 通过问答题的形式，剖析文章大意、重要细节以及作者写作手法、写作意图等深层信息，帮助学生由浅入深地领悟课文，全方位提高阅读理解能力。
- Critical thinking 围绕课文设置开放式问题，引导学生就主题内容和思政要素进行延伸讨论，培养探究能力和思辨能力。

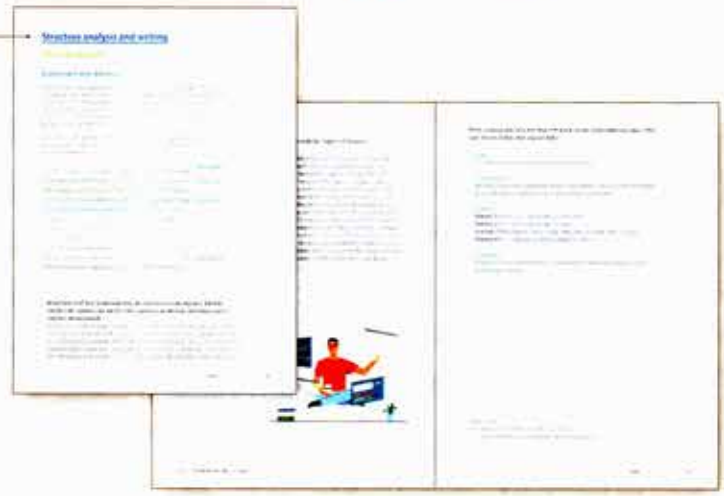
Language focus

包括 Words in use、Word building、Banked cloze 和 Expressions in use。从词、句、篇章入手，通过多样的语言练习加强学生对核心词汇的理解和运用，并提供词汇学习策略指导，帮助学生掌握构词法，扩展词汇量。



Structure analysis and writing

包括 Structure analysis（结构分析）和 Structured writing（基于结构分析的写作练习），两部分互为依托，相辅相成。结构分析以 Text A 为范例，分析典型段落或篇章的结构特点；写作练习基于结构分析，辅以提纲和范文，训练和培养学生完成段落或篇章写作的能力。



Section B

提供一篇课文（Text B），阅读技巧讲解和相关练习。

Reading skills

以 Text A 为实例详细阐述阅读技巧，并通过 Text B 落实应用，侧重培养阅读技巧和策略，讲练结合，有效提升阅读能力。



Reading comprehension

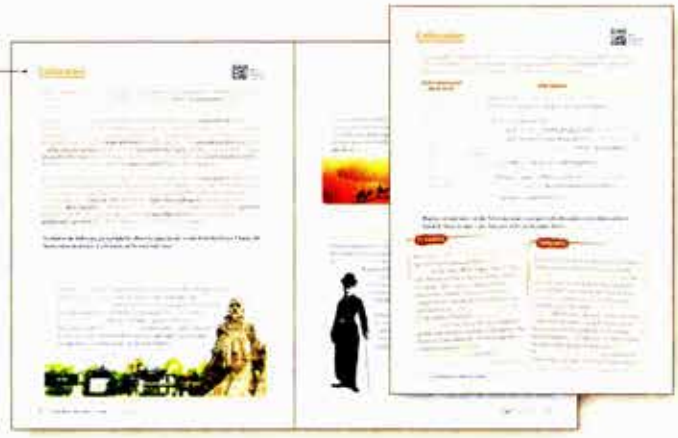
- Understanding the text 配合相关语言阅读能力测试，设置单项选择题，帮助学生对课文进行不同层次内容的理解。
- Critical thinking 同 Text A 相应部分。



Collocation

选取与主题相关的语篇素材，通过课文重点搭配讲解以及配套练习，帮助学生掌握核心、通用词汇的常用搭配，提高语言实际运用能力。

此外，学生可扫描二维码，在线上进行更多补充语言练习，加强对核心词汇、句型及语法点的训练。



Section C

集中呈现中国相关内容，包括一篇阅读短篇和一道翻译练习。

Stories of China

提供一篇中国内容的阅读短篇。题材生动时新、文本类型多样，既注重呈现新时代中国社会的发展成就和人民的精神风貌，如航空航天、清洁能源、乡村振兴等，也大力弘扬包括五四精神、京剧文化等在内的革命文化和中华优秀传统文化。学生可扫描二维码进行线上练习，领悟中国智慧，坚定文化自信。



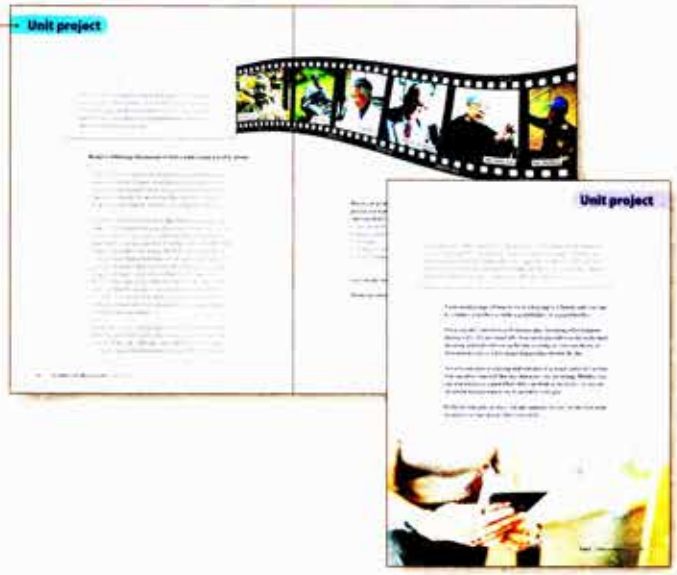
Translation

翻译内容聚焦中国文化。1—2级为句子翻译，各句之间主题相关，帮助学生提高对同类主题内容的翻译能力；3—4级为段落翻译，确保难度循序渐进，切实提高学生的翻译和文化沟通能力。



Unit project

依据单元主题，设计口头汇报、写作、短剧等形式多样的综合性语言任务，特别加大中国情境下的交际任务比重。基于真实的情境设计、清晰的步骤指导，引导学生通过调研、信息搜索、讨论等方式完成交际任务，在培养创新思维、沟通能力和合作意识的同时，提高讲好中国故事、传播好中国声音的能力。



数字课程

《新视野大学英语》（第四版）数字课程依托U校园3.0，将自主学习、课堂教学与数字技术深度结合。通过微课视频、补充练习等丰富的学习资源，以及在线交互式课件、智能评阅引擎等全新升级的教学工具，全方位提升学习体验和教学效果，支持师生合力打造智慧课堂，开展智慧教学。

打造优质微课视频，纸数深度融合

提供优质的微课视频，包括单元导学、思政讲解和思辨指导三类，与纸质教材有机结合、相互支持。通过形式活泼、内容实用的讲解以及练习，导入单元话题，解读思政育人元素，传递中华文化思想精髓，同时进行正向思辨指导，培养学生正确分析、评价信息与观点的思维能力。

提供全新教学工具，提升教学效果

教学云平台新增在线交互式课件，教师可直接编辑并生成个性化在线教学课件，教学课件与平台的课中互动功能深度融合，创设师生高效互动、便捷协作的智慧课堂。数字课程引入写作智能评阅引擎，丰富评价方式，帮助教师高效检查作业，掌握学习动态，提升教学效果。

拓展学习模式与内容，推动自主学习

打造伴随学生学习的专属数字人“子言”，创设数字人导学、伴学、促学模式，为学生自主学习提供全流程指导，增强沉浸式学习的体验感。同时，通过设置词汇卡学习、补充拓展练习活动、提供单元测试题目，延展学习内容，构建以学生为中心的语言学习环境，推动学生自主学习。

《新视野大学英语》系列教材一贯秉承“以教师为主导、以学生为主体”的教学理念，为广大师生提供高质量、体系化、多类型的数字教育资源与工具。各校教师可结合实际教学需求，有选择地使用相关资源或工具，开展混合式教学，实现线上线下融合互动，以此推动课堂教学模式更新，有效提升教学效果，落实课程思政建设。

以下为《读写教程》数字课程单元结构示意图，以及混合式教学模式使用建议，供各校教师在教学实践中参考：


线上
学生在U校园观看单元导学微课，提前熟悉单元内容，激发学习兴趣
Unit preview
单元导学微课
Section A
线上
学生在U校园完成读前导入练习、交互式课文和词汇学习，并通过思政讲解微课及配套练习，初步理解思政元素
教师可在后台查看学生自主学习数据，掌握预习情况，为课堂教学作准备
Reading the text
Pre-reading activities 读前导入练习
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Chinese view 思政讲解微课及练习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨指导微课及练习
线下
教师课上讲解、剖析Text A重难点，启发学生进行深入讨论。同时可结合微课讲解思政要素，进行思辨指导，并引导学生完成相关练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习
Language focus
教材配套语言练习
线上
学生在U校园学习结构分析讲解，完成写作任务，并通过写作智能评阅引擎，进行自动评分
教师可在后台查看智能评阅数据，了解学生写作的薄弱环节
Structure analysis and writing
Structure analysis 结构分析讲解
Structured writing 写作范文及练习
线下
教师课上进一步讲解结构分析及写作技巧，展示引擎评阅情况，并讲评学生作文
Section B
Reading skills
阅读技巧讲解与练习
线下
教师课上讲解阅读技巧，并引导学生完成练习
线上
学生在U校园完成交互式课文学习和词汇学习
Reading the text
Reading in detail 交互式课文学习
Vocabulary learning 词汇卡学习
Reading comprehension
Understanding the text 课文理解练习
Critical thinking 思辨练习
线下
教师课上组织学生完成Text B的理解练习和思辨练习
线上
学生在U校园完成语言练习和词汇搭配练习
Language focus
补充语言练习
Collocation
词汇搭配讲解与练习



编写团队

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《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 2》主编为郑树棠。参加编写的人员有郑树棠、蔡佩铃、刘忠喜、张海云、李维滨、贾再俊。

《新视野大学英语（第四版）读写教程 2》由郑树棠教授审定全稿。

Map of the book

Unit	Section A		Section B
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1 **Language in mission** *p2*	An impressive English lesson *p4*	Moving from paragraph to essay *p13*	Reading for the key ideas in sentences *p16*
2 **Exploring college majors** *p28*	The road to my major *p30*	Focusing on a narrative essay *p39*	Reading for major details *p42*
3 **The young generation: making a difference** *p54*	The young generation – the future of China *p57*	Focusing on an example essay *p65*	Predicting the author's ideas *p68*
4 **Mission and exploration of our time** *p80*	Huang Danian, a strategic scientist *p82*	Focusing on a comparison / contrast essay *p91*	Understanding figurative language *p94*
5 **Striving for financial health** *p106*	Spend or save – the student's dilemma *p108*	Focusing more on a comparison / contrast essay *p117*	Understanding denotation and connotation *p120*
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The humanities: out of date? *p44*	From a security guard to a university teacher *p51*	Writing a survey report on Chinese students' choice of majors *p53*
Understanding the young generation *p69*	Aiming to bring agriculture online *p77*	Presenting a talk show: Young people are making a difference in China *p79*
Journey through the body's senses *p95*	The May Fourth spirit alive in China *p103*	Writing a report on patriots in our society *p105*
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Unit 1

Language in mission

Not having heard something is not as good as having heard it; having heard it is not as good as having seen it; having seen it is not as good as knowing it; knowing it is not as good as putting it into practice.

— *Xunzi*

不闻不若闻之，闻之不若见之，见之不若知之，知之不若行之。

——《荀子》



Preview

English is a useful tool in communication, especially at the moment when China is deepening its reform and opening up. It can be used to **better present China to the world**. But learning English is never easy. Sometimes, the detailed work of understanding grammar and building vocabulary can be too overwhelming. Nevertheless, learning can happen dramatically with different strategies. An effective language teacher, for example, can maximize students' learning while motivated learners can enjoy what they are learning.

Listening to the father's "whoa!" toward his son, you'll feel grammar is such a wonderful thing to learn. Reading the story of Malcolm X, you'll know why learning English made him feel truly free while in prison. Anyway, studying with a curious mind and a "can do" attitude will make all the difference. What study plans will you make for your future success in learning English?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Listen to a talk about an English learner's learning experience. Then fill in the blanks based on what you hear.

Audio clip

1 Li Ming didn't do well in his English class because _____

_____.

2 His English teacher encouraged him to learn English well and use English to

_____

_____.

3 English can enable him to stay informed of the world's latest achievements and also help him _____

_____.

4 He changed his opinion and now he is happy because _____

_____.

2 Listen to the talk again and then share your own story of learning English in groups.

Text A



1 If I am the only parent who still corrects his child's English, then perhaps my son is right. To him, I am a **tedious** oddity: a father he is **obliged** to listen to and a man **absorbed** in the rules of grammar, which my son seems **allergic** to.

2 I think I got serious about this only recently when I ran into one of my former students, fresh from an **excursion** to Europe. "How was it?" I asked, full of **earnest** anticipation.

3 She nodded three or four times, searched the heavens for the right words, and then **exclaimed**, "It was, like, whoa!"

4 And that was it. The **civilization** of Greece and the glory of Roman **architecture** were **captured** in a **condensed** non-statement. My student's "whoa!" was **exceeded** only by my **distress**.



5 In the United States, there are many different stories about the **downturn** in the proper use of English. Surely, students should be able to **distinguish** between *their*, *there* and *they're* or the distinctive difference between ***complimentary*** and ***complementary***. However, they unfairly bear the **bulk** of the **criticism** for these knowledge **deficits** just because there is a public opinion that they should know better.

6 Students are not **dumb**, but they are being misled. For example, signs in **grocery stores** point them to the ***stationary***, even though the actual ***stationery*** items – pads, albums, and notebooks – are not nailed down. Friends and loved ones often **proclaim** they've just *ate* when, in fact, they've just *eaten*. Therefore, it doesn't make any sense to criticize our students.

7 In a sense, schools should be blamed for the **scandal** of this language deficit because they should have set high standards of English language **proficiency**. Instead, they only teach a little grammar and even less advanced vocabulary. **Moreover**, some teachers don't pay much attention to these **vital** structures of language because they also went without exposure to them. Schools fail to **adequately** teach the essential framework of language, **accurate** grammar and proper vocabulary, while they should take the responsibility of pushing the young onto the path of **competent** communication.

8 Since grammar is kind of boring to most of the young students, I think that it must be handled delicately, step by step. The chance came when one day I was driving with my son. As we set out on our trip, he noticed a bird in **jerky** flight and said, "It's flying so unsteady." I carefully asked, "My son, how is the bird flying?" "What's wrong? Did I say anything incorrectly?" he got lost. "Great! You said *incorrectly* instead of *incorrect*. We use adverbs to describe verbs. Therefore, it's flying so *unsteadily* but not so *unsteady*."

9 Curious about my correction, he asked me what an adverb was. Slowly, I said, "It's a word that tells you something about a verb." It led to his asking me what a verb was. I explained, "Verbs are action words; for example, Dad drives the truck. *Drive* is the verb because it's the thing Dad is doing."

10 He became attracted to the idea of action words, so we listed a few more: *fly*, *swim*, *dive*, *run*. Then, out of his own curiosity, he asked me if other words had names for their use and **functions**. This

led to a discussion of nouns, adjectives, and articles. Within the **span** of a 10-minute drive, he had learned to recognize the major parts of speech from **scratch**: verbs, adverbs, nouns, and adjectives. It was painless learning and great fun!

11 Perhaps, language should be looked upon as a road map and a valuable possession. Learners should often study the road map (check grammar) and **tune** up the car engine (**adjust** vocabulary). Learning grammar and a good vocabulary is just like driving with a road map in a well-conditioned car.

12 The road map provides guidance on your trip, but it won't tell you exactly what trees or flowers you will see, what kind of people you will encounter, or what types of feelings you will experience on your journey. Here, the vocabulary makes the journey's true colors come alive! A good vocabulary enables you to enjoy whatever you see as you drive along. Equipped with grammar and a good vocabulary, you have flexibility and excellent control. While the road map guides your journey to your **destination**, an excellent vehicle helps you to fully enjoy all of the sights, sounds, and experiences along the way.

13 Effective, **precise**, and beneficial communication depends upon grammar and a good vocabulary, the two essential **assets** in learning a language, but unfortunately, they are not fully taught in schools.

14 Just this morning, my son and I were eating breakfast when I attempted to add milk to my tea. "Dad," he said, "if I were you, I wouldn't do that. It's **sour**."

15 "Oh my!" I said, **swelling** with pride toward my son. "That's a grammatically perfect sentence. You used *were* instead of *was*."

16 "I know, I know," he said with a long agreeable sigh. "It's the **subjunctive** mood."

17 I was, like, whoa!

(*834 words*)

Culture notes

the civilization of Greece: Ancient Greece is considered the birthplace of Western democracy and the cradle of Western civilization, including literature, science, philosophy, drama, and architecture. The Olympic Games also originated there.

the glory of Roman architecture: Roman architecture continued the legacy left by Greek architects. The Romans also combined new construction techniques and materials with creative design to produce a whole range of brand-new architectural structures.

New words

▲ **tedious** /ˈtiːdiəs/ *a.* boring and continuing for too long 冗长乏味的

▲ **oblige** /əˈblaɪdʒ/ *vt.* (*fml.*) (*usu. passive*) make sb. feel that it is necessary to do sth. 迫使；使负有义务

▲ **absorb** /əbˈsɔːb/ *vt.*
1 interest sb. so much that they do not pay attention to other things 吸引（某人）；使全神贯注
2 take in liquid, gas, or another substance from the surface or space around sth. 吸收

absorbed /əbˈsɔːbd/ *a.* so interested or involved in sth. that you do not notice anything else 极感兴趣的；全神贯注的；专注的

allergic /əˈlɜːdʒɪk/ *a.*
1 (**be ~ to sth. / sb.**) (*infml.*) have a strong dislike of sth. or sb. 对…十分反感；厌恶
2 having an allergy 过敏的

▲ **excursion** /ɪkˈskɜːʃən/ *n.* [C] a short journey you take for pleasure 短途出行；远足

▲ **earnest** /ˈɜːnɪst/ *a.* very serious and sincere 非常认真的；真诚的

▲ **exclaim** /ɪkˈskleɪm/ *v.* say sth. suddenly and loudly because of surprise, anger, or excitement（由于惊讶、气愤或激动而）呼喊，惊叫

▲ **civilization** /ˌsɪvəlaɪˈzeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] a society that is well organized and developed, used esp. about a particular society in a particular place or at a particular time 文明（社会）

▲ **architecture** /ˈɑːkətektʃə/ *n.* [U] the style and design of a building or buildings 建筑风格；建筑设计

▲ **capture** /ˈkæptʃə/ *vt.* succeed in recording, showing, or describing a situation or feeling, using words or pictures（用文字或图片）记录，描述，捕捉

▲ **condense** /kənˈdens/ *vt.* make sth. that is spoken or written shorter, by not giving as much detail or using fewer words to give the same information 将（讲话或文章）压缩

condensed /kənˈdenst/ *a.* made shorter, usu. by including only the most important parts 压缩的

▲ **exceed** /ɪkˈsiːd/ *vt.* (*fml.*) be more than a particular number or amount 超过；超出

▲ **distress** /dɪˈstres/ *n.* [U] a feeling of extreme unhappiness 忧虑；苦恼；悲伤

downturn /ˈdaʊntɜːn/ *n.* [C, usu. sing.] a period or process in which business activity, production, etc. is reduced and conditions become worse（经济活动、生产等的）下降，衰退

▲ **distinguish** /dɪˈstɪŋgwɪʃ/ *v.* recognize the difference between things or people 区分；辨别

complimentary /ˌkɒmpləˈmentəri/ *a.*
1 given free to people 免费赠送的
2 saying that you admire sb. or sth. 赞美的；钦佩的

complementary /ˌkɒmpləˈmentəri/ *a.* complementary things go well together, although they are usu. different 互为补充的；互补的

▲ **bulk** /bʌlk/ *n.* (**the ~ of sth.**) the majority or largest part of sth.（某物的）大部分，多半

▲ **criticism** /ˈkrɪtɪsɪzəm/ *n.* [C, U] remarks that say what you think is bad about sb. or sth. 批评；批判；指责

▲ **deficit** /ˈdefɪsɪt/ *n.* [C]
1 a lack of a quality, skill, or ability that you should have（素质、技能或能力的）缺乏，不足
2 the amount by which sth. is less than you need or should have 赤字；亏损；逆差

注：标▲单词为四级词，未做标记单词为六级词，斜体单词为超纲词。

▲ **dumb** /dʌm/ *a.* (*infml.*) stupid 愚蠢的

grocery /ˈgrəʊsəri/ ***store*** *n.* [C] (*AmE*) a supermarket 超级市场

▲ **stationary** /ˈsteɪʃənəri/ *a.* standing still instead of moving 不（移）动的；静止的

stationery /ˈsteɪʃənəri/ *n.* [U] materials used for writing, such as paper, pens, and pencils 文具

▲ **proclaim** /prəˈkleɪm/ *vt.* (*fml.*) say publicly or officially that sth. important is true or exists 宣布；声明

▲ **scandal** /ˈskændl/ *n.*

1 [sing.] a situation that shocks you and makes you angry, esp. one that you think sb. in authority should change（尤指当局本应改变的）令人震惊的事，引起愤慨的事

2 [C] an event in which sb., esp. sb. important, behaves in a bad way that shocks people（尤指牵涉重要人物的）丑闻，丑事

▲ **proficiency** /prəˈfɪʃənsi/ *n.* [U] a good standard of ability and skill 熟练；精通

▲ **moreover** /mɔːrˈəʊvə/ *ad.* (*fml.*) in addition 而且；再者；此外

▲ **vital** /ˈvaɪtl/ *a.*

1 extremely important and necessary for sth. to succeed or exist 极其重要的；必不可少的

2 full of energy in a way that is exciting and attractive 生气勃勃的；充满活力的

▲ **adequately** /ˈædɪkwətli/ *ad.* in a way that is enough for a particular purpose 足够地；充分地；合乎需要地

▲ **accurate** /ˈækjərət/ *a.* correct and true in every detail 正确的；准确的

▲ **competent** /ˈkɒmpɪtənt/ *a.*

1 satisfactory but not esp. good 合格的，过得去的（但不见得特别好）

2 having enough skill or knowledge to do sth. to a satisfactory standard 合格的；能干的；胜任的

jerk /dʒɜːk/ *n.* [C] a sudden quick movement 猛的一动；猝然一动

jerky /ˈdʒɜːki/ *a.* moving roughly with many starts and stops（在行进中）不平稳的，颠簸的

▲ **function** /ˈfʌŋkʃən/

n. [C, U] the purpose that sth. has, or the job that sb. or sth. does（事物的）功能，作用；（某人的）职责

vi. work or operate in the correct or normal way 正常工作；正常运转

▲ **span** /spæn/ *n.* [C] a period of time between two dates or events（两个日期或事件之间的）时距，期间

▲ **scratch** /skrætʃ/ *n.*

1 (**from ~**) from a point where nothing has been done, so you have to do everything yourself 从零开始；从起点开始

2 [C] a thin mark or cut on the surface of sth. or on sb.'s skin（物件或皮肤上的）刮痕，划痕

▲ **tune** /tjuːn/ *vt.*

1 (*also* **~ up**) make small changes to an engine so that it works as well as possible 调整，调节（发动机，使达到最佳状态）

2 make small changes to a musical instrument so that it will produce the correct notes 为（乐器）调音，定弦

▲ **adjust** /əˈdʒʌst/

vt. change or move sth. slightly to improve it or make it more suitable for a particular purpose 调整；调节

v. gradually become familiar with a new situation（使）适应；（使）习惯

▲ **destination** /ˌdestəˈneɪʃən/ *n.* [C] the place that sb. or sth. is going to 目的地；终点

▲ **precise** /prɪˈsaɪs/ *a.* exact, clear, and correct 精确的；准确的

▲ **asset** /ˈæset/ *n.*

1 [C, usu. sing.] sth. or sb. that is useful because they help you succeed or deal with problems 有利条件；长处；有用的人

2 [C, usu. pl.] sth. valuable belonging to a person or organization which can be used for the payment of debts 资产；财产

▲ **sour** /saʊə/ *a.* having a sharp acid taste, like the taste of a lemon or a fruit that is not ready to be eaten 酸的

▲ **swell** /swel/ (**swelled**, **swollen**)

v. (**~ with pride / anger, etc.**) feel very proud, angry, etc. 洋洋得意 / 怒气冲冲等

vi. (*also* **~ up**) become larger and rounder than normal, used esp. about parts of the body （尤指身体部位的）肿，肿胀

subjunctive /səbˈdʒʌŋktɪv/

a. relating to a mood of a verb, used in some languages to express doubt, wishes, etc. （动词的）虚拟语气的

n. [C]（动词的）虚拟语气

Phrases and expressions

be / feel obliged to do sth. have to do sth. because the situation, the law, a duty, etc. makes it necessary（因形势、法律、义务等关系而）非做…不可，有责任做

get / be serious about become or be sincere about what you are saying, doing, or intending to do 对…是认真的；对…并非开玩笑的

run into sb. (*infml.*) meet sb. by chance 偶然遇见

fresh from having just come from a particular place or experience 刚从…来的；刚有…经历的

distinguish between recognize and understand the difference between two or more things or people 区分；辨别

nail sth. down

1 fasten sth. to sth. else with nails 把…钉住；将…钉牢

2 (*infml.*) reach a final and definite agreement or decision about sth. 最终确定；对…作出定论

get / feel / be lost be unable to understand sth. because it is new, difficult, complicated, etc. 弄不懂；困惑

become / be attracted to sth. become or be interested in sth. 对…有兴趣

out of curiosity because of curiosity 出于好奇

look upon … as consider sb. or sth. in a particular way, or as a particular thing 把…看作

be equipped with sth. be provided with the things that are needed for a particular kind of activity or work 以…为装备；配备有

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why did the son think that his father was a tedious oddity?
2 How do you understand the sentence "The civilization of Greece and the glory of Roman architecture were captured in a condensed non-statement" (Para. 4)?
3 Why does the author think that, in a sense, schools should be blamed for students' language deficits?
4 Why does the author say that the work of teaching grammar must be handled delicately?
5 What did the father teach the son while giving him a grammar lesson?
6 Why did the son feel curious about what his father said?
7 What are the two things that the author uses to describe grammar and vocabulary?
8 How do you understand the interjection "whoa!" said by the father at the end of the text?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Does English grammar help a lot in English learning? Why or why not?
2 In what ways can students learn English grammar more effectively?
3 How can students successfully enlarge their vocabulary?
4 What is the importance of learning English?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

adequately adjust asset competent condense deficit distinguish exceed precise proficiency

1 The guest speaker decided to _____ his speech in order to leave enough time for his audience to ask questions.
2 According to the media, China's wind power capacity has _____ the previous level considerably.
3 Researchers conducted a set of psychological tests to determine the negative consequences of a sleep _____.
4 In addition to a sense of sight, bees also have an unusual sense of smell, so they can _____ more than 10 similar flower odors.
5 Moving forward even in the face of great difficulties has become the most important _____ in my life and career.
6 The lawyer proclaimed that they couldn't jump to conclusions because acceptable conclusions must be _____ supported by evidence.
7 To help the employees become more communicative, the company offered several workshops to those who were not _____ in social interactions.
8 Some parents try to help solve the problems that their sons and daughters have in _____ to their college life.

9 China's series of _____ measures have proved to be effective for a steady economic recovery despite difficulties.
10 The Italian businessman spoke fluent Chinese and demonstrated his Chinese _____ at the World Expo held in Shanghai.

Word building

-al

与名词结合构成形容词。以这种方式构成的形容词通常用来描述与原名词相关的事物。有时，使用 -ial 代替 -al，特别是对于以 -er、-or 结尾的名词。

accident	>	accidental
clinic		clinical
grammar		grammatical
editor		**editorial**
manager		**managerial**
province		**provincial**
secretary		**secretarial**

-y

与动词结合，有时与形容词或名词结合而构成新名词。以这种方式构成的名词表示状态、行为或处所。

difficult	>	difficulty
discover		discovery
master		**mastery**
minister		**ministry**
recover		**recovery**
treasure		**treasury**

注：粗体单词为本单元新学派生词。

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

editorial managerial mastery
ministry provincial recovery
secretarial treasury

1 Careful and detailed planning, plus a strong _____ hand, was an essential element in the success of the book published last week.
2 In terms of health, we must not forget that _____ is brought about not by doctors but by patients themselves.
3 Leadership doesn't just mean having a(n) _____ position or being in charge of a team; more importantly, you need to have people skills.
4 Huangyan District of Taizhou City, over 200 kilometers from the _____ capital Hangzhou, is well known for its mold industry at home and abroad.
5 Several years after China launched the reform and opening up policy, local governments began to run schools under the guidance of the _____ of Education.
6 In my opinion, the _____ of anything, be it gaming or business, comes only from practice, no matter how gifted a person is.
7 According to the media, the U.S. Department of the _____ would most likely run out of cash if Congress fails to raise the debt limit.
8 The primary purpose of this position is to provide professional _____ services to the CEO to support their day-to-day work.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	absorbed	**F**	bulk	**K**	functions
B	abundant	**G**	distress	**L**	hidden
C	accurate	**H**	efficiently	**M**	obliged
D	adjusted	**I**	evidently	**N**	official
E	beneficial	**J**	fictions	**O**	written

The Internet has made learning English much easier. English learners used to be 1) _____ to spend their time in libraries looking for the books that would help them in their language learning. It was very inconvenient because a lot of materials were 2) _____ in numerous textbooks and readers. But today content on a variety of subjects is only a click away. This is especially 3) _____ for those who are serious about learning English.

In order to achieve fluency in English, you need to be comfortable using at least 10,000 words. The 4) _____ materials on the Internet make it possible for you to choose appropriate content to read and listen to. These materials can be 5) _____ to your level if you input some keywords in the search engine. But how can you remember the 6) _____ of unfamiliar words?

In this case, the Internet 7) _____ makes it easier for you to learn vocabulary. You can use online dictionaries to instantly find out the specific meanings and grammatical 8) _____ of new words. The Internet helps you 9) _____ build up your vocabulary based on lively and interesting language content, which greatly reduces the 10) _____ caused by your inability to remember the new words. The efficiency of this vocabulary learning is one of the reasons why the Internet has become an ideal place to learn the English language.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be allergic to be obliged to
become attracted to distinguish between
fresh from get lost get serious about
look upon … as run into

1 In Chinese culture, adult children are expected to take care of their aged parents, so they _____ contact or visit their parents regularly.
2 Most of the time, people don't really care about natural disasters and won't _____ avoiding them till they are personally affected by one.
3 When you _____ a friend that you haven't seen for a long time and have a good chat with him or her, you will surely be delighted.
4 While reading, we need to _____ facts and opinions in order to have a better and more accurate comprehension.
5 The growth of the food e-commerce sector in China has played an important role in promoting the sales of agricultural products _____ the fields.
6 If I don't like someone or something, I might just say I _____ them, even though it sounds a little rude.
7 When the topic was discussed, I quickly _____ because I am not good at things like math and analytical skills.
8 It is hoped that some companies will _____ this small old town to invest and build factories.
9 The Tang Dynasty is _____ a golden age in Chinese history, when Chinese culture spread across much of Asia.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Moving from paragraph to essay

Starting from this book, you are moving from paragraph writing to short essay writing. Precisely, you will learn how to write a short essay composed of 3-5 paragraphs, with no less than 120 words. An essay has three main parts: introduction, body, and conclusion.

Introduction: The introduction introduces the topic of an essay and usually contains a thesis statement. A thesis statement is a complete sentence that presents your opinion, attitude, or position about the essay topic. The way to introduce the topic should be as interesting as possible. You can start the introduction with a dramatic incident, a famous quote, a thought-provoking question, or a general statement to interest or attract your reader.

Body: The body is the main part of an essay. It may consist of several paragraphs, each of which usually has a topic sentence at the beginning. Each body paragraph should address a specific point related to the thesis statement. You can develop ideas by way of examples, cause and effect, comparison and contrast, classification, narration, description, or argumentation.

Conclusion: To write an effective conclusion, you can either restate the thesis statement using a different structure and vocabulary or briefly summarize the main idea discussed in the essay. Use transitional words at the beginning of the conclusion to signal that you're wrapping up the essay. The common ones are *in conclusion*, *in summary*, *in short*, or *to summarize*. Don't forget to add your final thoughts and opinions, such as a suggestion, a prediction, or a warning at the end.

Now, let's take a look at the structure of the text "An impressive English lesson".

Introduction	Body	Conclusion
Brings out the topic and the thesis statement of the text: Students unfairly bear the bulk of the criticism for their knowledge deficits in grammar and vocabulary because there is a public opinion that they should know better. (Paras. 1-5)	Claims that students shouldn't be blamed for their language deficits, supported with examples, reasons, and the demonstration of how grammar can be effectively taught. (Paras. 6-10) Emphasizes the importance of learning grammar and vocabulary in a figurative way: Learning English is just like holding a road map in a well-tuned car. (Paras. 11-13)	Wraps up the text through an anecdote where he praised his son for a job well done on grammar, which echoes the controlling idea in the thesis statement: Students are unfairly blamed. (Paras. 14-17)

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how the introduction, body, and conclusion are developed.

Topic
Learning English grammar

Introduction
Thesis statement: It is really fun and helpful to learn English grammar.

Body
Example 1: Adding a comma could make an entire difference in meaning.
Example 2: A grammar mistake could make a world of difference in meaning.

Conclusion
How enjoyable and beneficial it is to learn English grammar.

During my middle school years, I was allergic to English grammar. However, the two incidents I experienced later changed my view completely. I no longer think grammar is dull and useless. In fact, it is really fun and helpful to learn English grammar.

It occurred while I was absorbed in the stories we were asked to read. My English teacher wrote two sentences on the blackboard: 1) *The king would wear no clothes which could make him appear different from others*; 2) *The king would wear no clothes, which could make him appear different from others*. Glancing at the two sentences, I thought the teacher must have made a mistake because these two sentences were the same. Suddenly, the class burst into loud laughter. Only then did I realize that adding a comma makes a big difference in meaning: dressed vs. undressed.

Not long after, another interesting thing happened to me. One day, after the English teacher returned our homework, I was surprised to see he had crossed out *-ly* in the sentence "I studied English hardly". "Isn't *hardly* an adverb?" I asked myself. Later, of course, I figured out what was wrong: an overgeneralization! I had assumed that an adverb ended with *-ly* would always have the same meaning as the adjective. Not till then did I find out that *hardly* means "almost not", so what I had written was a world of difference from what I wanted to say.

In conclusion, what I experienced tells me how enjoyable and beneficial it is to learn English grammar. I would say English grammar is truly a mysterious world of art, without which we can hardly learn English well.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

English grammar, a headache to me

Introduction

Thesis statement: English grammar is a big headache to me.

Body

Example: The difference between *used to* and *be used to*

Conclusion

Learning English grammar is tough for me.

More topics

- Learning English through imitation / repetition
- Learning English with / without grammar

Section B

Reading skills

Reading for the key ideas in sentences

Although a sentence may give a great deal of information, it usually offers just one key idea. You should be able to find key ideas in order to understand the sentences more clearly. You may ask the following questions to get the key ideas in different sentences.

1 Who or what is the sentence about?
2 What is the person or object doing, or what is happening to the person or object?
3 Why and how is the person or object doing this or that?
4 When and where is something happening to the person or object?

Many words in a sentence describe things about the subject of the sentence but they merely add details to it. If you ask *when*, *how*, *where*, or *why*, you will easily find the details, which also helps you see the key idea.

Here is one example from Text A.

To him, I am a tedious oddity: a father he is obliged to listen to and a man absorbed in the rules of grammar, which my son seems allergic to. (Para. 1)

Key idea: What the father is like in the eyes of his son.

Why is this the key idea of the sentence? First of all, the sentence is about the father, which answers the question of "who". Then all the details about the father are told through the eyes of his son: a tedious oddity, a father he has to listen to, and a man absorbed in grammar. The whole sentence tells us how the son would portray his father.

Of course, you cannot always easily decide which details are simply descriptive and which add to the key idea. However, the starting point for determining the key idea in a sentence is to find who or what the sentence is about, and what the person or object is doing or what is happening to them.

1 Read the following sentences from Text B and write the key idea of each sentence.

Example To speed up his language learning scheme, he skipped all the words he didn't know and then would end up with no clue as to what the book was about. (Para. 3)
Key idea: He couldn't understand what the book was about.

1 As an adult, when he tried to inform people about his new beliefs, he found that he didn't have the adequate communication skills he needed. (Para. 2)

_____

_____

2 He told us of his amazement at how closely related the words seemed – how *moist* could be the root of *moisture*, and how *advisable* and *advisory* had the same root! (Para. 5)

_____

_____

3 Malcolm X depicted how, the next morning when he woke up, he kept thinking about the words he had copied and read aloud and about the acquisition of the knowledge he was pursuing. (Para. 6)

_____

_____

4 With every succeeding page he copied and read aloud, Malcolm X found he was learning and remembering more and more words. (Para. 7)

_____

_____

5 He had left behind the narrow, ignorant world of his youth to join the world community of thoughts and actions ever since he started with his great journey of learning in prison. (Para. 10)

_____

_____

Text B

The great journey

1 Malcolm X was an African-American civil rights activist, writer, and speaker. Born in 1925, he was **mysteriously assassinated** in 1965. By the time of his death, his own telling of his life story, *The **Autobiography** of Malcolm X*, had been widely known. He was born Malcolm Little into a poor **household**. Later, he took the name Malcolm X after joining a religious organization.

2 Malcolm X learned about the organization while in prison for **committing** criminal acts such as theft. Because he was poorly educated, he felt inadequate to teach his new beliefs to others. As a young man, he could **sketch** his thoughts with poor grammar and little vocabulary using the simple, **unsophisticated** language of people on the street. As an adult, when he tried to inform people about his new beliefs, he found that he didn't have the adequate communication skills he needed. In his own words, he "wasn't even functional".

3 In a **bid** to increase his knowledge and improve his skills, **desperate** Malcolm X **devised** a **scheme**. He turned to books, believing this would be beneficial. However, when he tried to read serious books on his own, he was distressed as he didn't know most of the words. To speed up his language learning scheme, he skipped all the words he didn't know and then would end up with no **clue** as to what the book was about. "I became **frustrated**," Malcolm X wrote in his autobiography, speaking of his inadequate language skills.

4 Malcolm X's considerable frustration at his inability to read and write **launched** him on a **quest** to overcome his deficiencies. He said, "I saw that the best thing I could do was get hold of a dictionary – to study, to learn some words." And he was also lucky enough to reason that he should try to improve his handwriting. "It was sad. I couldn't even write in a straight line," he told us. These ideas together moved him to **appeal** to the prison authorities for some paper and pencils.

5 For the first two days, Malcolm X just **skimmed** through the pages of the dictionary, trying to **negotiate** his way through its unfamiliar **format**. He told us of his amazement at how closely related the words seemed – how ***moist*** could be the root of *moisture*, and how ***advisable*** and ***advisory*** had the same root! "I didn't know which words I needed to learn," he said. "Finally, just to start some kind of action, I began copying." In his



of learning

slow, careful, and **crude** handwriting, Malcolm X copied everything on the first full page of the dictionary into a notebook. He even copied the **quotation marks**! This took him one full day. After that, he read everything he had written aloud. "Over and over, aloud, to myself, I read my own handwriting," Malcolm **recalled**. He also **logged** important things that happened every day. Repetition helped move him from basic **literacy** toward true proficiency.

6 Malcolm X **depicted** how, the next morning when he woke up, he kept thinking about the words he had copied and read aloud and about the **acquisition** of the knowledge he was pursuing. It was a **marvellous** feeling. He felt immensely proud.

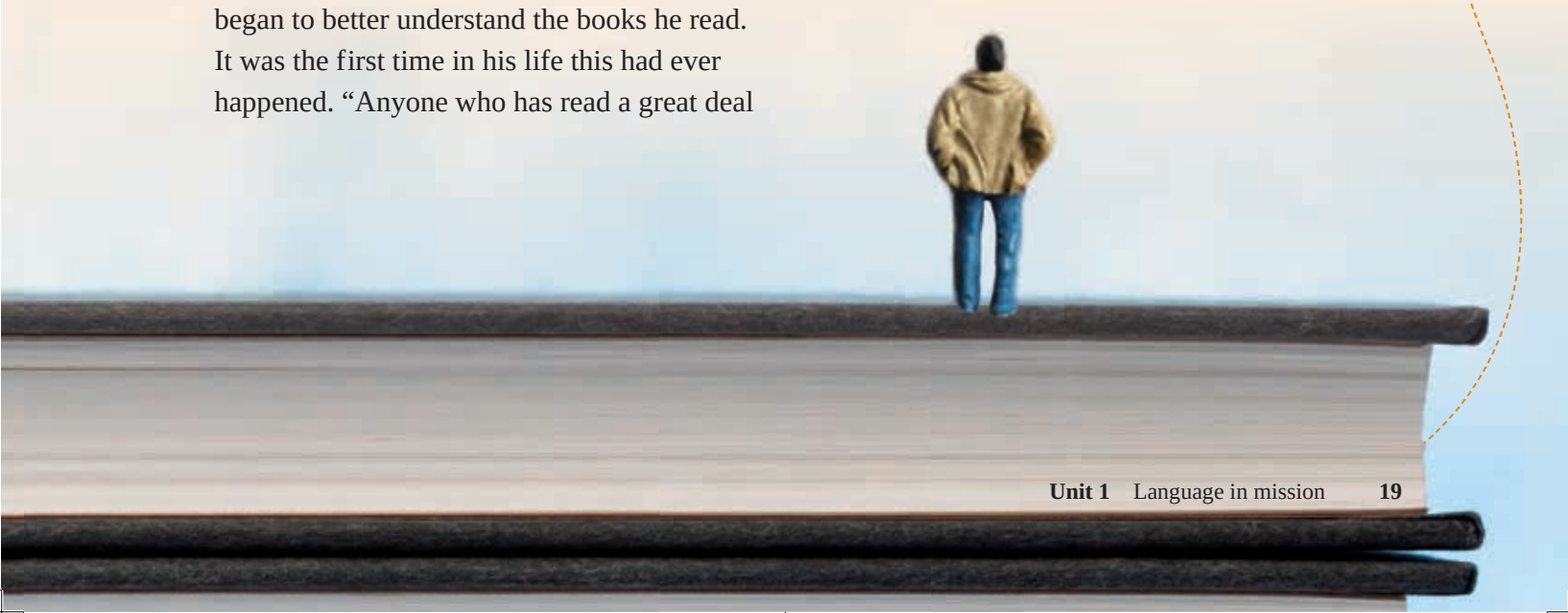
7 He was so fascinated that he went on copying the next page of the dictionary. Once again, he awoke, proud and energized. With every succeeding page he copied and read aloud, Malcolm X found he was learning and remembering more and more words. With each **successive** day, his **confusion diminished**.

8 As Malcolm X's word base broadened, he began to better understand the books he read. It was the first time in his life this had ever happened. "Anyone who has read a great deal can imagine the new world that opened." From then until he left that prison, his **concentration** was focused on reading. He was so absorbed in it that months passed without his even thinking about being in prison. "In fact, up to then, I had never been so truly free in my life."

9 "I knew right there in prison that reading had changed forever the course of my life," Malcolm X wrote. He described how one day a writer telephoned him from London for an interview. The interviewer asked Malcolm X what college he had graduated from as he could write so **fluently**. He told the Englishman that his personal university was "books".

10 Malcolm X's life is a wonderful example of the **profound** effect of learning a language. He was born into a world full of poverty and **ignorance**. However, as he acquired knowledge, his **horizons expanded**. He had left behind the narrow, ignorant world of his youth to join the world community of thoughts and actions ever since he started with his great journey of learning in prison.

(*792 words*)



New words

▲ **mysterious** /mɪˈstɪəriəs/ *a.* difficult to explain or understand 难以解释的；神秘的

mysteriously /mɪˈstɪəriəsli/ *ad.* 难以解释地；神秘地

assassinate /əˈsæsəneɪt/ *vt.* murder an important person 暗杀；行刺

autobiography /ˌɔːtəbaɪˈɒgrəfi/ *n.* [C, U] a book in which sb. writes about their own life, or books of this type 自传

▲ **household** /ˈhaʊshəʊld/ *n.* [C] all the people who live together in one house 家庭；一家人

▲ **commit** /kəˈmɪt/ *vt.*

1 do sth. wrong or illegal 犯（错误或罪行）

2 decide to use money, time, people, etc. for a particular purpose 投入（钱、时间、人力等）

▲ **sketch** /sketʃ/

vt. (*also* **~ out**) describe sth. in a general way, giving the basic ideas 概述；简述

v. make a quick, rough drawing of sth.（给…）画速写；（给…）画素描

n. [C] a short written or spoken description 简述；速写；概述

▲ **sophisticated** /səˈfɪstɪkeɪtɪd/ *a.* (of a machine, system, etc.) clever and complicated in the way that it works or is presented（机器、体系等）复杂的，精密的

unsophisticated /ˌʌnsəˈfɪstɪkeɪtɪd/ *a.* simple and basic; not complicated 简单的；不复杂的

▲ **bid** /bɪd/

n. [C] 1 an attempt to achieve or obtain sth.（为争取某物而作的）努力

2 an offer to pay a particular price for sth., esp. at an auction（尤指拍卖时的）出价

v. (**bid**, **bid**) offer to pay a particular price for goods, esp. in an auction（尤指拍卖时）出价

▲ **desperate** /ˈdespərət/ *a.*

1 willing to do anything to change a very bad situation, and not caring about danger（为了改变糟糕境遇而）不惜冒险的，拼命的；绝望的

2 needing or wanting sth. very much 非常需要…的；极其需要…的

▲ **devise** /dɪˈvaɪz/ *vt.* plan or invent a new way of doing sth. 想出；设计；发明

▲ **scheme** /skiːm/ *n.* [C] (*BrE*) a plan or system for doing or organizing sth. 计划；方案；体系；体制

▲ **clue** /kluː/ *n.* [C]

1 (**not have a ~ / have no ~**) (*infml.*) not have any idea about the answer to a question, how to do sth., what a situation is, etc.（对…）一无所知，毫无头绪

2 a fact or piece of evidence that helps sb. discover the answer to a problem（问题答案的）线索，提示

▲ **frustrate** /frʌˈstreɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sb. feel annoyed and impatient by preventing them from doing or getting sth. 使懊丧；使懊恼

2 prevent sb.'s plans, efforts, or attempts from succeeding 挫败；阻挠

frustrated /frʌˈstreɪtɪd/ *a.* 懊恼的；沮丧的

▲ **launch** /lɔːntʃ/ *vt.* start sth., usu. sth. big or important 发动；发起；开始从事

quest /kwest/ *n.* [C] a long search for sth. that is difficult to find（长期的）寻求；探索；追求

▲ **appeal** /əˈpiːl/ *vi.* make a serious public request for help, money, information, etc. 呼吁；恳请；恳求

skim /skɪm/ *v.* read sth. quickly to find the main facts or ideas in it 浏览，略读（以找出主要信息）

▲ **negotiate** /nɪˈgəʊʃieɪt/

vt. successfully deal with sth. that is preventing sb. from achieving an aim（成功地）解决，

处理，克服

v. try to reach an agreement by discussing sth. in a formal way, esp. in a business or political situation（尤指在商业或政治上）谈判，协商

▲ **format** /ˈfɔːmæt/ *n.* [C, U] the arrangement, design, or organization of sth. 安排；设计；组织方式

▲ **moist** /mɔɪst/ *a.* slightly wet, esp. in a way that is pleasant or suitable 潮润的；微湿的；湿润的

▲ **advisable** /ədˈvaɪzəbəl/ *a.* (*not before noun*) (*fml.*) sensible and a good idea in order to achieve sth. 可取的；明智的

▲ **advisory** /ədˈvaɪzəri/ *a.* having the purpose of giving advice 顾问的；咨询的

crude /kruːd/ *a.*

1 not developed to a high standard, or made with little skill 粗制的；粗糙的

2 not exact or without any detail, but generally correct and useful 粗略的；大概的

▲ **quotation** /kwəʊˈteɪʃən/ *n.* [C] a sentence or phrase from a book, speech, etc. which you repeat in a speech or piece of writing 引语；引文

quotation mark *n.* [C, usu. pl.] 引号

▲ **recall** /rɪˈkɔːl/ *v.* remember a particular fact, event, or situation from the past 回想；回忆起

▲ **log** /lɒg/

vt. make an official record of events, facts, etc. 正式记录（事件、事实等）

v. cut down trees 伐木；砍伐

▲ **literacy** /ˈlɪtərəsi/ *n.* [U] the state of being able to read and write 读写能力；识字

depict /dɪˈpɪkt/ *vt.* (*fml.*) describe sth. or sb. in writing or speech, or show them in a painting, picture, etc. 描写；描述；描绘

▲ **acquisition** /ˌækwəˈzɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process by which you gain knowledge or learn a skill（知识、技能的）获得，习得

▲ **marvellous** /ˈmɑːvələs/ *a.* (*AmE* **marvelous**) extremely good, enjoyable, impressive, etc. 极好的；绝妙的；了不起的

▲ **successive** /səkˈsesɪv/ *a.* (*only before noun*) coming or following one after the other 连续的；接连的；相继的

▲ **confusion** /kənˈfjuːʒən/ *n.* [U] a feeling that you do not understand sth. or cannot decide what to do 迷惑；困惑

diminish /dəˈmɪnɪʃ/ *v.* become or make sth. become smaller or less（使）减少；（使）减小

▲ **concentration** /ˌkɒnsənˈtreɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the process of giving all your attention to sth. 集中精力；专心；专注

▲ **fluent** /ˈfluːənt/ *a.* fluent speech or writing is smooth and confident, with no mistakes（语言或文字）流畅熟练的

fluently /ˈfluːəntli/ *ad.*（语言或文字）流畅熟练地

▲ **profound** /prəˈfaʊnd/ *a.*

1 having a strong influence or effect（影响）深刻的，极大的

2 showing strong serious feelings（感情）强烈的，深切的，严肃的

▲ **ignorance** /ˈɪgnərəns/ *n.* [U] lack of knowledge or information about sth. 无知；愚昧

▲ **horizon** /həˈraɪzən/ *n.*

1 (**~s**) [pl.] the limit of one's ideas, knowledge, and experience（思想、知识和经验的）范围，界限；眼界

2 (**the ~**) the line far away where the land or sea seems to meet the sky 地平线

▲ **expand** /ɪkˈspænd/ *v.* become larger in size, number, or amount, or make sth. become larger（使）扩大；（使）增加

Phrases and expressions

in a bid to do sth. in an attempt to achieve or obtain sth. 试图（或力求）做

turn to sb. / sth. go to sb. or sth. for help, advice, etc. 求助于

speak of mention or talk about 提到；提及

launch sb. on sth. make sb. start sth., usu. sth. big or important 使某人开始进行某事

get hold of sth. find or borrow sth. so that you can use it 找（或借）来

appeal to sb. for sth. make an earnest or urgent request to sb. to get sth. that you need 请求某人提供某物

focus (sth.) on give a lot of attention to one particular person, subject, or thing 集中；特别关注

Proper names

Malcolm /ˈmælkəm/ X 马尔科姆·艾克斯（1925—1965，美国黑人运动领袖）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What is true about Malcolm X?
- A He was put in jail because he joined a religious organization.
- B He wrote *The Autobiography of Malcolm X* in prison.
- C He mysteriously assassinated someone in 1965.
- D He was an African-American civil rights activist.

2 Why did Malcolm X say that he "wasn't even functional" (Para. 2)?
- A He felt ill-prepared to teach his new beliefs to others.
- B He was no longer one of the people on the street.
- C He couldn't recall what he had learned.
- D He couldn't sketch his thoughts quickly.

3 Why did Malcolm X say that he "became frustrated" (Para. 3)?
- A The books couldn't help him improve his language skills.
- B The books he read were too serious for him to understand.
- C He simply couldn't understand what was said in the book.
- D He was pushed to speed up his language learning scheme.

4 What motivated Malcolm X to launch a quest to overcome his language deficiencies?
- A He was often frustrated as he couldn't read and write well.
- B He wanted to learn some basic reading and writing skills.
- C He couldn't find any clues when he was reading a book.
- D He thought he needed to improve his handwriting.

5 How did Malcolm X move from basic literacy toward true proficiency?
- A By repeatedly logging important anecdotes.
- B By repeatedly copying different word roots.
- C By repeatedly copying words and reading them aloud.
- D By repeatedly thinking about his unique learning strategies.

6 What cleared up Malcolm X's confusion about learning English?
- A Thinking about the words he copied.
- B Remembering more and more words.
- C The marvelous feeling he had every morning.
- D The fascination that he got when pursuing knowledge.

7 Why did Malcolm X say "In fact, up to then, I had never been so truly free in my life" (Para. 8)?
- A He couldn't imagine the world before.
- B He couldn't focus on reading before.
- C He felt no longer imprisoned by ignorance.
- D He began to forget why he was put in jail.

8 Why did Malcolm X refer to books as his personal university?
- A He taught himself college courses by books.
- B He learned some word roots from the books.
- C He got a lot of pleasure from the books.
- D He acquired knowledge through the books.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What inspiration did you get from the story of Malcolm X?
2 Why could Malcolm X succeed in learning the English language?
3 How can you adopt Malcolm X's attitude toward learning English in your own studies?
4 Would you recite the dictionary as Malcolm X did? Why or why not?
5 Do you think language can help shape one's mind? Why or why not?

Collocation

More language exercises

English collocations are a useful weapon to sharpen your communication skill. Equipped with this weapon, you can always impress people when you speak and write. For example, you don't just want to say "I'm very happy about it". Instead, you would like to say "I'm extremely happy about it". Similarly, you would like to say "I'm bitterly disappointed" instead of "I'm very disappointed". Therefore, you have a good reason to be motivated to learn collocations from what you read.

This unit focuses on language teaching and learning; therefore, we can see some collocation pairs relevant to this topic in the reading texts. For example, there are *language proficiency*, *language deficit*, *excellent control*, *advanced vocabulary*, *proper vocabulary*, *competent communication*, *effective communication*, and *precise communication* in Text A. Also, in Text B we can see such expressions as *unsophisticated language* and *true proficiency*.

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
essential	a deficiency
distinctive	a thought
high	a scheme
valuable	knowledge
considerable	standard
acquire	possession
overcome	difference
sketch	frustration
devise	framework

4 Read the mini-talk about language teaching. Complete it with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations.

Well, speaking of language teaching, I am afraid that in our language classes we didn't spend adequate time on the 1) *es*_____ *fr*_____ of language: good grammar and 2) *pr*_____ *vo*_____.

Because teachers, students, parents, and the job market are concerned so much about examination results, our current school system pays too much attention to 3) *ex*_____ *co*_____ of testing strategies and relies heavily on how well students can perform on tests.

Some schools assume that students with a 4) *la*_____ *de*_____ can improve their reading scores if they repeatedly practice examination strategies on randomly selected reading passages. Therefore, instead of setting 5) *h*_____ *st*_____ of English 6) *l*_____ *pr*_____, schools somehow encourage students to only practice taking exams with the reading strategies they are "taught" in class. Consequently, they can only 7) *a*_____ *kn*_____ of test-taking strategies, but not 8) *c*_____ *com*_____ skills.

To 9) *ov*_____ *de*_____ in language teaching, classes should focus on reading various texts and articles on literature, science, history, and art. Students can learn how to 10) *sk*_____ their *th*_____ to achieve 11) *e*_____ *com*_____ in the real world through extensive reading. While conducting reading activities, we should also spend enough time on language components such as 12) *ad*_____ *vo*_____. In short, test preparation should be focused on the content rather than test-taking strategies.

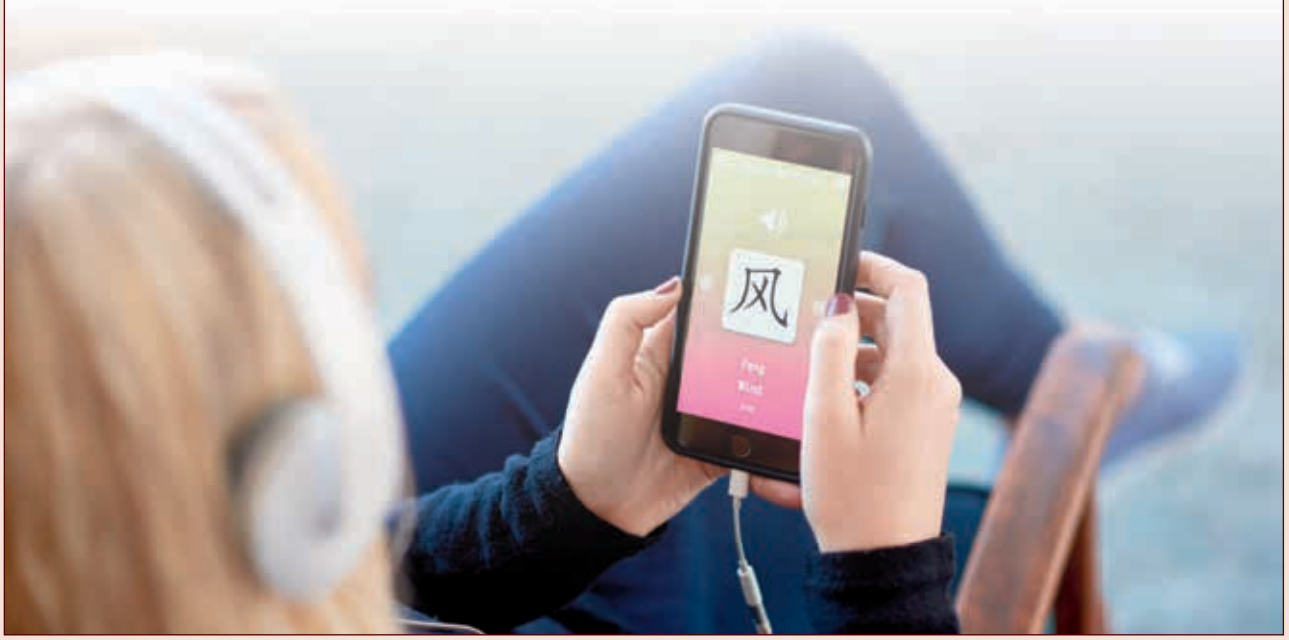
Stories of China

What challenges learners of Chinese?

Because of the rapid transformation of its society and the continuous development of its economy, China has attracted people from more and more countries. They come to China to work and study, and many start to learn Chinese.

However, learning a new language is not easy, especially Chinese. The Chinese tones are one of the key challenges for foreign learners. Tones in Chinese distinguish meanings. When foreign learners speak Chinese, the pronunciation often sounds a little weird, because they cannot grasp the tones well. The main problems are that their voice cannot go up for the second tone, go down for the fourth, and make a turn for the third. For example, the words " 睡觉 (shuì jiào)" and " 水饺 (shuǐ jiǎo)" have different tones and, therefore, convey different meanings. " 睡觉 " means "sleep", and " 水饺 " means "dumpling". If the tone is not properly pronounced, the meaning will be entirely different.

Another challenge is the Chinese writing system, which has gone through a long evolution since ancient China. Chinese is an ideographic (表意的) language, and its characters are formed from images. Writing Chinese characters, in a sense, is just like drawing pictures. Besides, a Chinese character combines its form, sound, and meaning



together into one, but the relationship between the three is rather complex. To learn Chinese characters, learners should not only remember the relationship between form and meaning but also the relationship between sound and meaning. This builds a huge language barrier for foreigners.

Furthermore, Chinese vocabulary can make its learners feel overwhelmed. In fact, vocabulary, a basic component of a language, is the most difficult part in learning Chinese. For instance, due to the rich category of quantifiers in the Chinese language, the usage of different quantifiers seems to be confusing to foreigners, such as " 一块面包 (a piece of bread)", " 一张纸 (a piece of paper)", and " 一支曲子 (a piece of music)". There are also many other quantifiers that are hard for beginners to use correctly.

These are some of the challenges when foreigners learn the Chinese language. However, it is always fun to learn the language because of its long history and unique ideographic meaning. Motivated foreigners can become proficient in Chinese after a period of time staying in China.

Chinese is a beautiful language, very different from English or other languages. It is predictable that China's rising international status will continue to draw the attention of the world and help significantly increase the number of foreigners interested in learning Chinese.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 众所周知，中国书法（calligraphy）是一门独特的艺术，也是世界上独一无二的艺术瑰宝（treasure）。

2 汉字在漫长的演变过程中，始终起着交流思想、传承文化的重要作用。

3 很显然，中国书法的形成、发展与汉字的演变存在着密不可分的关系。

Unit project

Writing a report on English learning strategies



English is a useful tool to help with our country's reform and opening up. Learning English is not an easy job, but we can learn it well with various strategies and consistent effort. Have you ever thought about any learning strategies? What strategies are more effective for you and your classmates? In this unit project, you are required to interview your classmates and write a report on English learning strategies.

Step 1 **Read the following list of strategies for learning English and check (✔) the strategies you usually adopt. You can also add more if necessary.**

- ☐ 1 Listen to English songs and watch English movies.
- ☐ 2 Connect with English speakers via email, blogs, etc.
- ☐ 3 Spend one or half an hour per day reading English articles.
- ☐ 4 Have a notebook exclusively for new words and idioms.
- ☐ 5 Use English-English dictionaries to look up new words.
- ☐ 6 Pay close attention to new vocabulary while listening and reading.
- ☐ 7 Other: _____

Step 2 **Interview two or three classmates using the above list and collect their strategies for learning English.**

Step 3 **Work in groups to compare and share the information you've collected.**

Step 4 **Write a report on learning strategies based on your findings. The report should include the following:**

- People you interviewed
- Strategies they adopted
- Your evaluation of the strategies
- A plan to improve your own learning strategies

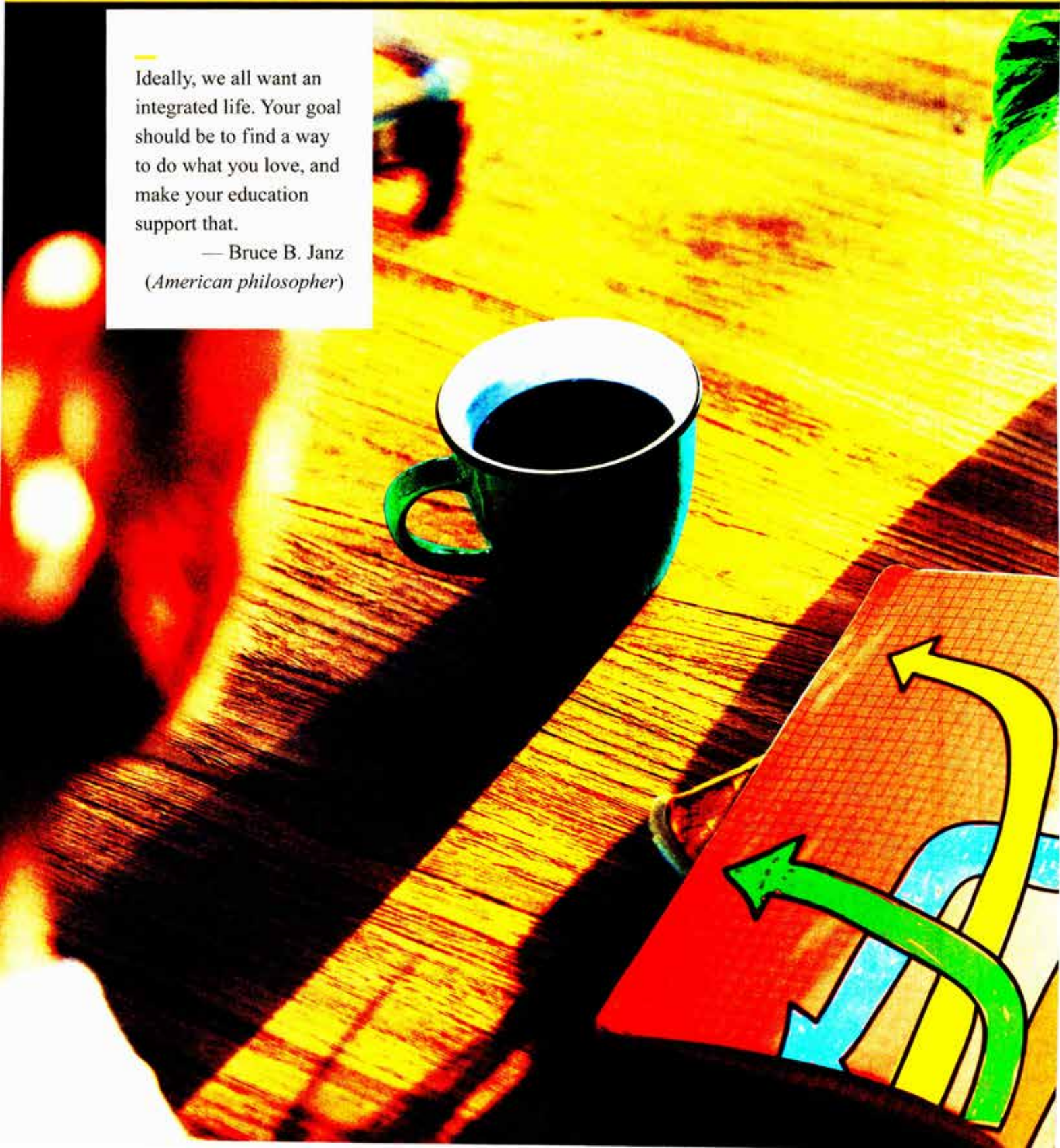
Step 5 **Present the report in your group and vote for the best one.**

Unit 2

Exploring college majors

Ideally, we all want an integrated life. Your goal should be to find a way to do what you love, and make your education support that.

— Bruce B. Janz
(*American philosopher*)



Preview

Are you happy about your major? Do you think your major is just right for you? There are no fixed criteria for choosing a major. Some choose their favorite major based on their personal interests, and some **choose the most unpopular discipline for the needs of the country**. In short, interests, abilities, needs, ambitions, etc. may all affect your decision about choosing a major.

What major to choose will not only impact your future but also affect your motivation to learn. If you love what you're studying, you're more likely to fully engage in your classes. It's not surprising that students who major in the subjects they have passion for tend to be happier and do better academically, just as the author of Text A did. Text B openly asserts that humanities can benefit you in your future career. Would you buy that? Of course, it's never "one size fits all"! There must be answers just right for you!



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Listen to a dialog about choosing a college major. Then choose the correct answer to each of the following questions.

Audio clip

1 What did Sara suggest to the man in terms of choosing a major?
   A Choosing a major that can lead to better career opportunities.
   B Choosing a major that suits his interest, ability, and personality.
2 Why did Sara choose history as her major?
   A To be different from her classmates.
   B To learn more and broaden her horizons.
3 What else did Sara suggest should be taken into consideration?
   A Choosing a major that satisfies the needs of society and the country.
   B Choosing a major that many people flock to, such as business.
4 What did Sara mean by "a sense of accomplishment"?
   A Being able to accomplish what the man had expected.
   B Being able to use knowledge to serve society and the country.

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 From your personal experience, what is the most challenging part in choosing the right major?
2 If you were asked for advice about choosing a major, what would you say?
3 In your opinion, what should college students do to reflect their value to society?

Text A

1 Do you know the **fairy tale** of "Goldilocks and the Three Bears"? Goldilocks entered the house of the three bears. There, she tried Papa Bear's porridge, and it was too hot. Mama Bear's was too cold. But Baby Bear's was just right, so she ate it all up. Thus, essentially, she committed the crime of **burglary** and **grabbed** a full serving of food belonging to an innocent child. Shame on her!

2 Interestingly, the **plot** in this fairy tale is very similar to my experience in choosing my college major. It took me three tries as well to find a major and a career that I loved and that fit me. For many of us, it can be a very lengthy process of self-discovery before we realize what we want to do and what we are really **passionate** about.

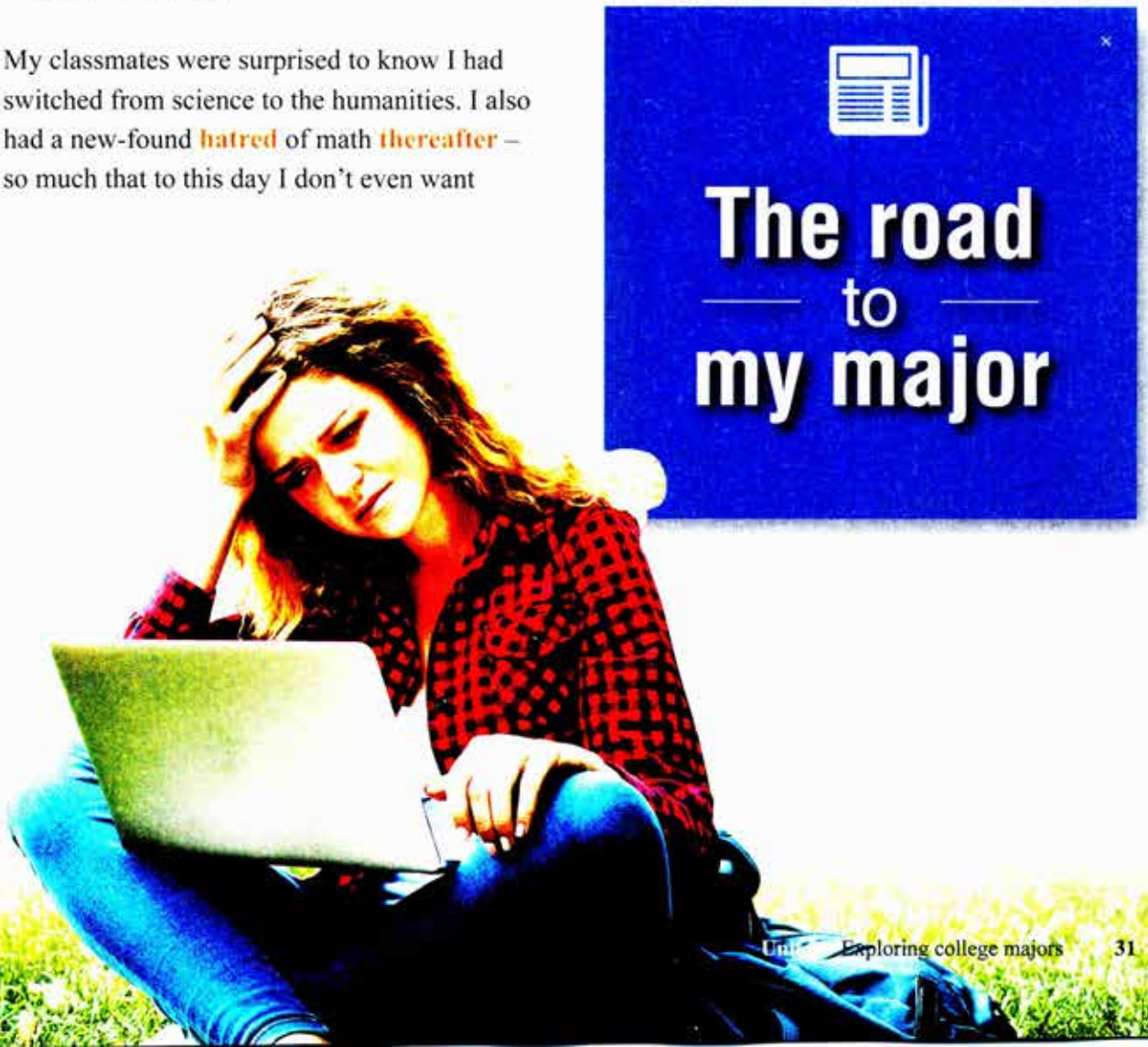
3 Believe it or not, engineering was my high school **version** of a future career. Sounds **weird**, doesn't it? I, **currently** a writer who does nothing with numbers, wanted to be an engineer during my high school years! At that time, it truly made sense, though. I was extremely **obsessed** with the **magnificence** of **massive** engineering structures. I would wander the streets of Boston **gazing** up at the skyscrapers in **awe**, and I was so fascinated by **roller coasters** in the theme parks. I was good at math and was doing well with the advanced math classes, but when it was time to decide whether or not to take the AP (**Advanced Placement**) math course in high school, I

hesitated. Why? I lacked confidence and knew there was a chance I wouldn't succeed.

4 I started questioning my decision to become an engineer, so the first **semester** at college, I took the **introductory** engineering math class to **confirm** or disprove my doubt – whether I have a talent for engineering. Well, I struggled. Not just "I'm having trouble with this chapter" kind of struggle. The concepts were simply beyond me. My math level was fairly advanced in high school, but at college I found I wasn't up to **par**. I struggled so much that I dropped the course and gave up my high school dream – to become an engineer. The porridge was too hot!

5 My classmates were surprised to know I had switched from science to the humanities. I also had a new-found **hatred** of math **thereafter** – so much that to this day I don't even want to **calculate** the tip on a restaurant bill. I felt the subject let me down, so my next career consideration was, naturally, to do something on the opposite side of the **spectrum**, something free and **artistic**.

6 I **browsed** the **options** on my college website. The **graphic design** program reminded me of my childhood days of excessive drawing. This part of the porridge turned out quite brief, since the requirements to enter the program were not demanding. Nevertheless, I still didn't feel quite right because I was not excited about it. I walked away. The porridge was too cold!



7 It was at this point that I felt completely frustrated, a **sentiment** shared by many college students browsing majors. I picked the brains of my advisor, carefully read the information on the career services website, and continued to hesitate about my major choice. Things didn't change till I got a phone call from my dad. Talking to him, I threw out the idea of applying for a position at a student-run newspaper on campus, more like a last **resort** than an actual consideration. "You know, you've always been good at writing," he said. You know what? My **prolonged** hesitation over my major ended dramatically, not with more excessive overthinking, but rather, as a sudden realization. All I needed was an outside **source** to confirm the fact: Journalism was my **calling**.

8 "Why didn't it hit me before?" I asked myself. As a child, I won writing contests and got second place in two Spelling Bees. I earned straight A's in English and writing classes. Even at college, friends let me **proofread** their papers. The signs were right there in front of me, but I just ignored them because I didn't think my abilities were unique.

9 Journalism, to me, is the perfect balance between what I loved about engineering and graphic design. It's structured, like engineering, in the fact that you need to know grammar rules, journalistic styles, **press releases**, and the like. But it's also artistic in the fact that you get to explore a range of **thought-provoking** topics, express them in a creative light, and put them all in front of readers.

10 I ended up majoring in journalism with a **minor** in English after rediscovering my love for writing. I then applied for the newspaper job and was accepted on my first try. I was lucky enough to be at a school with a **reputable** journalism program. I was also lucky in the sense that I discovered my career **aspirations** at the ripe age of 20, not just because it saved me unknown **tuition** dollars pursuing unknown degrees with unknown extra classes. I found the porridge just right, so I swallowed it.

(*856 words*)

Culture notes

Goldilocks and the Three Bears: a British 19th-century fairy tale. It has three versions and has become one of the most popular fairy tales in English-speaking countries.

Spelling Bee: a competition in which participants are asked to spell a large variety of selected words with a certain degree of difficulty. The competition is said to have originated in the United States and is common only in countries where English is spoken.

New words

▲ fairy /ˈfeəri/ *n.* [C] a small imaginary creature with magic powers, which looks like a very small person 仙子；小精灵

fairy tale *n.* [C] (*also* **fairy story**) a children's story in which magical things happen 童话；神话；神仙故事

burglary /ˈbɜːgləri/ *n.* [C, U] the crime of getting into a building to steal things 入室盗窃（罪）

▲ grab /græb/ *vt.*
1 get sth. for yourself, sometimes in an unfair way 霸占；捞取；强夺
2 take hold of sb. or sth. with a sudden or violent movement 攫取；抓住

▲ plot /plɒt/ *n.* [C]
1 the events that form the main story of a book, film, or play（书、电影、戏剧的）情节
2 a secret plan by a group of people to do sth. harmful or illegal 密谋；阴谋；秘密计划

▲ passionate /ˈpæʃənət/ *a.* very enthusiastic or interested 非常热情的；极其感兴趣的

▲ version /ˈvɜːʃən/ *n.* [C] a copy of sth. that has been changed so it is slightly different 版本；变体

▲ weird /wɪəd/ *a.* (*infml.*) very strange and unusual, and difficult to understand or explain 古怪的；奇异的

▲ currently /ˈkʌrəntli/ *ad.* at the present time 现时；当前

obsess /əbˈses/ *vt.* (*usu. passive*) completely fill your mind so that you cannot think of anything else, in a way that is not reasonable or normal 使痴迷；使迷恋；使着迷

▲ magnificence /mægˈnɪfɪsəns/ *n.* [U] the quality and state of being magnificent 宏伟；壮丽；华丽；富丽堂皇

▲ massive /ˈmæsɪv/ *a.*
1 very large, solid, and heavy 大而重的；厚重的
2 unusually large, powerful, or damaging 巨大的；强大的；强烈的；极具破坏力的

▲ gaze /geɪz/ *vi.* look at sb. or sth. for a long time, giving it all your attention, often without realizing you are doing so（常指无意识地）凝视，盯着看

▲ awe /ɔː/ *n.* [U] feelings of respect and slight fear; feelings of being very impressed by sth. or sb. 敬畏；惊叹

roller coaster /ˈrəʊlə ˌkəʊstə/ *n.* [C] 过山车；云霄飞车

▲ placement /ˈpleɪsmənt/ *n.* [U] the process of finding sb. a place where they can live, work, or study 安置；安排；安顿

Advanced Placement *n.* (*AmE*) a program that provides course descriptions, curriculum material, and tests to high schools, giving students the opportunity to complete college-level studies 先修课程；进阶课程

▲ hesitate /ˈhezɪteɪt/ *vi.* pause before saying or doing sth. because you are nervous or not sure 犹豫；踌躇；迟疑

▲ semester /səˈmestə/ *n.* [C] one of the two periods that the school or college year is divided into 学期（一学年分两个学期）

▲ introductory /ˌɪntrəˈdʌktəri/ *a.* (*only before noun*) intended for people who have never done a particular activity before 入门的；初步的

▲ confirm /kənˈfɜːm/ *vt.* show that sth. is definitely true, esp. by providing more proof（尤指通过提供更多证据）证实，证明

par /pɑː/ *n.* [U] the usual or expected standard 标准；水准

▲ hatred /ˈheɪtrɪd/ *n.* [C, U] an angry feeling of extreme dislike for sb. or sth. 憎恶；憎恨；仇恨

thereafter /ðeərˈɑːftə/ *ad.* (*fml.*) after a particular event or time 其后；此后

▲ **calculate** /ˈkælkjəleɪt/ *vt.*

1 find out how much sth. will cost, how long sth. will take, etc. by using numbers 计算；核算

2 guess sth. using as many facts as you can find 估计；预测

spectrum /ˈspektrəm/ *n.* [C] (*pl.* **spectra**)

1 a complete range of opinions, people, situations, etc., going from one extreme to its opposite（观点、人、情况等的）范围，幅度

2 the set of bands of colored light into which a beam of light separates when it is passed through a prism 光谱

▲ **artistic** /ɑːˈtɪstɪk/ *a.*

1 relating to art or culture 美术的；艺术的

2 good at painting, drawing, or producing beautiful things 艺术精湛的；有艺术才华的

▲ **browse** /braʊz/ *v.* search for information on a computer or on the Internet（在计算机或因特网上）浏览（信息）

▲ **option** /ˈɒpʃən/ *n.* [C] a choice you can make in a particular situation 选择；可选择的东西

▲ **graphic** /ˈgræfɪk/ *a.*

1 (*only before noun*) connected with or including drawing, printing, or designing 绘画的；图样的；印刷的；平面设计的

2 a graphic account or description of an event is very clear and gives a lot of details, esp. unpleasant ones（叙述或描写）清楚详细的，细致的（尤指包含令人不愉快的细节）

graphic design *n.* [U]（书、杂志等的）平面设计

sentiment /ˈsentəmənt/ *n.*

1 [C, U] (*fml.*) an opinion or feeling you have about sth. 意见；观点；感想

2 [U] feelings of pity, love, sadness, etc. that are often considered to be too strong or not suitable for a particular situation 多愁善感；感情因素

▲ **resort** /rɪˈzɔːt/

n. 1 (**last / final ~**) what you will do if everything else fails（其他方法都失败后采用的）最后的手段

2 [C] a place where a lot of people go for holidays 度假胜地

v. (**~ to**) do sth. extreme or unpleasant in order to solve a problem 采取；诉诸；求助于

prolong /prəˈlɒŋ/ *vt.* deliberately make sth. such as a feeling or an activity last longer 延长，拉长，拖长（感觉或活动）

prolonged /prəˈlɒŋd/ *a.* continuing for a long time 持久的

▲ **source** /sɔːs/ *n.* [C]

1 a person, book, or document that supplies you with information 提供消息者；资料来源

2 a thing, place, activity, etc. that you get sth. from 来源；出处

▲ **calling** /ˈkɔːlɪŋ/ *n.* [C]

1 (*fml.*) sb.'s profession or trade 职业；行业

2 a strong desire or feeling of duty to do a particular job, esp. one in which you help other people 使命感；责任感

proofread /ˈpruːfriːd/ *v.* (*also* **proof**) (**proofread, proofread**) read through sth. that is written or printed in order to correct any mistakes in it 校对；校阅

▲ **release** /rɪˈliːs/

n. [C, U] an official statement, report, etc. that is made available to be printed or broadcast, or the act of making it available 发布的声明（或报告等）；（声明、报告等的）发表，发布

vt. let news or official information be known and printed 公开发表；发布

press release *n.* [C] an official statement giving information to the newspapers, radio, or television 新闻稿

▲ **provoke** /prəˈvəʊk/ *vt.*

1 cause a reaction or feeling, esp. a sudden one 激起；引起

2 make sb. angry, esp. deliberately 激怒；使恼火

thought-provoking *a.* making people think seriously about a particular subject 发人深省的；引人深思的

▲ **minor** /ˈmaɪnə/

n. [C] (*AmE*) the second main subject that you study at university for your degree（大学中的）辅修科目

v. **(~ in)** (*AmE*) study a second main subject as part of your university degree（大学里）辅修（某课程）

reputable /ˈrepjətəbəl/ *a.* respected for being honest or for doing good work 声誉好的；有声望的；信誉佳的

aspiration /ˌæspəˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [C, usu. pl., U] a strong desire to have or achieve sth. 志向；抱负；强烈愿望

▲ **tuition** /tjuˈɪʃən/ *n.* [U] (*BrE* **tuition fees**) the money you pay for being taught 学费

Phrases and expressions

be passionate about have special interest in sth. 热衷于

be obsessed with / by think about sth. a lot, with the result that you don't pay attention to other things or people 沉迷于；对…着迷

in awe in a mood of great admiration and respect, often combined with fear 敬畏的（地）；崇敬的（地）

not up to par less good than usual or below the proper standard 在一般水平以下；达不到标准

let sb. down

1 make sb. less successful or effective 使略逊一筹；使美中不足

2 make sb. disappointed by not doing sth. 使失望；辜负（别人的信任或期望）

turn out happen in a particular way, or have a particular result, esp. one that you didn't expect 最后结果是；最终成为

pick one's brains ask sb. who knows a lot about sth. for information and advice about it 向…讨教（或请教）

throw sth. out say sth. in a way that suggests you have not given it a lot of thought 脱口而出；随口说

major in (*esp. AmE*) study sth. as your main subject at college or university（在大学）主修

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why does the author say that the fairy tale is very similar to her experience?
2 Why does the author say that choosing a major can be a lengthy process of self-discovery?
3 What made the author want to become an engineer during her high school years?
4 Why did the author give up her high school dream after she entered college?
5 How come the author had a hatred of math later?
6 What made the author drop her second choice of a major – graphic design?
7 When did the author's prolonged hesitation over her major end dramatically?
8 Why does the author think journalism is the perfect balance for her?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 In your opinion, what makes choosing a major difficult?
2 In what ways can a major that suits you empower you in the future?
3 Are double major students more competitive in the job market? Why or why not?
4 Will the choice of a major affect students' future career? Why or why not?
5 Besides personal factors, what other factors can affect the choice of a major?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

artistic aspiration browse confirm
magnificence option prolonged
provoke release reputable

1 With the _____ global fight against poverty still continuing, many countries are looking to draw inspiration from China.
2 According to the news _____, her interest in writing about plants and animals came from her childhood.
3 Many of them are beginners who have never done painting before and are looking to develop their _____ interests.
4 Consumers are increasingly comfortable shopping using their mobile devices, with 69 percent of people _____ and shopping online last year.
5 The tourists were awestruck at the _____ of the Great Wall, the building of which started as early as the seventh century B.C.E.
6 As we know, earlier diagnosis (诊断) can give better treatment _____ to patients, which will also help them get effective care.
7 Some clinics require people to call the front desk to _____ their appointments before they come to see the doctors.
8 The website is reliable because I've made dozens of purchases from this very _____ site with zero problems.
9 "What do you think the author meant when …?" is a common book club question, which _____ serious analysis of a topic.
10 Just as we all admire heroes, we look to others for inspiration and _____, but change has to start with you, as an individual.

Word building



与动词组合构成名词，可表示动词描述的活动。但有些不含原来动词的意思，只表示这个动作、行为的产物或结果。

call		calling
live		living
bear	>	**bearing**
dress		**dressing**
fill		**filling**

与动词组合构成形容词。其含义分为两种情况：由及物动词转换成的形容词描述的是该动作让人产生的感受和想法；由不及物动词转换成的形容词描述的是连续的过程或状态。

interest		interesting
frighten		frightening
grow	>	growing
last		**lasting**



与动词组合构成形容词。表示“具有……倾向的”、“具有……特性的”或“属于……的”。

defend		defensive
obsess		obsessive
conclude	>	**conclusive**
elect		**elective**
restrict		**restrictive**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

bearing conclusive dressing
elective filling
lasting restrictive

1 If you want to stay healthy, the next time you sit down at a restaurant, don't order the salad _____, and don't order the fried stuff.
2 Whenever parents make a decision, they need to take their children into consideration because it may have a(n) _____ on the children.
3 Musical training earlier in life can have _____ benefits, namely improving listening skills, strengthening attention spans, etc., according to the study.
4 Students wishing to major in engineering or computer science are required to complete six additional _____ courses in the department.
5 The elderly Chinese lady showed the foreigners how to mix the dumpling _____, using chicken, vegetables, and green onions.
6 The authorities established _____ rules for delivery men, hoping to enhance the management of the courier and takeout delivery sectors.
7 Scientists have attempted to determine what drives certain people to commit horrible acts, but _____ answers are difficult to find.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A abilities	**F** fortunate	**K** options
B absorbed	**G** gain	**L** passionate
C competent	**H** generally	**M** portions
D confine	**I** inevitably	**N** reputable
E confirm	**J** obsessed	**O** resort

When choosing a college or major, you need to examine yourself: What are your 1) _____ and strengths? What are your weaknesses? What do you want out of life? Are you socially 2) _____ or do you need family and friends' support in order to 3) _____ what you have decided is right?

Your college does not have to be bigger than your high school. Don't be 4) _____ with the size of your college. Since a smaller community is more favorable for self-exploration, many 5) _____ colleges have a smaller student population. It is not the number of people, but the people themselves and the kind of school community in which you will learn that really matter.

You don't have to 6) _____ to other people's help, but think about the people in your life who are happy and successful and find out where they went to college. You will 7) _____ find that success in life has less to do with the choice of college than with the experience and opportunities you'll 8) _____ while in college, coupled with personal qualities and traits.

There are many 9) _____ to major in, but you may need the variety and depth of college coursework to determine the major you are 10) _____ about. Whether you choose your major out of personal interest or for the needs of society and the country, you may possibly change your mind, even two or three times, before you finally settle on one.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

in awe　let sb. down　not up to par
obsessed with　passionate about
pick one's brains　throw … out　turn out

1 When I first saw the scenery of Mount Huangshan, I was _____: the fascinating pine trees, the spectacular peaks, and the fairyland of clouds and mists.
2 The group discussion became heated, with creative ideas and suggestions _____ from time to time.
3 Whenever there is a chance we can help these children, we make a top effort and don't want to _____.
4 Science is not my profession, so if you want to discuss it, you could _____ other people here who know science better than me.
5 I draw inspiration from many teachers who are _____ their work and try to spread their enthusiasm to their students.
6 If you feel that your grades or your study skills are _____, you may turn to your teachers for advice.
7 I had never been to this restaurant before, but it _____ fantastic not only because of its delicious food but also the wonderful service.
8 If one is always _____ money, appearance, and social status, they will unfortunately forget what is most important in their life.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Focusing on a narrative essay

In this unit, you will learn how to write a narrative. At times we make a statement clear by relating in detail something that has happened. A person might say "I was very excited yesterday" and then go on to illustrate the statement with a narrative. The details could make the moment of excitement vivid and real for us, and we can understand just why the person felt so excited.

A narrative, in some sense, is simply an account that illustrates a point. That point is often about an emotion you felt: relief, delight, anger, jealousy, confusion, thankfulness, loneliness, sadness, or terror. For example, to present the feeling of relief, you may think of the time when you got a sudden realization of something that had confused you for quite a long time or when you could see "the light at the end of the tunnel".

In brief, when you write a narrative, you may go through several steps:

1 Write down whatever comes to your mind about the experience without worrying about spelling or grammar.
2 Write your thesis statement and make sure it contains the emotion you will focus on. For example, "My college life was an extremely pleasant experience."
3 Make up a list of all the details involved in the experience. Then number these details according to the order in which they occurred.
4 Write a rough draft based on the listed details. Use time signals such as *first*, *then*, *after*, *next*, *while*, *during*, and *finally* to help connect details as you move from the beginning to the middle and to the end of the narrative. Make sure to include not only what happened but also how you felt about what was going on. You may also make the experience more vivid by including mini-dialogs.

Now, take a look at Para. 7 of Text A.

It was at this point that I felt completely frustrated, a sentiment shared by many college students browsing majors. I picked the brains of my advisor, carefully read the information on the career services website, and continued to hesitate about my major choice. Things didn't change till I got a phone call from my dad. Talking to him, I threw out the idea of applying for a position at a student-run newspaper on campus, more like a last resort than an actual consideration. "You know, you've always been good at writing," he said. You know what? My prolonged hesitation over my major ended dramatically, not with more excessive overthinking, but rather, as a sudden realization ...

The narrative is vivid because of the details of her feelings: from hesitation and frustration in the beginning to a sudden realization in the end. Also, a direct quote by her caring and encouraging father is nicely used, which brings the narrative to life. It's not difficult to see that the paragraph illustrates the emotion of relief. You can tell how the author felt when she suddenly realized that journalism was her calling.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops with details.

Topic
My first day of college

Introduction
Thesis statement: I will never forget my first day of college as it was quite fascinating.

Body
Detail 1: What happened when I arrived at college
Detail 2: The speech by the college president
Detail 3: The advice from a professor

Conclusion
I was truly fascinated by my first day of college.

Like every high school student, I dreamed of the day when I could attend college. To me, college life is a wonderful mix of experiences and memories. I will never forget my first day of college as it was quite fascinating.

That day, I woke up early, took a bath, hurriedly had my breakfast and dashed off to college. When I arrived on campus, I saw a group of older students welcoming the newcomers. Curiously, I joined them. There were lots of "get to know you" activities and I had great fun making new friends. At one point, I was asked to sing. I was really embarrassed but everyone shouted "Come on!" and I managed to sing a whole song! I even got applause.

Soon, we were told to gather in the hall, where the college president would deliver a speech. After a little while, the president began his address to us. He first shared his philosophy of life and gave us some advice in a simple and humorous way, and then he advised us that we should devote 100 percent of our focus to academics and make every effort to achieve our objectives. We were greatly inspired and determined to go all out to excel in college.

Afterward, a professor walked us to the classroom. Without giving us any lecture, he gave us some advice on how to live our lives in the future. He emphasized that we should not abuse the right of freedom, but rather make full use of the opportunity to pursue our goals. He then made us do self-introduction in class one by one. It was fun because I met many interesting classmates. Before he left the classroom, the professor said passionately, "Wish you all the best in your college life!"

Anyway, I was truly fascinated by my first day of college. To me, college is unquestionably an excellent place for a student's life. I felt as if I had entered an amazing and very pleasant universe, where there were modern structures, beautiful playgrounds, dedicated professors, friendly students, and more.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Making a public speech

Introduction

Thesis statement: I had never thought I could speak in public, but I finally conquered my fear of it.

Body

Detail 1: I practiced my speech a lot with written notes.

Detail 2: I picked up the wrong notes by mistake that day, but I made it.

Conclusion

The speech made me realize that people can always overcome their fears if they are motivated.

More topics

- An unforgettable experience
- The happiest day in my life

Section B

Reading skills

Reading for major details

It's important to identify the main idea of a paragraph, but the main idea doesn't give you all the information you need in a paragraph. Instead, facts, examples, and details appearing within a paragraph may help to pave the path for your comprehension. These supporting details may paint a more complete picture, prove a significant point, or show the close relationship between ideas.

On the other hand, it is also obvious that not all the details in a paragraph have the same importance. Details that give major information about the main idea, however, are very important. Small or less important details help round out the paragraph and often hold your attention, thus making the material you are reading more interesting. Still, you may ignore small details if your goal is a clear and quick understanding of the material.

So, when looking for the major details of a paragraph, you have to learn how to read for the main idea of the paragraph. When you have found all the facts and details that help to add up to the main idea of the paragraph, you can separate them from less important details. Now look at Para. 3 from Text A.

Believe it or not, engineering was my high school version of a future career. Sounds weird, doesn't it? I, currently a writer who does nothing with numbers, wanted to be an engineer during my high school years! At that time, it truly made sense, though. I was extremely obsessed with the magnificence of massive engineering structures. I would wander the streets of Boston gazing up at the skyscrapers in awe, and I was so fascinated by roller coasters in the theme parks. I was good at math and was doing well with the advanced math classes, but when it was time to decide whether or not to take the AP (Advanced Placement) math course in high school, I hesitated. Why? I lacked confidence and knew there was a chance I wouldn't succeed.

Main idea: Engineering was my high school version of a future career.
Major details: I was extremely obsessed with the magnificence of massive engineering structures; I was good at math and was doing well with the advanced math classes.

Once you have identified the major details of a paragraph, other details of the paragraph become secondary and less important.

I Read the following paragraphs from Text B. Then find the main idea and major detail of each paragraph.

1 Over the next few years, as labor markets struggle, the humanities will probably continue their long slide in succession. There already has been a nearly 50 percent decline in the portion of liberal arts majors over the past years, and it is logical to think that the trend is bound to continue or even accelerate. Once the dominant pillar of university life, the humanities now play little roles when students take their college tours. These days, labs are more vivid and compelling than libraries. (Para. 3)

Main idea: _____

Major detail: _____

2 Perhaps the best argument in favor of the humanities is the scope of possibilities that are widely open to us. Did you know that Sally Ride, the first American woman getting into space, had a degree in the humanities, aside from physics? Martial arts actor Bruce Lee also majored in the humanities. Famous people who studied the humanities make a long list. It's easy to see that the humanities can prepare us for many different careers and jobs we can undertake, whether medicine, business, science, or entertainment. If we study only mathematics, it's likely we will be a candidate only for jobs as a mathematician. If we include studying the humanities, we can break through many barriers and are limited only by our effort and imagination. (Para. 8)

Main idea: _____

Major detail: _____

3 Of course, nowadays, if we study the humanities alone, we are liable to miss many opportunities. Each one of us needs to become as technically and professionally skilled as possible to help meet the needs of modern life. In fact, increasingly a pairing of technical knowledge and inner insight is seen as the ideal in the establishment of a career. If I were the Dean of Admissions at a medical school and two people applied to our school, both having the required basic science courses, one a philosophy major and the other solely a pre-med student, the philosophy applicant would be chosen. (Para. 9)

Main idea: _____

Major detail: _____

Text B

1 When the going gets tough, the tough take **accounting**. When the job market worsens, many students calculate they can't major in English or history. They have to study something that **boosts** their **prospects** of landing a job.

2 The data show that as students in the U.S. have increasingly shouldered the ever-rising cost of tuition, they have **defected** from the study of the humanities to applied science and "hard" skills that they **bet** will lead to employment. In other words, a college education is more and more seen as a means for economic betterment rather than a means for human betterment. This is a trend that is likely to **persist** and even **accelerate**.

3 Over the next few years, as labor markets struggle, the humanities will probably continue their long slide in **succession**. There already has been a nearly 50 percent decline in the portion of **liberal arts** majors over the past years, and it is **logical** to think that the trend is **bound** to continue or even accelerate. Once the **dominant pillar** of university life, the humanities now play little roles when students take their college tours. These days, labs are more **vivid** and **compelling** than libraries.

4 Here, please allow me to stand up for and **promote** the true value that the humanities add to people's lives. Since ancient times, people have **speculated** about the mystery of those inner forces that drive some people to greatness and others to **self-destruction**. This inner drive has been called many things over the centuries. The famous psychologist, Sigmund Freud, called it the "**unconscious** mind" or, more familiarly, "instinct".

5 From the beginning of time, this inner aspect of our being, this drive that can be **constructive** or destructive, has captured our imagination. The stories of this amazing struggle have formed the basis of cultures the world over. Historians, architects, authors, **philosophers**, and artists have captured the words, images, and meanings of this inner struggle in the form of story, music, **myth**, painting, architecture, sculpture, **landscape**, and tradition. These men and women developed artistic "languages" that help us understand these aspirations and also educate generations. This vast body of work from ancient times, the very foundation of civilization, forms the basis of the study of the humanities.



6 Studying the humanities improves our ability to read and write. No matter what we do in life, we will have a huge advantage if we can read complex ideas and understand their meaning. Likewise, we will immensely benefit if we can write a clear and elegant analysis of those ideas.

7 Studying the humanities makes us familiar with the language of emotion and the creative process. In an information economy, many people have the ability to produce a useful product. Yet, very few people have the ability to create a spectacular brand. Most importantly, studying the humanities invests us with great insight and self-awareness, thereby releasing our creative energy and talent in a positive and constructive manner.

8 Perhaps the best argument in favor of the humanities is the scope of possibilities that are widely open to us. Did you know that Sally Ride, the first American woman getting into space, had a degree in the humanities, aside from physics? Martial arts actor Bruce Lee also majored in the humanities. Famous people who studied the humanities make a long list. It's easy to see that the humanities can prepare us for many different careers and jobs we can undertake, whether medicine, business, science, or entertainment. If we study only mathematics, it's likely we will be a candidate only for jobs as a mathematician. If we include studying the humanities, we can break through many barriers and are limited only by our effort and imagination.

9 Of course, nowadays, if we study the humanities alone, we are liable to miss many opportunities. Each one of us needs to become as technically and professionally skilled as possible to meet the needs of modern life. In fact, increasingly a pairing of technical knowledge and inner insight is seen as the ideal in the establishment of a career. If I were the Dean of Admissions at a medical school and two people applied to our school, both having the required basic science courses, one a philosophy major and the other solely a pre-med student, the philosophy applicant would be chosen.

10 In summary, the humanities help to create well-rounded human beings with insight and understanding of the passions, hopes, and dreams common to all humanity. The humanities, the ancient timeless reservoir of knowledge, teach us to see things differently and broaden our horizons. They are as useful and relevant in our modern age as they have always been. Doesn't it make sense to spend some time in the company of the humanities, our outstanding and remarkable treasure of knowledge?

(798 words)

out of date?



New words

▲ accounting /əˈkaʊntɪŋ/ *n.* [U] the work of accountants or the methods they use 会计；会计学

▲ boost /buːst/ *vt.* increase or improve sth. and make it more successful 促进；推动；使兴旺

▲ prospect /ˈprɒspekt/ *n.* [C, U] the possibility that sth. will happen 可能性；希望

▲ defect /dɪˈfekt/

vi. leave a country, political party, etc., esp. in order to join an opposing one 背叛；叛逃

n. [C] a fault in sb. or sth. 缺点；欠缺；不足之处

▲ bet /bet/ **(bet, bet)**

vt. be fairly sure that sth. is true, that sth. will happen, etc., although you cannot prove this 肯定

v. risk money on the result of a race, game, competition, or other future event 赌；与…打赌

▲ persist /pəˈsɪst/

vi. (*fml.*) continue to exist 继续存在；持续

v. continue to do sth., although this is difficult, or other people oppose it 坚持；执意

▲ accelerate /əkˈseləreɪt/ *v.* happen or make sth. happen at a faster rate（使）加快；促进

▲ succession /səkˈseʃən/ *n.*

1 **(in ~)** happening one after the other without anything different happening in between 连续不断；一个接一个

2 [sing.] a series of people or things of the same type 一连串，一系列（同类型的人或物）

▲ liberal /ˈlɪbərəl/ *a.* accepting different opinions and ways of behaving and tending to be sympathetic to other people 心胸宽广的；开明的

liberal arts *n.* [pl.] (*esp. AmE*) the areas of learning which develop sb.'s ability to think and increase their general knowledge, rather than developing technical skills 文科

▲ logical /ˈlɒdʒɪkəl/ *a.* connecting ideas or reasons in a sensible way 合乎逻辑的；合理的

▲ bound /baʊnd/ *a.* **(~ to do / be sth.)** certain or likely to happen, or to do or be sth. 一定会；很可能会

▲ dominant /ˈdɒmɪnənt/ *a.* more important, powerful, or successful than the other people or things of the same type 有优势的；占统治地位的

▲ pillar /ˈpɪlə/ *n.* [C]

1 a very important part of a system of beliefs or ideas（信仰或思想的）支柱，核心

2 a thick strong upright post that supports part of a building 柱子；支柱

▲ vivid /ˈvɪvɪd/ *a.* having or producing very clear and detailed images in the mind 清晰的；生动的

▲ compelling /kəmˈpelɪŋ/ *a.* interesting or exciting enough to keep your attention completely 有强烈吸引力的；引人入胜的；令人激动的

▲ promote /prəˈməʊt/ *vt.* support or encourage sth. 支持；鼓励；提倡

▲ speculate /ˈspekjəleɪt/ *v.* form an opinion about sth. without knowing all the details or facts 推测；猜测；推断

▲ destruction /dɪˈstrʌkʃən/ *n.* [U] damage that is so severe that sth. stops existing or can never return to its normal state 毁灭；摧毁；破坏

self-destruction *n.* [U] the act of doing things to deliberately harm yourself 自毁

▲ conscious /ˈkɒnʃəs/ *a.*

1 conscious thoughts, memories, etc. are ones which you know about（思想、记忆等）有意识的，意识到的，知道的

2 (*not before noun*) noticing or realizing sth. 注意到的；意识到的

unconscious /ʌnˈkɒnʃəs/ *a.*

1 an unconscious feeling or thought is one that you do not realize you have（感情或想法）无

意识的，不自觉的

2 in a condition similar to sleep in which you do not see, feel, or think, usu. because you are injured（通常因受伤而）失去知觉的，不省人事的

constructive /kənˈstrʌktɪv/ *a.* useful and helpful, or likely to produce good results 建设性的；积极的

▲ **philosopher** /fəˈlɒsəfə/ *n.* [C] sb. who studies and tries to explain the meaning of things such as life, knowledge, or beliefs 哲学家；哲人

▲ **myth** /mɪθ/ *n.* [C, U]

1 an ancient story, esp. one invented in order to explain natural or historical events（古代的）神话

2 an idea or story that many people believe, but which is not true（许多人相信的）错误观念，荒诞说法

▲ **landscape** /ˈlændskeɪp/ *n.* [C, usu. sing.] everything you can see when you look across an area of land, including hills, rivers, buildings, trees, and plants（陆上的）风景，景致，景色

▲ **likewise** /ˈlaɪkwaɪz/ *ad.* (*fml.*) in the same way 同样地；相似地

▲ **elegant** /ˈeləgənt/ *a.*

1 (of a plan or an idea) clever but simple（计划或想法）简练的，简洁的，简明的

2 beautiful, attractive, or graceful 优美的；高雅的

spectacular /spekˈtækjələ/ *a.* extremely impressive 引人入胜的；非常壮观的

▲ **invest** /ɪnˈvest/ *v.* use your money with the aim of making a profit from it 投资

▲ **insight** /ˈɪnsaɪt/ *n.*

1 [U] the ability to notice and understand a lot about people or situations 洞察力；领悟力

2 [C, U] an understanding of what sth. is like 洞悉；了解

▲ **awareness** /əˈweənəs/ *n.* [U] knowledge or understanding of a particular subject or situation 认识；意识

self-awareness *n.* [U] knowledge and understanding of yourself 自知；自我了解；自我认识

▲ **thereby** /ðeəˈbaɪ/ *ad.* (*fml.*) because of or by means of what has just been mentioned 因此；从而；借此

▲ **scope** /skəʊp/ *n.* [U] the range of things that a subject, activity, book, etc. deals with（学科、活动、书籍等的）范围

martial /ˈmɑːʃəl/ *art* *n.* [C, usu. pl.] any of the fighting sports that include judo and karate 武术

▲ **undertake** /ˌʌndəˈteɪk/ *vt.* (**undertook, undertaken**) agree to be responsible for a job or project and do it 承担；着手做

▲ **candidate** /ˈkændədət/ *n.* [C] sb. who is being considered for a job or is competing in an election 候选人；申请者

mathematician /ˌmæθəməˈtɪʃən/ *n.* [C] sb. who studies or teaches mathematics, or is a specialist in mathematics 数学家；数学教师

▲ **barrier** /ˈbæriə/ *n.* [C] anything that prevents progress or makes it difficult for sb. to achieve sth. 障碍

▲ **liable** /ˈlaɪəbəl/ *a.* (**~ to do sth.**) likely to do or say sth. or to behave in a particular way, esp. because of a fault or natural tendency 可能（或易于）做某事的

▲ **ideal** /ˌaɪˈdɪəl/

a. the best or most suitable that sth. could possibly be 理想的；最好的；最合适的

n. [C] a principle about what is morally right or a perfect standard that you hope to achieve 理想

▲ **dean** /diːn/ *n.* [C] a senior official at a college or university（学院或大学的）院长，系主任，教务长

▲ **solely** /ˈsəʊlli/ *ad.* involving nothing except the person or thing mentioned 只；唯一地；仅仅

▲ **applicant** /ˈæplɪkənt/ *n.* [C] sb. who has formally asked, usu. in writing, for a job, university place, etc. 申请人

reservoir /ˈrezəvwɑː/ *n.* [C]

1 a large quantity of sth. that can be used 积蓄；储备

2 an artificial or natural lake where water is stored so that it can be supplied to the houses in an area（人造的）水库；（天然）蓄水湖

▲ **outstanding** /aʊtˈstændɪŋ/ *a.* extremely good or impressive 杰出的；出众的；显著的

Phrases and expressions

stand up for support or defend a person or idea when they are being attacked 支持；捍卫；维护

speculate about / on make guesses about the possible causes or effects of sth. 猜测；推测

capture sb.'s imagination make sb. feel very interested in sth. 引起某人的想象

in the form of in the way sth. is or appears to be 以…形式；以…方式

a body of sth. a large amount or mass of sth., esp. sth. that has been collected 大量的某物

invest ... with sth. (*fml.*) give sb. or sth. a particular quality 赋予…以（某种性质）

in a ... manner in the way in which sth. is done or happens 以…方式；以…方法

in favor of

1 supporting a person or an idea, proposal, etc. that you believe is right 支持；赞同

2 in exchange for another thing (because the other thing is better or you want it more) 为了支持…

prepare sb. for make sb. ready and able to deal with a future event 使…做好准备（来应对未来）

in the company of with sb. or sth. 和…在一起；陪伴；伴随

Proper names

Sigmund Freud /ˈsɪgmənd ˌfrɔɪd/ 西格蒙德·弗洛伊德（1856—1939，奥地利精神病医生、精神分析学家，精神分析学派的创始人）

Sally Ride /ˈsæli ˌraɪd/ 萨莉·赖德（1951—2012，美国物理学家，曾是美国宇航员）

Bruce Lee /ˌbruːs ˈliː/ 李小龙（1940—1973，美籍华人，武术技击家、武术哲学家和电影演员）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Why do many students think they can't major in English or history?
- A They don't think English and history are as good as accounting.
- B They think English and history are relatively unpopular majors.
- C They want to study something that can help them easily land a job.
- D They want to study accounting as this can help them build their career.

2 Why is college education increasingly seen as a means of economic betterment according to the text?
- A Many students have shouldered the ever-rising cost of tuition.
- B Many students have run away from the study of the humanities.
- C Many students can't afford the high cost of tuition and have dropped out.
- D Many students have started to take "hard-skill" courses for employment.

3 How come labs are more compelling than libraries these days?
- A Libraries are now not as modern as science labs.
- B Libraries have stricter restrictions to students than labs.
- C More students are interested in working in the labs.
- D More students major in science than in the humanities.

4 What has captured our imagination from the very beginning?
- A The inner drive of human beings.
- B The foundation of civilization.
- C The development of artistic "languages".
- D The very true value of the humanities.

5 Why do we need the ability to read and write?
- A We need to come up with complex ideas.
- B We need to improve our analysis of life.
- C We need the ability to study the humanities.
- D We need the ability to benefit us in life.

6 How can we release our creative energy and talent in a positive manner?
- A By analyzing great ideas clearly and simply.
- B By gaining great insight and self-awareness.
- C By having the ability to produce a brand.
- D By getting familiar with complex ideas.

7 What is the most important value of studying the humanities?
- A It improves our ability to read and write.
- B It familiarizes us with the language of emotion.
- C It opens up a world of possibilities to us.
- D It enables us to create a spectacular brand.

8 Why are we likely to miss many opportunities if we study the humanities alone?
- A Employers prefer students with technical knowledge.
- B Modern life requires both technical knowledge and inner insight.
- C Science students have better logical thinking and hands-on skills.
- D Humanities students can write well but cannot think critically.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 How would you distinguish between a product and a brand?
2 In what ways does studying the humanities help students gain self-awareness?
3 Is the mathematics major likely to lead to a job as a mathematician? Why or why not?
4 Besides what's mentioned in the text, what other advantages can students get from taking courses in the humanities?
5 Should colleges give more support to the study of the humanities? Why or why not?

Collocation

More language exercises

This unit continues exploring students' academic life: the significance of the choice of a major and the humanity studies. We can learn from this unit that choosing a college major requires a ***lengthy process*** (Text A) as well as ***career consideration*** (Text A). The process of ***prolonged hesitation*** (Text A) can make students feel distressed and ***completely frustrated*** (Text A), but you never know, sometimes it may bring students a ***sudden realization*** (Text A) of what they really want. Also, we can learn from this unit that studying the humanities invests students with such merits and potentials as ***creative talent*** (Text B), ***great insight*** (Text B), ***creative energy*** (Text B), and the ability of ***elegant analysis*** (Text B). With the help of the ***dominant pillar*** (Text B) of the humanities and in a ***constructive manner*** (Text B), they'll surely make breakthroughs.

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
fairly	realization
perfect	manner
lack	topic
positive	advanced
sudden	confidence
thought-provoking	balance

4 Read the extracts about the choice of a major and the humanities from a university newspaper. Replace the wrong italicized words with the correct ones from the texts.

How should a student go about choosing a college major? It's an essential and 1) *thoughtful* _____ topic for every college student. Major choice involves 2) *work* _____ consideration. Warnings from parents, advisors, and the news media suggest that whatever major students choose will decide where they end up. Whether true or not, if students 3) *reduce* _____ confidence, they will probably have a negative sentiment in the end, because suddenly they're not just choosing a major but their ultimate fate. To overcome this feeling, they need to adopt a(n) 4) *perfect* _____ manner. They can think seriously about what they really want to do and talk to people in the fields they're interested in to get a second opinion. Their 5) *postponed* _____ hesitation won't help them; it may make them feel completely 6) *scared* _____.

— Laura Davis

It is clear that the goal of education is to cultivate students' 7) *huge* _____ insights and enable students to better serve their country. Though some say that it's hard to find a job with a humanities degree, the humanities are the 8) *master* _____ pillar of university life that helps students grow. The humanities invest us with creative talent and release our 9) *clever* _____ energy. We need engineers who can respect individual and cultural differences and who can communicate effectively after a(n) 10) *fine* _____ analysis. In short, we must have a(n) 11) *great* _____ balance in the knowledge of science and the humanities and apply our critical thinking skills in the 12) *long* _____ process of great learning.

— Johnny Macy

Stories of China

As he dropped out of school at 16, worked as a security guard at 22, and graduated with a Ph.D. at 41, Li Mingyong has made his life story inspirational. Looking back at his life journey, he said with emotion, "I hope my story can touch the hearts of students and help them learn to grow in difficult situations."

Born in 1977 in a poverty-stricken village in Zunyi, Guizhou Province, Li was excellent at school. However, because of his poor family background, after graduating from junior high, he had to stop his schooling and go out to work.

Li worked as a cement worker at construction sites in Guiyang, the capital of Guizhou. But the hard work didn't pay much. How could he help his family pay off their debts? He decided to go back home to help his father breed ducks. Father and son worked hard for three years and the family was finally able to clear their debts. It was a big relief to Li, so he returned to Guiyang to seek new job opportunities.

This time he became a security guard at the Guizhou Institute of Education (now Guizhou Education University). It was this job as a security guard at the college that enabled him to broaden his horizons. Influenced by the academic atmosphere on campus, 22-year-old Li made up his mind to continue his path to education.

To work and study at the same time is challenging, so every day he would snatch two hours of study after he got off work at 11:00 at night. He persevered in this way for two years till he passed the adult college entrance exam and was accepted by the Chinese Department of Guizhou Institute of Education in 2001. Two years later, he became an undergraduate, majoring in Chinese. In 2005, he graduated with a B.A.



He could have found a decent job with his B.A. degree, but his dream was to become a university teacher, so he started to prepare for the graduate entrance exam. To improve his English, he memorized an 8,000-word English dictionary. In 2007, he got first place in the written exam and was accepted by Guizhou University. After he got his master's degree in aesthetics (美学), Li returned to his alma mater (母校), Guizhou Education University, to work as a counselor.

At this point, in the eyes of many people, Li had already achieved an enviable miracle, but he did not stop there. He continued to study while working. In 2015, he entered a Ph.D. program in Central China Normal University and graduated in 2018. With his Ph.D., he returned to Guizhou Education University to become a university lecturer of aesthetics.

His journey to receiving a Ph.D. took him 18 years, starting from 2001 when he was accepted as a student of Chinese. Don't assume he never failed. In fact, he failed many times, but he never gave up! He knew how to forge ahead through rocky roads and learn things the hard way. He has made his dream come true through his strong determination and remarkable persistence.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 改革开放以来，中国的教育事业得到了快速发展，并取得了引人瞩目的成就。

2 中国的教育成就主要反映在九年义务教育（nine-year compulsory education）的全面普及（popularization）和高等教育大众化的实现。

3 我们将深入实施科教兴国（invigorating China through science and education）战略，坚持教育优先发展，为党育人、为国育才，全面提高人才自主培养质量。

Unit project

Writing a survey report on Chinese students' choice of majors

Many college students have experienced prolonged hesitation in choosing a college major. To them, this particular life experience is important and unforgettable. Even now they would still mention it or keep rewinding the episodes. You may be one of them!

This unit project, therefore, provides an opportunity for you to interview your classmates and write a survey report on Chinese students' choice of majors. Writing the report will improve your critical thinking skills.

Step 1 **Complete the survey by interviewing one classmate. Check (✓) the statements that your interviewee agrees with.**

1 It took me a long time to choose a major that I was really interested in.
2 My parents put me under much pressure when I wanted to choose the major I like.
3 I hesitated about whether to choose a science major or liberal arts major.
4 I was confused and tried to seek advice from my friends and classmates.
5 I tried to find out more about the program before making a decision.
6 Now I still ask myself if I made the right decision on the major I finally picked up.
7 I kind of regret choosing my major because I find I don't have passion for it.
8 I'm not passionate about my major but don't know what would suit me better.
9 I'm thinking about changing my major but worry it will postpone my graduation.
10 I wonder if my major will benefit me in achieving my life goals.

Step 2 **Work in groups and share the result of your survey with others to see what statements in the survey get more checks. Then choose three that get the most checks.**

Step 3 **Based on the group findings, write a short report of about 5-6 sentences.**
In the report, first summarize the survey and then give your opinions about the survey result. You may comment on the three statements that had the most checks and provide some advice or suggestions.

Step 4 **Share your report with your group members.**
You may either read out your own report or switch with another classmate and read out theirs. In this way, you can learn something from each other. If time allows, give feedback on each other's reports in terms of content and language.

Unit 3

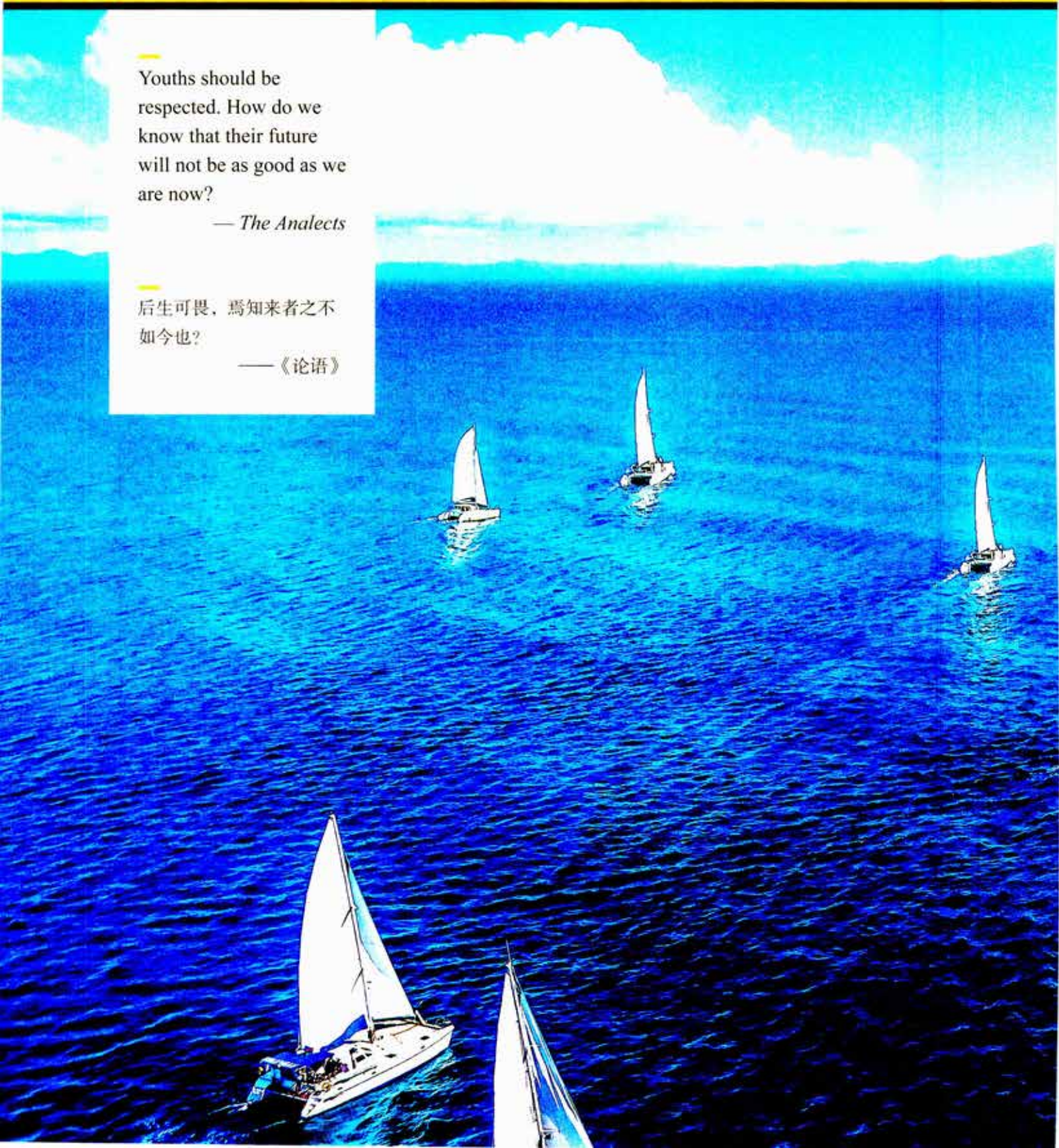
The young generation: making a difference

Youths should be respected. How do we know that their future will not be as good as we are now?

— *The Analects*

后生可畏，焉知来者之不如今也？

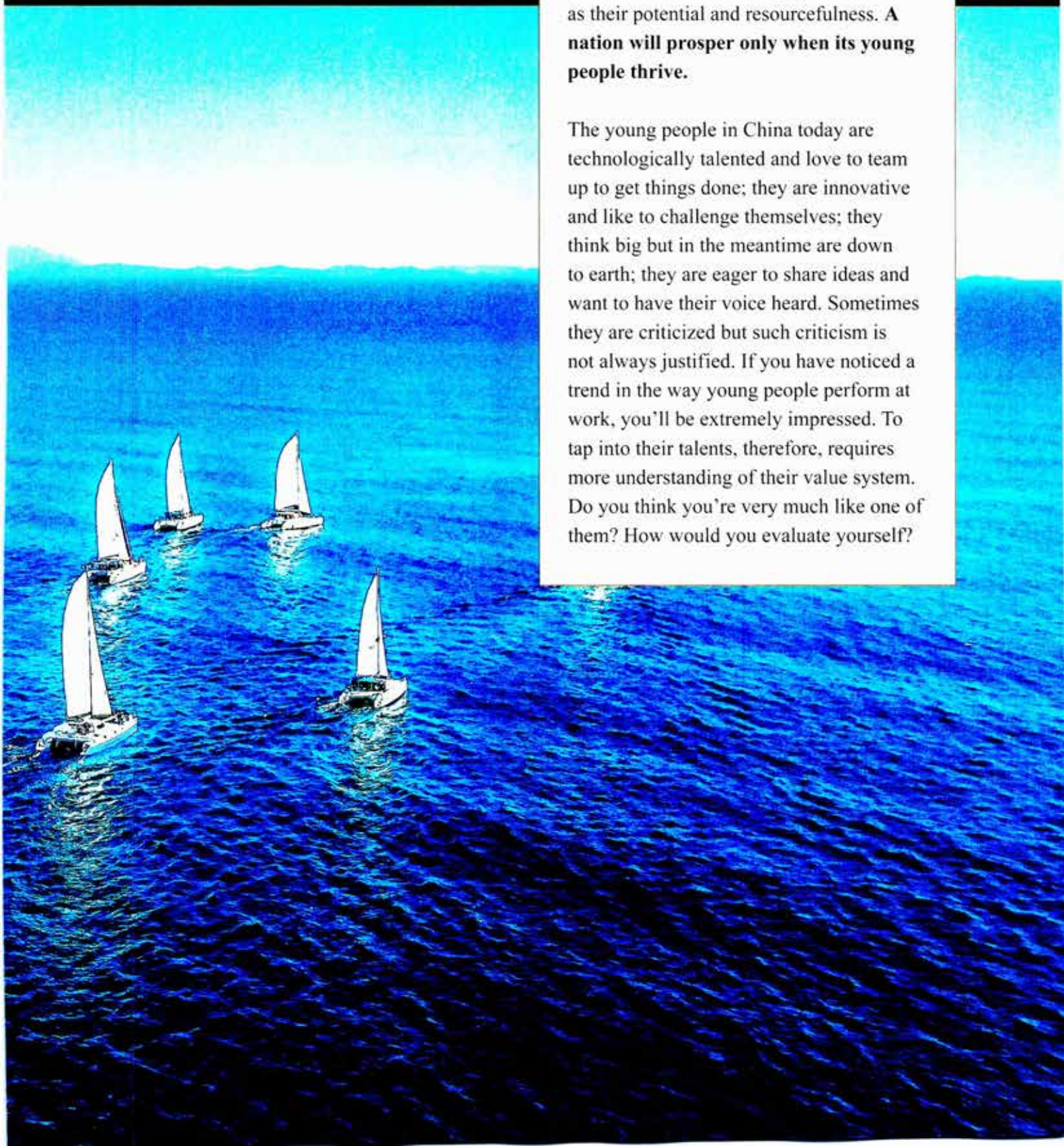
——《论语》



Preview

Who will be the master of the world tomorrow? Undoubtedly, the young generation, for their strong passion, as well as their potential and resourcefulness. **A nation will prosper only when its young people thrive.**

The young people in China today are technologically talented and love to team up to get things done; they are innovative and like to challenge themselves; they think big but in the meantime are down to earth; they are eager to share ideas and want to have their voice heard. Sometimes they are criticized but such criticism is not always justified. If you have noticed a trend in the way young people perform at work, you'll be extremely impressed. To tap into their talents, therefore, requires more understanding of their value system. Do you think you're very much like one of them? How would you evaluate yourself?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 What would you expect and want in terms of your future career? Look at the following list and check (✓) the ones that apply to you.

- ☐ 1 To share ideas and work in a team.
- ☐ 2 To practice entrepreneurship with my passion and knowledge.
- ☐ 3 To get opportunities to experiment and innovate.
- ☐ 4 To have my voice heard and my suggestions carry weight.
- ☐ 5 To be encouraged to learn from senior co-workers.
- ☐ 6 To gain work experience through doing problem-solving tasks.
- ☐ 7 To have flexible working hours and be able to work from home sometimes.
- ☐ 8 To work close to my home so that I can take better care of my family.
- ☐ 9 To have regular working hours and routines.
- ☐ 10 To have freedom to complete work in my own way.

2 Look at the pictures which depict the daily work life of a young girl named Nancy. Then write up 7-8 sentences to describe her feelings about work.



Your writing may begin with:

Nancy graduated from college one year ago and is now working with some lovely people in a company. She really enjoys her work though it's challenging …

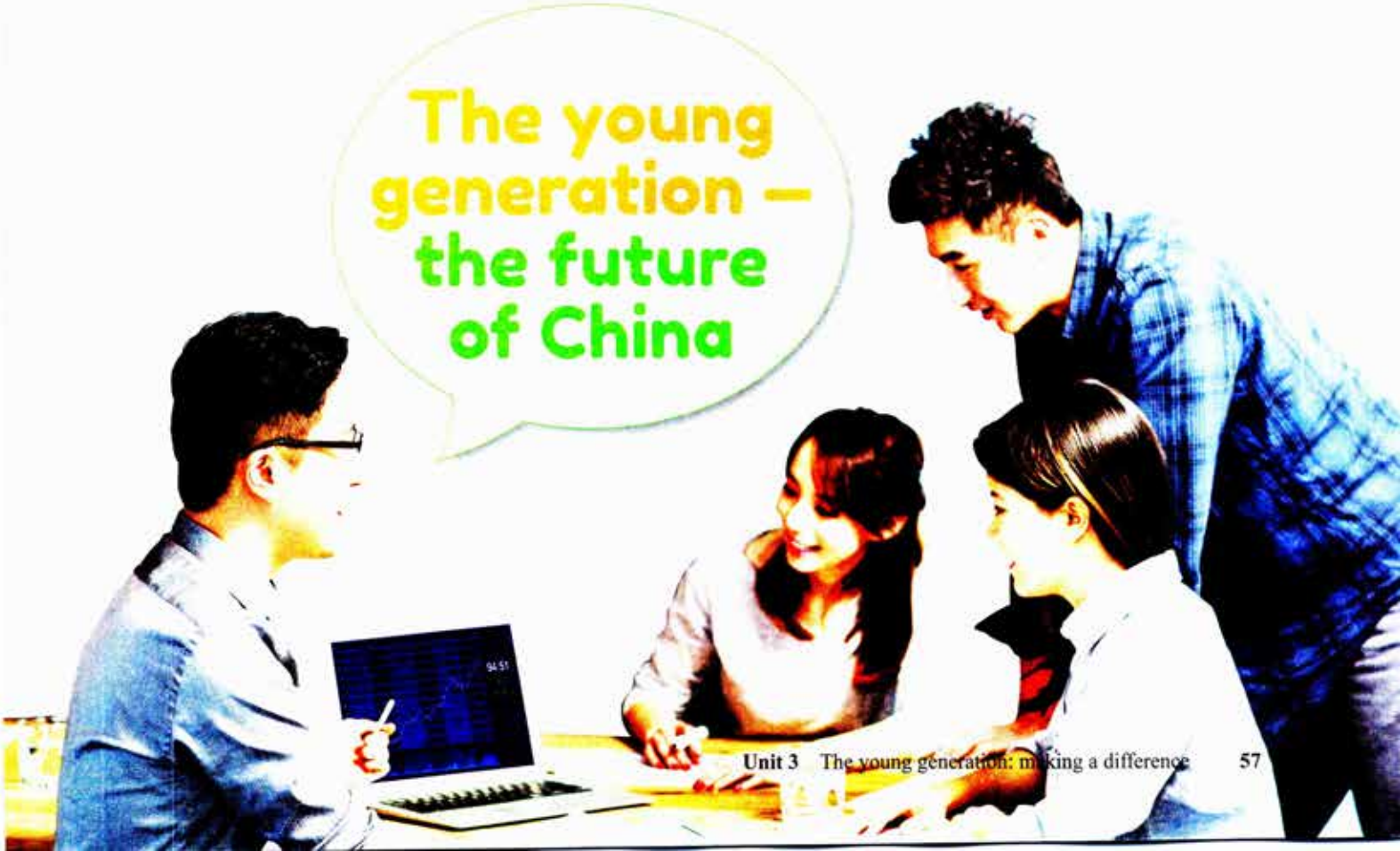
Text A

1 If I ask you, "Have you ever used instant messaging apps?", you would probably respond, "It's a must." Yes, people take it for granted because these apps have already become part of their daily life. They would rather use instant messaging than email to conduct their daily activities. The apps offer everything from free video calls and instant group chats to news updates and easy access to large multimedia files. In addition to the chat service, people are accustomed to using the apps to shop online, pay for goods at stores, settle utility bills, and attend online meetings, just with a few taps. It's no exaggeration to say that life in China today would be unthinkable without instant messaging apps.

2 But what makes these apps tick with the masses? You may shrug your shoulders. Here is the secret sauce: The young generation in China created the perfect, user-friendly apps that meet people's needs. They are working tirelessly with their strong passion, amazing talents, unique work style, and high aspirations.

3 It sounds incredible that these young people, most born in the 1990s, have transformed people's lives in every sector. No kidding! When tech companies recruit new employees for their fantastic platforms, they usually prefer fresh graduates – those newly graduated from college. Why? Young people usually have a stronger passion for entrepreneurship. They are more persevering and more willing to endure hardship. Likewise, they don't fear failure and don't want to just observe. They want to participate and be part of the action. Their internal driving force has little to do with money. What makes them happy and passionate is when they see their products have changed the lives of many people. Listen to their passionate cry, "NEW era, NEW revolution. I am a MAKER, for the DREAM in my heart."

The young generation – the future of China



4 These young people admire creativity but dislike the traditional top-down management. "I am the boss and you'll do as I say" is becoming much less effective. Instead, they prefer teamwork and love to share. One typical example is "Shake", an innovation not from a top-down assigned task but from young peers' instinctive sense at a dining table. While having a meal together, some young people wanted to add each other to their friend circle, but they thought it was too troublesome to search for the user names. Someone suggested, "Why don't we all shake our phones together?" Then came the innovative feature of "Shake". In these talented work teams, this kind of invaluable suggestion is quite common.

5 Furthermore, their work style is not conventional either. They don't care about the traditional nine-to-five work hours. With the sufficient support from their companies, the young innovators are now enjoying a relatively free work-time system: no punch-in or punch-out; no fixed-time shifts. The time schedules are very flexible. That's why their office buildings can be very quiet and almost empty in the morning, but in the afternoon the atmosphere becomes more active, and in the evening the buildings are brightly lit – the most vigorous time of the day for these teams. This is actually a win-win situation. These young people, with a strong work ethic, really enjoy the new system; likewise, the companies are more than happy to see the high work efficiency delivered by these young people.

6 Paralleling their passion, talents, and work style are their high aspirations. They're eager to exhibit the will to voice their individual and collective ideas as to what to do or what not to do. Besides wanting their views to carry weight, they also think big and aim high. Their persistence in practicing the spirit of entrepreneurship is stunning. They prefer to enhance their performance and gain more experience through working in collective dynamics. Moreover, these young people don't want to innovate just for the sake of innovation. What they do and strive for is based on the needs of their users and something valuable to their customers. It is this goal that stirs the heart of these young people and has brought them huge success – the various functionalities of the apps are now seamlessly woven into the fabric of people's daily life.

7 Undoubtedly, today's young generation is at the dawn of China's tomorrow. If the incredible story of these young app developers, in a way, just unpacks China's technical innovation and success, a new wave of young Chinese has already taken flight with the wing of China's economic growth. These young people are part of the inventive firms emerging from China. The contributions they have made are remarkable. Companies that are ready to tap into their potential will attract, motivate, and retain very capable young employees who are resourceful and globally minded. It can be perceived that this young generation will become leaders of businesses and lead China to a brighter future. Industries and consumers around the world will soon feel their impact.

(*814 words*)

New words

▲ **grant** /grɑːnt/ *vt.*

1 **[take it for ~ed (that)]** believe that sth. is true without making sure 想当然地认为；认为…是理所当然

2 **(take sb. / sth. for ~ed)** expect that sb. or sth. will always be there when you need them and never think how important or useful they are 视某人 / 某事为理所当然（而对其不重视）

▲ **conduct** /kənˈdʌkt/

vt. carry out a particular activity or process, esp. in order to get information or prove facts （尤指为获取信息或证实某事时）进行，实施，执行

v. stand in front of a group of musicians or singers and direct their playing or singing 指挥

▲ **accustomed** /əˈkʌstəmd/ *a.* **[be ~ to (doing) sth.]** be familiar with sth. and accept it as normal 习惯于（做）某事

▲ **utility** /juːˈtɪləti/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.] a public service such as gas, water, or electricity that is used by everyone（煤气、水、电等的）公共服务，公用事业

▲ **exaggeration** /ɪgˌzædʒəˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] a statement or way of saying sth. that makes sth. seem better, larger, etc. than it really is 夸张；夸大；言过其实

▲ **shrug** /ʃrʌg/ *v.* raise and then lower your shoulders in order to show that you do not know sth. or do not care about sth. 耸（肩）（表示不知道或不在乎）

▲ **sector** /ˈsektə/ *n.* [C] a part of an area of activity, esp. of business, trade, etc.（尤指商业、贸易等领域的）部门，行业

▲ **recruit** /rɪˈkruːt/ *v.*

1 find new people to work in a company, join an organization, do a job, etc. 招聘；吸收，招收（新成员）

2 get people to join the army, navy, etc. 招募（新兵）

▲ **employee** /ɪmˈplɔɪiː/ *n.* [C] sb. who is paid to work for sb. else 受雇者；雇员

▲ **entrepreneur** /ˌɒntrəprəˈnɜː/ *n.* [C] sb. who starts a new business or arranges business deals in order to make money, often in a way that involves financial risks 企业家

entrepreneurship /ˌɒntrəprəˈnɜːʃɪp/ *n.* [U] the state of being an entrepreneur, or the activities associated with being an entrepreneur 企业家（身份、行为）；企业家精神

▲ **persevere** /ˌpɜːsəˈvɪə/ *vi.* continue trying to achieve sth. difficult 锲而不舍；坚持不懈

persevering /ˌpɜːsəˈvɪərɪŋ/ *a.* determined to continue trying to achieve sth. difficult 坚持不懈的；锲而不舍的

▲ **endure** /ɪnˈdjʊə/

vt. be in a difficult or painful situation for a long time without complaining 忍耐；忍受

vi. remain alive or continue to exist for a long time 生活下去；持续存在

▲ **internal** /ɪnˈtɜːnl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*)

1 existing or happening in your mind 内心的；精神的

2 existing or happening within a country, not between different countries 国内的；本国的

▲ **innovation** /ˌɪnəˈveɪʃən/ *n.* [C] a new idea, method, or invention 新观念；新方法；新发明

▲ **assign** /əˈsaɪn/ *vt.*

1 give sb. a particular job or make them responsible for a particular person or thing 分配，分派，指派（任务）

2 give money, equipment, etc. to sb. to use 分配，分派（资金、设备等）

▲ **feature** /ˈfiːtʃə/ *n.* [C]
1 a part of sth. that you notice because it seems important, interesting, or typical 特点；特征；特色
2 a piece of writing about a subject in a newspaper or magazine, or a special report on television or on the radio（报纸或杂志的）特写；（电视或广播的）专题节目

▲ **invaluable** /ɪnˈvæljuəbəl/ *a.* extremely useful 极有价值的

▲ **furthermore** /ˌfɜːðəˈmɔː/ *ad.* (*fml.*) in addition to what has already been said 此外；而且；不仅如此；更有甚者

▲ **conventional** /kənˈvenʃənəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*) of the usual, traditional, or accepted type, instead of being new and different 常例的；传统的；因袭的

▲ **sufficient** /səˈfɪʃənt/ *a.* (*fml.*) as much as is needed for a particular purpose 足够的；充分的

▲ **shift** /ʃɪft/ *n.* [C]
1 a period of work time in a factory, hospital, or other place where some people work during the day and some work at night 轮班工作时间
2 a change in sth., e.g. in sb.'s ideas or opinions 改变；变化

▲ **schedule** /ˈʃedjuːl/
n. [C] a plan of what sb. is going to do and when they are going to do it 计划表；进度表；日程表
vt. plan that sth. will happen at a particular time 排定；把…安排在；预定

▲ **flexible** /ˈfleksəbəl/ *a.* able to change to suit new conditions or situations 能适应新情况的；灵活的；可变动的

▲ **vigorous** /ˈvɪgərəs/ *a.*
1 characterized by or done with force and energy 强有力的；积极的
2 strong and healthy 强健的；精力旺盛的

▲ **ethic** /ˈeθɪk/ *n.* [C] a general idea or belief that influences people's behavior and attitudes 伦理；道德体系

work ethic *n.* [sing.] a belief in the moral value and importance of work 职业道德

▲ **parallel** /ˈpærəlel/
vt. be similar to sth.; happen at the same time as sth. 与…相似；与…同时发生
a. being an equal distance apart everywhere 平行的

▲ **exhibit** /ɪgˈzɪbɪt/
vt. (*fml.*) clearly show a particular quality, emotion, or ability 展示，显示（品质、情感或能力）
v. show sth. in a public place so that people can go to see it 展出；展览

▲ **collective** /kəˈlektɪv/ *a.* (*only before noun*) shared or made by every member of a group or society 集体的；共同的；共有的

▲ **persistence** /pəˈsɪstəns/ *n.* [U]
1 determination to do sth. even though it is difficult or other people oppose it 坚持；执着；执意
2 when sth. continues to exist or happen, esp. for longer than is usual or desirable 持续存在；维持

stunning /ˈstʌnɪŋ/ *a.*
1 very surprising or shocking 令人惊奇的；令人震惊的
2 extremely attractive or beautiful 极具吸引力的；极漂亮的

▲ **enhance** /ɪnˈhɑːns/ *vt.* improve sth. 改善；改进

▲ **strive** /straɪv/ *vi.* (**strove, striven**) (*fml.*) make a great effort to achieve sth. 努力；奋斗

▲ **stir** /stɜː/ *vt.*
1 make sb. have a strong feeling or reaction 激发，激起（强烈的感情）；引起（强烈的反应）

2 move a liquid or substance around with a spoon or stick in order to mix it together 搅；搅拌；搅动

functionality /ˌfʌŋkʃəˈnæləti/ *n.* [C, U] one or all of the operations that a computer, software program, or piece of equipment is able to perform（计算机、软件或设备的）功能

seamlessly /ˈsiːmləsli/ *ad.*

1 smoothly that you cannot tell where one thing stops and another begins 流畅地；浑然一体地

2 without any seams 无缝地

▲ weave /wiːv/ *v.* (**wove, woven**) make cloth, a carpet, a basket, etc. by crossing threads or thin pieces under and over each other by hand or on a loom 编；织

▲ fabric /ˈfæbrɪk/ *n.*

1 [sing.] (**the ~**) (*fml.*) the basic structure of a society, an organization, etc. that enables it to function successfully（社会、机构等的）结构

2 [C, U] cloth used for making clothes, curtains, etc. 衣料；织物

▲ motivate /ˈməʊtɪveɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sb. want to achieve sth. and make them willing to work hard in order to do this 激发；激励；促进

2 be the reason why sb. does sth. 成为…的动机

▲ retain /rɪˈteɪn/ *vt.* (*fml.*)

1 continue to employ sb. as a worker for a long time 留用（员工）

2 keep sth. or continue to have sth. 保留；保有；继续拥有

▲ resourceful /rɪˈzɔːsfəl/ *a.* good at finding ways of dealing with practical problems 足智多谋的；机智的

▲ perceive /pəˈsiːv/ *vt.* understand or think of sth. or sb. in a particular way（以某种方式）看待，理解

Phrases and expressions

no exaggeration (to say ... / that ...) no overstatement 毫不夸张；并非言过其实

have a passion for sth. have a strong liking for sth. 酷爱；热爱

for the sake of in order to help, improve, or please sb. or sth. 为了…（的缘故）

strive for make a great effort to achieve sth. or accomplish certain goals 为实现…而奋斗（或努力）

be based on use sth. as the thing from which sth. else is developed 以…为基础；以…为根据

tap into use or take what is needed from sth. 利用；发掘；开发

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why do people say "it's a must" when responding to the question about using instant messaging apps?
2 Who makes instant messaging apps work so well and become so popular?
3 Why do tech companies prefer to hire fresh graduates when recruiting new employees?
4 What do young employees dislike about management at work?
5 What does the invention of "Shake" by the young people illustrate?
6 Why does the author say that young people's work style is not conventional?
7 How do you know that these young employees have high aspirations?
8 Who will attract, motivate, and retain very capable young employees?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What could motivate people to join the work teams for instant messaging apps?
2 What are the most important factors that help the young app developers succeed?
3 Do you think the young app developers are representative of the young generation in China today? Give reasons.
4 What reasons can you think of to explain why the young generation is China's future?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

assign endure exhibit flexible
internal parallel persistence
recruit stunning vigorous

1 The boss said, "The schedule is completely _____ because I do not need to be around and watch when you do your work."
2 Currently, the stock market is not very stable, but over the long run, the growth of stock funds will _____ the growth of the economy.
3 These student volunteers can decide how to perform any _____ work, for which they are qualified and have a strong passion.
4 Human beings, by providing environmental enrichment, encourage animals to explore, interact, and _____ natural behaviors.
5 Along with extraordinary courage, qualities like _____, teamwork, and most importantly, leadership shine in all of our student activities.
6 This is a beautiful part of the city to live in, with stylish and architecturally _____ historic buildings lining the clean and quiet streets.
7 An energetic search will soon be put in place to _____ a qualified person who can continue with the leadership of a big company.
8 I've _____ hardships throughout my life, so I think I can handle the stress and achieve my full potential in this company.
9 Many people believe that _____ exercise and outdoor sports could better help people stay healthy and strong.
10 With the help of my family and friends, all of my _____ doubts about myself gradually disappeared and my confidence was restored.

Word building



与名词结合构成形容词。以这种方式构成的形容词通常表示与原名词事物相似的、有关的，或由原名词事物构成的。

cinema		cinematic
economy		economic
geometry	>	**geometric**
ocean		**oceanic**
poet		**poetic**



与动词结合构成名词。以这种方式构成的名词是指该动词描述的状态或过程，或该过程的实例。注意：-ion 的拼写有多种变体，常见的是 -ation、-ition、-sion 和 -tion。

hesitate		hesitation
protect		protection
assume	>	**assumption**
classify		**classification**
detect		**detection**



以后缀 -ist 结尾的名词通常指行为基于某种特定信念的人，或指从事特定工作的人。

novel		novelist
special	>	specialist
biology		**biologist**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

assumption　biologist　classification
detection　geometric　oceanic　poetic

1 The painter used _____ patterns in a creative way to depict the living and working scenes of the diligent Chinese people.
2 According to the media, the _____ Chinese dance *National Beauty* has spread the traditional Chinese culture to different parts of the world.
3 She is interested in _____ systems, especially the physical and chemical exchanges between the ocean and the atmosphere.
4 An analysis of ancient handprints found in some cave sites overturned the traditional _____ that most cave paintings were the work of men.
5 This security system was designed by a group of young technicians to detect some suspicious processes using a new _____ method.
6 Though I learned little about biology, my wife is a(n) _____ by profession, so this world is not completely strange and foreign to me.
7 Confronted with the growing garbage output and worsening environment, many countries are implementing the policy of garbage _____ with great effort.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A academic	F ethic	K persevering
B asserting	G innovated	L platform
C assuming	H motivated	M released
D dynamic	I obey	N remained
E emerged	J obsess	O retain

Ms. Wang has been happy with her new job with a software company. "It offers a big 1) _____ for me to develop, and I can learn much!" she said. Like Ms. Wang, a growing number of young Chinese workers are demanding that their voices be heard and 2) _____ themselves more in the workplace. Young people have become the main population in China's talent market, according to a report 3) _____ earlier this year. Therefore, many companies are doubling their efforts to attract and 4) _____ this vital group.

Raised in the time of great social and economic change in China, this generation has 5) _____ as well-educated, highly resourceful members of the workforce. They are often in search of better learning and career-development opportunities. A study of the generation found that of employees who 6) _____ with the same company for one to five years, more than 80 percent said that good career development was what 7) _____ them to stay with the company.

This generation doesn't just want to 8) _____ orders. They want to participate in decision-making. They question authority and are 9) _____ in what they're pursuing. If companies want to keep on these talented employees, they have to make the workplace more 10) _____. Many companies have taken significant steps to create more flexible working environments, in an attempt to encourage employees to stay longer with the company.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be accustomed to be based on
for the sake of have a passion for
no exaggeration strive for
take it for granted that tap into

1 The course project that I completed weeks ago has helped me _____ my creativity and intuition which I didn't even realize I had.
2 Many people probably _____ fast Internet access is almost everywhere – at home, at work, and even in the most remote areas.
3 It's probably true that we always _____ the goal that we consider challenging but achievable to gain a sense of accomplishment.
4 It's _____ to say that the kitchen he installed last month is 100 times better, and now I fortunately have the kitchen I dreamed of.
5 Since the exam _____ what you have learned, you can expect to see some questions from previous assignments.
6 I think journalists work in a timely manner and _____ daily deadlines or tight working schedules because they were well trained in this way.
7 The situation between us is very challenging, but we have to learn how to handle the difficult situation _____ improving our relations.
8 The award-winning chef says that since he was young, he _____ Chinese food because of its rich ingredients and well-balanced nutrition.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Focusing on an example essay

In this unit, you will learn how to write examples in an essay. Text A in this unit is a feature, or a special report, on the work teams for instant messaging apps. To elaborate, a feature usually focuses on particular people, places, and events. It covers topics in depth, going further than usual news articles, because it's not meant to report the latest breaking news but rather take an in-depth look at a particular subject. A good feature requires specific and lively examples, obtained from some background research, interviews, and observations.

In Text A, the author has included several vivid and impressive examples to effectively present the unique characteristics of the young people: their strong passion, amazing talents, unique work style, and high aspirations. Let's take a look at two paragraphs from Text A.

... these apps have already become part of their daily life. They would rather use instant messaging than email to conduct their daily activities. The apps offer everything from free video calls and instant group chats to news updates and easy access to large multimedia files. In addition to the chat service, people are accustomed to using the apps to shop online, pay for goods at stores, settle utility bills, and attend online meetings, just with a few taps ... (Para. 1)

These young people admire creativity but dislike the traditional top-down management ... One typical example is "Shake", an innovation not from a top-down assigned task but from young peers' instinctive sense at a dining table. While having a meal together, some young people wanted to add each other to their friend circle, but they thought it was too troublesome to search for the user names. Someone suggested, "Why don't we all shake our phones together?" Then came the innovative feature of "Shake" ... (Para. 4)

Para. 1 consists of short examples arranged in a series of seemingly discrete but actually related words and sentences. They all support the point that "these apps have already become part of their daily life". Para. 4, however, only contains one lengthy example of "Shake". It supports the point that "These young people admire creativity". You may use either method to effectively develop your essay.

Therefore, how many examples you need to include depends – some points require numerous examples and others can be effectively developed with a few. For instance, to illustrate the point "San Francisco has some of the most unusual sights in California", a few examples would be enough. Also, the examples you use should be representative – to fairly support your point. You don't want to include the irrelevant example of some beautiful beaches in Los Angeles to support your point.

In addition, to make examples specific and impressive, you'd better use descriptive words and direct speech if possible. Meanwhile, to achieve coherence, you need to pay attention to the order

of examples and proper use of transitions. The examples can be organized according to time, familiarity, and importance. And the shift from one example to the next shouldn't be abrupt so that the reader understands clearly the progression of thought.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops with examples.

Topic
Gender barriers

Introduction
Thesis statement: In the U.S., female employees today are still facing many challenges, especially gender barriers.

Body
1 A double standard for men and women
Example 1: "cold-hearted" women
Example 2: "behaving improperly" vs. "having a strong character"
2 An unfair sentiment toward women
Example: when a woman gets promoted

Conclusion
Female employees can be made to feel insecure in the workplace because of gender barriers.

Throughout history, women have been hard workers who place a high value on achievements at work. They often perceive their personal worth based upon how well they can perform their jobs. However, in the U.S., female employees today are still facing many challenges, especially gender barriers.

First of all, a double standard of behavior for men and women is still present in the workplace. Like it or not, people still have some notions of what is acceptable female behavior. For instance, women who work extra hard, try best to accomplish goals, and don't believe in weaknesses are considered "cold-hearted". Another example is that when a woman shows strength of character, she may be seen as "behaving improperly". However, if the same thing happens to a male, he is seen as "having a strong character".

In addition, because of an unfair sentiment toward women, they sometimes have to face harsh criticism no matter whether it's reasonable or not. One of the examples is that if a woman gets promoted, she could be accused of using her female charm unfairly. In other words, her promotion is not because of her hard work but because of her appearance.

To conclude, female employees in the U.S. can be made to feel insecure in the workplace because of gender barriers. They have to face a double standard of behavior for men and women; they have to deal with negative perceptions. Therefore, a change in attitudes toward women is a must now.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Young people in my eyes

Introduction

Thesis statement: As a generation, they're impressively open-minded and highly motivated.

Body

1 Their readiness to embrace new things
   Example: the new mindset of career choices
2 Their high aspirations
   Example: the work teams for instant messaging apps

Conclusion

Being open-minded and having high aspirations are the two important characteristics of the young generation.

More topics

- Young people: reshaping our society
- What motivates young people to strive and persevere

Section B

Reading skills

Predicting the author's ideas

One way to read effectively is to predict. Making predictions or anticipating the author's next point is an important skill in active reading. Although you may not be able to predict every detail and the author may surprise you with unexpected ideas, you can often anticipate the general direction in which the author is going. Making predictions while you read keeps your mind alert and involved with the reading passage. It's a way to double-check your comprehension of what you've read so far, and it can be a great aid to understanding what comes next. Let's read the first two paragraphs in Text A.

If I ask you, "Have you ever used instant messaging apps?", you would probably respond, "It's a must." Yes, people take it for granted because these apps have already become part of their daily life. They would rather use instant messaging than email to conduct their daily activities. The apps offer everything from free video calls and instant group chats to news updates and easy access to large multimedia files. In addition to the chat service, people are accustomed to using the apps to shop online, pay for goods at stores, settle utility bills, and attend online meetings, just with a few taps. It's no exaggeration to say that life in China today would be unthinkable without instant messaging apps. (Para. 1)

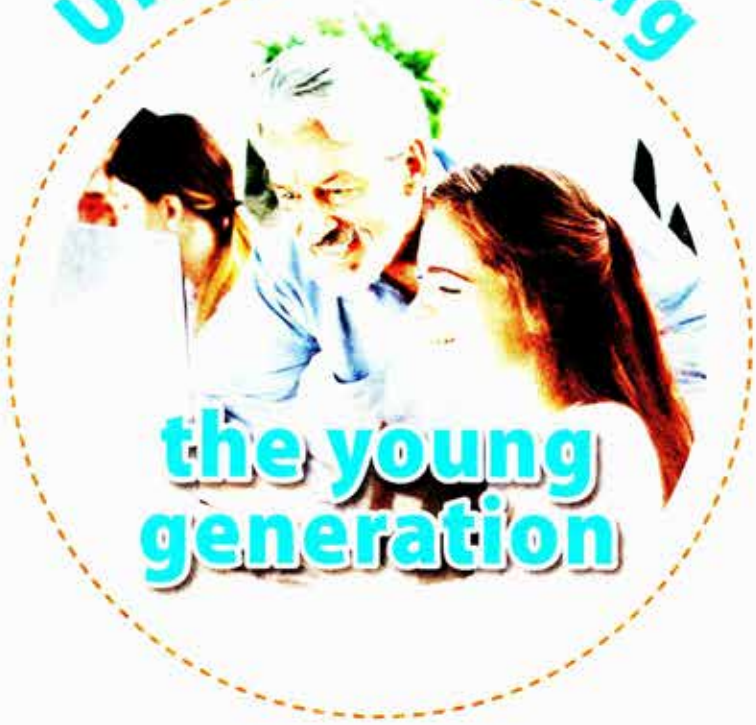
But what makes these apps tick with the masses? You may shrug your shoulders. Here is the secret sauce ... (Para. 2)

When reading the first sentence, you can predict right away that the text is about instant messaging apps. You may ask "Why could the answer be so sure?" and go on predicting the possible reasons for that. Your prediction could be right or wrong, but this won't be known till the next sentence: "Yes, people take it for granted because these apps have already become part of their daily life." Therefore, you always adjust or correct what you predicted, which helps you better comprehend the text. You keep asking questions, for example, "How have these apps become part of our daily life?". You can find the answer right there in the following sentences, namely the various uses of the apps. As soon as you read "what makes these apps tick with the masses?", you can immediately predict that what follows is a thesis statement. So making predictions is often a two-way communication since you need to interact with the text from time to time in the reading process.

1 Try to predict the general direction of the author's thinking in Text B. There are a few multiple-choice questions in the text to guide your comprehension. Be sure to answer them before you go on to the next section of the reading. Remember: Being accurate in your predictions isn't as important as the process of making predictions.

Text B

Understanding the young generation



1 Today's young generation simply can't imagine a world without the Internet or cell phones. They are gifted with technology and crazy about **artificial intelligence**. However, this is just one of their unique **characteristics**. They are also known as a generation that is **visual**, **idealistic**, and global. Society has been making little noises about this particular group, throwing criticism along their way to **maturity**. No matter whether these noises are **valid** or not, to fully tap into their strengths and resourcefulness, we need to be patient, **communicative**, and understanding.

Prediction 1

After reading the title and the first paragraph, you probably think the remaining part of the reading might be about _____.

A the public opinions about the young generation

B the success stories of the young generation

C the ways to get along with the young generation

2 To start with, we must be patient with the young generation, or some unexpected incidents may occur. Occasionally, we do see some young people who are not considerate of others. The following anecdote may, in a way, serve as **proof** and **illustrate** this characteristic some young people possess.

3 Staying at our cottage recently, my husband and I were joined by my 20-year-old niece and her three best **buddies** for four days. We listened a lot to their dreams and schemes, as well as their **self-evaluations**. We were so amazed at their **perceptive** views, their broad knowledge of the world, and their impressive **capability** to use their cell phones.

4 The young ladies decided to have a beach fire and spent the evening chatting and **renewing** friendships. They undoubtedly had a lot of fun at the beach that night, but the next day, when my husband tried to build a fire for me, gosh, he discovered, rather than dragging fire logs to the beach, the girls had burned every piece of **kindling** in the garage – something he had spent two days splitting logs to create!

Prediction 2

After reading Paras. 2-4, you know what happened to the couple. Whether the girls did it intentionally or unintentionally, the disappointment at their inconsideration is for sure. What will be the possible response of the couple to be stated in the next paragraph?

A They criticized the girls.

B They would forgive the girls.

C They asked the girls to leave.

5 Though a little **offended**, my husband didn't complain at all. Looking at these cheerful young ladies, he whispered in my ear, "You know they were born and grew up in an entirely different world from ours, so we should be patient enough toward their behavior. I believe they'll become more mature and considerate later on." He's right. Being patient is the best strategy for helping young people grow.

6 Effective communication is also a key to the solution of an unpleasant occurrence. Sometimes, people criticize young people's "**individualism**", **condemning** their self-centered behavior. Is that true? Yeah, sometimes. But be aware, that's exactly the time when communication is needed. From an incident that is illustrative of this characteristic, we can **infer** there must be a communication breakdown.

7 Not long ago, we held a barbecue to celebrate a product launch. Employees ordered one of three **entrées** in advance. Guess what? The first employees in the line, primarily hungry young men, helped themselves to as many entrées as they wanted – some took all three. **Consequently**, the **caterer** ran out of food before all of our employees could eat. My husband and I, who usually wait until we are sure all of the employees get food, ended up eating at a local restaurant. So did many of our employees who missed out on the meal.

Prediction 3

After reading Paras. 6-7, you know about the incident at the barbecue, where some young employees helped themselves to more food than they should have. What comments could be possibly included in the next paragraph?

A The company should give a warning to these employees.

B Young employees need to be more mature and considerate.

C Something could be done to avoid such happenings in the future.

8 This **episode** seems anything but **incidental**. Did these young individuals ever think about the possible consequences that might impact others? In this story, no. Then the action is most likely **impulsive**. How can we avoid this kind of incident? The answer is – better communication. A sign could have reminded the employees that they were assigned one entrée, the one they pre-ordered. Also, the caterer could have orally sent out the message that they could only take one or their co-workers would go hungry.

9 Last but not least, to work successfully with young people, older generations need to show more understanding. Unfortunately, the young generation is, on a large **scale**, depicted as a group that lacks self-awareness. It might be true, but **ironically**, sometimes older generations can have the same problem.

10 Just yesterday, an elderly employee reported to the HR office that the young employees on her team were committing age **discrimination**. Later, however, the HR manager found that they were actually having problems understanding each other. The elderly employee assumed that her great experience would be respected and her ideas would be **implemented** by the young employees. However, they **somehow** challenged her opinions and wanted to do the project in their own way.

Prediction 4

From Paras. 9-10, you know that sometimes misunderstanding occurs between older and younger employees in the workplace. The next paragraph might be about _____.

A advice on how to solve the problem

B investigation into whose fault it was

C blaming the young employees for their inconsideration

11 To prevent an **elevation** of this conflict, the elderly employee, who was used to **automatic** respect and trust from people young enough to be her children and grandchildren, had to learn that **whereas** treating each other with mutual respect in the workplace is a must, expecting your ideas to be **influential** because you know more is not necessarily right. On the other hand, the young employees need to understand that they can't reject an idea without first weighing its **merits**.

12 To conclude, what this young generation expects from us is more patience, better communication, and deeper understanding. To retain these extremely talented young people at work, employers should be **inspirational** and able to recognize their priorities and immediate needs. Smart employers **demonstrate** not only IQ but also EQ – they share knowledge and information yet understand emotion and **networking**. In this environment, young people will surely **excel** and make a commitment. Their real strengths and resourcefulness can, therefore, be successfully tapped.

(*848 words*)

Culture notes

barbecue: a tradition in the U.S. for three centuries. The tradition is for large gatherings as well as festival celebrations, such as a new product launch mentioned in the text. Having a barbecue has become an important part of people's lives in the U.S., so it's a more culturally related activity – a passed-down ritual or tradition.

New words

▲ **artificial** /ˌɑːtɪˈfɪʃəl/ *a.*
1 made or produced to copy sth. natural; not real 人造的；人工的；假的
2 not what it appears to be 虚假的；假装的

▲ **intelligence** /ɪnˈtelədʒəns/ *n.* [U]
1 the ability to learn, understand, and think about things 智力；智慧；悟性；理解力
2 information about the secret activities of foreign governments, the military plans of an enemy, etc. 情报；谍报

artificial intelligence *n.* [U] the study of how to make computers do intelligent things that people can do, such as think and make decisions 人工智能

▲ **characteristic** /ˌkærəktəˈrɪstɪk/
n. [C, usu. pl.] a quality or feature of sth. or sb. that is typical of them and easy to recognize （物或人的）特征，特性，特色
a. very typical of a particular thing or of sb.'s character 典型的；独特的

▲ **visual** /ˈvɪʒuəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*) relating to seeing 视觉的；视力的

▲ **idealistic** /aɪˌdɪəˈlɪstɪk/ *a.* believing that you should live according to high standards and principles, even if they cannot really be achieved, or showing this belief 理想主义（者）的；空想的

▲ **maturity** /məˈtʃʊərəti/ *n.* [U]
1 the quality of behaving in a sensible way like an adult 成熟
2 the time or state when sb. or sth. is fully grown or developed （人或物的）成熟（期）

▲ **valid** /ˈvælɪd/ *a.*
1 reasonable and generally accepted 有根据的；令人信服的
2 that is legally or officially acceptable （法律上）有效的；（正式）认可的

▲ **communicative** /kəˈmjuːnəkətɪv/ *a.*
1 able to talk easily to other people 健谈的；善于言谈的
2 relating to the ability to communicate, esp. in a foreign language （尤指外语）表达能力的

▲ **proof** /pruːf/ *n.* [C, U] facts, information, documents, etc. that prove sth. is true 证明；证据

▲ **illustrate** /ˈɪləstreɪt/ *vt.* make the meaning of sth. clearer by giving examples （举例）说明，阐明

▲ **buddy** /ˈbʌdi/ *n.* [C] (*infml.*) a friend 朋友；伙伴

▲ **evaluation** /ɪˌvæljuˈeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] a judgment about how good, useful, or successful sth. is 评价；评估

self-evaluation *n.* [C, U] the process or an instance of assessing oneself and weighing up one's achievements 自我评价

▲ **perceptive** /pəˈseptɪv/ *a.* having or showing the ability to see or understand things quickly, esp. things that are not obvious 理解力强的；有洞察力的；思维敏捷的

▲ **capability** /ˌkeɪpəˈbɪləti/ *n.* [C] the natural ability, skill, or power that makes a machine, person, or organization able to do sth., esp. sth. difficult （尤指完成困难事情的）能力，才能

▲ **renew** /rɪˈnjuː/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) begin doing sth. again after a period of not doing it （中止后）重新开始，继续
2 arrange for an agreement or official document to continue for a further period of time 延长（协议或官方文件）的期限；使续期

kindling /ˈkɪndlɪŋ/ *n.* [U] small sticks, leaves, etc. that you use to start a fire 引火物

▲ **offend** /əˈfend/
v. make sb. angry or upset by doing or saying sth. that they think is rude, unkind, etc. 冒犯；使生气
vi. (*fml.*) commit a crime or crimes 犯罪；违法

offended /əˈfendɪd/ *a.* angry and upset by sb.'s behavior or remarks 气愤的；不悦的

▲ individualism /ˌɪndəˈvɪdʒuəlɪzəm/ *n.* [U]
1 the behavior or attitude of sb. who does things in their own way without being influenced by other people（行为或态度）我行我素
2 the belief that the rights and freedom of individual people are the most important rights in society 个人主义

▲ condemn /kənˈdem/ *vt.*
1 say very strongly that you do not approve of sth. or sb., esp. because you think it is morally wrong 指责；谴责
2 give sb. a severe punishment after deciding they are guilty of a crime 给…判罪；给…判刑

▲ infer /ɪnˈfɜː/ *vt.* form an opinion that sth. is probably true because of information that you have（根据资料）推断，推定

entrée /ˈɒntreɪ/ *n.* [C] the main dish of a meal, or a dish served before the main course – used in restaurants or on formal occasions 主菜，正餐前的开胃菜（用于餐馆或正式场合）

▲ consequently /ˈkɒnsəkwəntli/ *ad.* as a result 结果；因此；所以

▲ cater /ˈkeɪtə/ *v.* provide and serve food and drinks at a party, meeting, etc., usu. as a business（在聚会、会议等上）（为…）提供饮食，承办酒席

caterer /ˈkeɪtərə/ *n.* [C] a person or company that provides and serves food and drinks at a party, meeting, etc.（聚会、会议等的）酒席承办者

▲ episode /ˈepəsəʊd/ *n.* [C]
1 an event or a short period of time during which sth. happens 一段经历；一段时期
2 a part of a television or radio story that is broadcast separately and forms one of a series（电视剧或广播剧的）集

▲ incidental /ˌɪnsəˈdentl/ *a.* accidentally happening as a result of an activity or process 偶然发生的；意外的

▲ impulsive /ɪmˈpʌlsɪv/ *a.* (of people or their behavior) acting without considering the possible dangers or problems first（人或行为）冲动的，鲁莽的

▲ scale /skeɪl/ *n.* [sing., U] the size or level of sth., or the amount that sth. is happening 规模；范围；程度

▲ ironically /aɪˈrɒnɪkli/ *ad.* used when talking about a situation in which the opposite of what you expected happens or is true 具有讽刺意味的是；出乎意料的是；让人哭笑不得的是

▲ discrimination /dɪˌskrɪməˈneɪʃən/ *n.* [U] the practice of treating one person or group differently from another in an unfair way 歧视

▲ implement /ˈɪmpləment/ *vt.* make sth. such as an idea, plan, system, or law start to work and be used 实施；执行；贯彻

▲ somehow /ˈsʌmhaʊ/ *ad.*
1 for some reason that is not clear to you or that you do not understand 由于某种不明原因；不知为什么
2 in some way, or by some means, although you do not know how 用某种方法；不知怎的

▲ elevation /ˌeləˈveɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C, U] (*fml.*) an increase in the amount or level of sth.（数量或水平的）增加，升高
2 [sing.] a height above the level of the sea 海拔

▲ automatic /ˌɔːtəˈmætɪk/ *a.*
1 happening as a result of specific conditions, rules, or laws, without a special decision being made 必然的；当然的
2 (of a machine, device, etc.) having controls that work without needing a person to operate them（机器、装置等）自动的

▲ **whereas** /weəˈæz/ *conj.* (*fml.*) used to say that although sth. is true of one thing, it is not true of another 但是；却；尽管

▲ **influential** /ˌɪnfluˈenʃəl/ *a.* having a lot of influence and therefore changing the way people think and behave 有影响力的

▲ **merit** /ˈmerɪt/ *n.* [C] an advantage or good feature of sth. 长处；优点

▲ **inspirational** /ˌɪnspəˈreɪʃənəl/ *a.* providing encouragement or new ideas for what you should do 启发灵感的；鼓舞人心的

▲ **demonstrate** /ˈdemənstreɪt/ *vt.*

1 show that you have a particular ability, quality, or feeling 展示，表露出（某种能力、品质或感情）

2 show or prove sth. clearly 说明；证明；证实；论证

▲ **networking** /ˈnetwɜːkɪŋ/ *n.* [U] the practice of meeting other people involved in the same kind of work, to share information, support each other, etc. 建立人际关系网

▲ **excel** /ɪkˈsel/ *vi.* do sth. very well, or much better than most people 优于；擅长；胜过他人

Phrases and expressions

be gifted with have a natural ability to do certain things very well 在…方面有天赋（或才华）

be crazy about like sb. very much or be very interested in sth. 对…着迷；醉心于

be amazed at be very surprised at 对…感到惊讶（或惊奇）

whisper (sth.) in one's ear speak or say sth. very quietly to sb. 在…耳边低语

be illustrative of help to explain the meaning of sth. 对…起说明作用

run out (of sth.) use all of sth. and not have any more left 用完；耗尽

miss out on not have the chance to do sth. that you enjoy and that would be good for you 失去…的机会

on a large scale involving a lot of effort, people, supplies, etc. 大规模地

be depicted as be described as 被描绘成

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What advice does the author give for dealing with the young generation?
- A Less noise toward this particular group.
- B Less use of their vigor and intelligence.
- C More criticism along their way to maturity.
- D More understanding and communication.

2 What's the author's opinion of the girls who burned all the kindling from the garage?
- A They are charming but inconsiderate.
- B They are good at using cell phones.
- C We should be more patient with their behavior.
- D We should be amazed at their views and knowledge.

3 What's the solution to young people's "individualism"?
- A Drawing inferences based on what they do.
- B Stopping criticizing and condemning them.
- C Having effective communication with them.
- D Condemning them for being selfish and self-centered.

4 Why did many employees attending the barbecue party end up eating at a restaurant?
- A Some young people were too hungry to think about others.
- B Some young people took away as many entrées as they wanted.
- C These employees didn't pre-order their preferred entrées.
- D These employees didn't stand first in line to pick up food.

5 What is suggested to avoid the incident at the barbecue in the future?
- A Young people should think of others.
- B There should be better communication.
- C A reminder should be sent to the employees in advance.
- D The caterer should prepare and bring more food to the party.

6 What caused the "age discrimination" incident mentioned in the text?
- A The young men lacked self-awareness.
- B The employees misunderstood each other.
- C The young did not show respect to the elderly.
- D The elderly employee asked the HR to get involved in the accident.

7 What advice does the author give older employees to avoid conflicts with their young colleagues?
- A Assuming your experience should be respected is reasonable.
- B Expecting your ideas to be influential is not necessarily right.
- C Rejecting an idea without weighing its merits is inappropriate.
- D Treating the young employees with respect is a must in the workplace.

8 How can employers retain their talented young employees at work?
- A Give them a little more patience.
- B Share your knowledge and information.
- C Understand their emotions and viewpoints.
- D Inspire them and recognize their priorities and immediate needs.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Why do you think it's wrong to make too many negative comments about young people?
2 Did the anecdotes in the text well illustrate the characteristics of young people? Why or why not?
3 In your opinion, what are the unique characteristics of young people today?
4 In your opinion, what are the most important contributions young people have made to our society?
5 The youth work is regarded as strategically significant in China. How does our society value the young generation?

Collocation



While Text B vividly depicts some incidents involving young people in the West, Text A applauds the work teams for instant messaging apps for their high aspirations and strong motivation. With considerable time and effort, they have accomplished many incredible tasks. You can see the collocations in this unit are closely linked with the young generation, such as *fantastic platform, strong passion, amazing talent, endure hardship, instinctive sense, invaluable suggestion, high aspirations, collective idea* in Text A and *unique characteristic, perceptive view, extremely talented, entirely different* in Text B. You can also locate other collocations from the two texts.

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
incredible	capability
work	minded
broad	story
impressive	tap into
globally	knowledge
fully	tirelessly

4 Read the short interview about the young generation. Complete it with the words below based on the collocations from the texts.

amazing collective entirely extremely
fantastic high impressive incredible
invaluable perceptive strong unique

Kevin: Being a young entrepreneur, how would you define the young generation today? As you know, there is much debate on their 1) _____ characteristics.

Peter: Well, here are some of the main characteristics to define this young generation. The one that stands out, I think, is their 2) _____ aspirations. Generally speaking, they are confident and ambitious. To them, there's no limit to what they can achieve. They have a(n) 3) _____ passion for innovation and at the same time hope their expectations can be matched with their 4) _____ talents.

Kevin: Teamwork is also high on the agenda of this generation. Is that right? I heard a lot of 5) _____ stories in this regard. They're all amazing and very interesting.

Peter: Oh, that's absolutely right! Cooperation is always preferred. In their opinion, 6) _____ ideas work better than individual ones. Moreover, they're anxious to be involved. They want their 7) _____ suggestions to carry weight and their voice to be heard. Even if their 8) _____ views are unfortunately rejected, they expect openness from management.

Kevin: How would you comment on the public opinion that this young generation is 9) _____ talented in technology? Do you think this is something very positive?

Peter: I would definitely think it's a very positive comment. Today's young people can represent themselves and show their talent through the 10) _____ platform of the Internet. They prefer to communicate more quickly and effectively via email, social networks, or text messaging, which is 11) _____ different from traditional means of communication. They are embracing technologies and implementing them into their business. Their 12) _____ capability in high-tech is simply admirable …

Stories of China

Aiming to bring agriculture online

Many young Chinese are interested in start-ups (创业公司). They hope to innovate and start their own businesses. They are obviously unafraid of failure. Driven by the Internet and rapid economic growth, a post-95 entrepreneur, Gou Yingda, has his own success story to tell.

Tall and slim, wearing sports shoes and a jeans jacket, Yingda runs in quick steps as he arrives for the interview. His energetic manner and his quick steps make him look very young. He smiles frequently and doesn't show any sign of tiredness, though he only slept a few hours last night. Young as he looks, he is already an experienced entrepreneur, having spent many years in the field of Internet start-ups.

Upon his graduation from high school, he spent a whole summer at a coffee house, a well-known place for business starters in Beijing. There he immersed (沉浸) himself in the circle and eagerly exchanged views with other people. The passionate young man gradually had a clear picture of what he would do: He would build people's trust in agricultural products and food safety through transparent operation of agricultural products.

He is now the CEO of an Internet company aiming to link farmers with urban consumers to guarantee green, organic produce (有机农产品). It's not just an agricultural e-commerce website. Its goal is to use the Internet to transform China's agriculture. The company



acquires the right to use farmland and then hires farmers to grow crops on the land. In fall, when the crops are harvested, the company will deliver the produce directly from the field to the consumer.

To build up their consumers' confidence in the produce, the company sets up cameras on the farmland and provides real-time updates via live streams (直播), so consumers can check on their plants with their mobile phones. This practice makes the production process transparent and effectively relieves people's concerns about food safety. The young CEO believes that the key to the success of the company lies in consumers' trust and that allowing them to watch the whole farming process can win their trust.

"We promise to provide organic food without any chemicals, and we aim at China's top agricultural brand," said Yingda. "Even if we fail, it is also a great attempt. So, I want to awaken the Chinese youth to pay attention to agriculture and rebuild their hometown." He goes on business trips every two to three days: attending meetings, checking on farmland, and giving lectures. In his opinion, people choose his produce because he is persistent in what he's doing, and they believe in his business model.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 如今，很多年轻人不再只选择稳定的（stable）工作，他们更愿意自主创业，依靠自己的智慧和努力去证明他们的自我价值（self-worth）。

2 创业者的成功不但会创造财富，增加就业机会，改善大家的生活，而且从长远来看，对于我们的国家也是一件好事。

3 中国政府大力鼓励和支持创业和创新，这会进一步激发年轻人的热情，增强他们的信心。

Unit project

Presenting a talk show: Young people are making a difference in China

This unit project aims to present a talk show, in which a host will interact with a few guests for 8-10 minutes. The host first asks questions regarding how young people today are making contributions to society in different workplaces to make a difference in China. Then the guests give responses to the questions. Both questions and responses can be prepared in groups or improvised (即兴的) during the talk show if the host or the guests come up with some new ideas.

Step 1 **Work in groups and brainstorm different occupations and their significance.**
Think about different occupations that can make contributions to society, such as an office clerk, a computer engineer, a courier (快递员), a salesperson, or an athlete. The significance of a courier could be delivering as many packages as possible to meet the needs of people.

Step 2 **Assign group members their respective roles. You may start with selecting a host and then decide the occupation of each guest.**

Step 3 **Design specific questions the host can ask.**
The questions should be relevant to different occupations. For instance, "What do you think of your job as …?" "What's your career goal for the job of …?" "Do you think the young people on the job are making a difference to the relevant field?" Make sure the questions are clear and thought-provoking, reflecting different perspectives.

Step 4 **Discuss the questions and note down the answers if necessary.**
The answers should be specific, with a personal opinion followed by supporting details. For instance, "As a courier, I have a dream – to become an expert in parcel packaging and delivery so that I can help people get what they ordered safely and quickly."

Step 5 **Rehearse the talk show and present it in class.**
To make sure your talk show is lively and interesting, relax and respond with confidence. The host should be encouraging and enthusiastic as well. If time allows, you can evaluate other groups' performance based on the criteria of "SMART" – specific, meaningful, achievable, relevant, and timely.

Unit

4 Mission and exploration of our time

Exalted merit depends on the high aim, and a patrimony is enlarged only by diligence.

— *The Book of History*

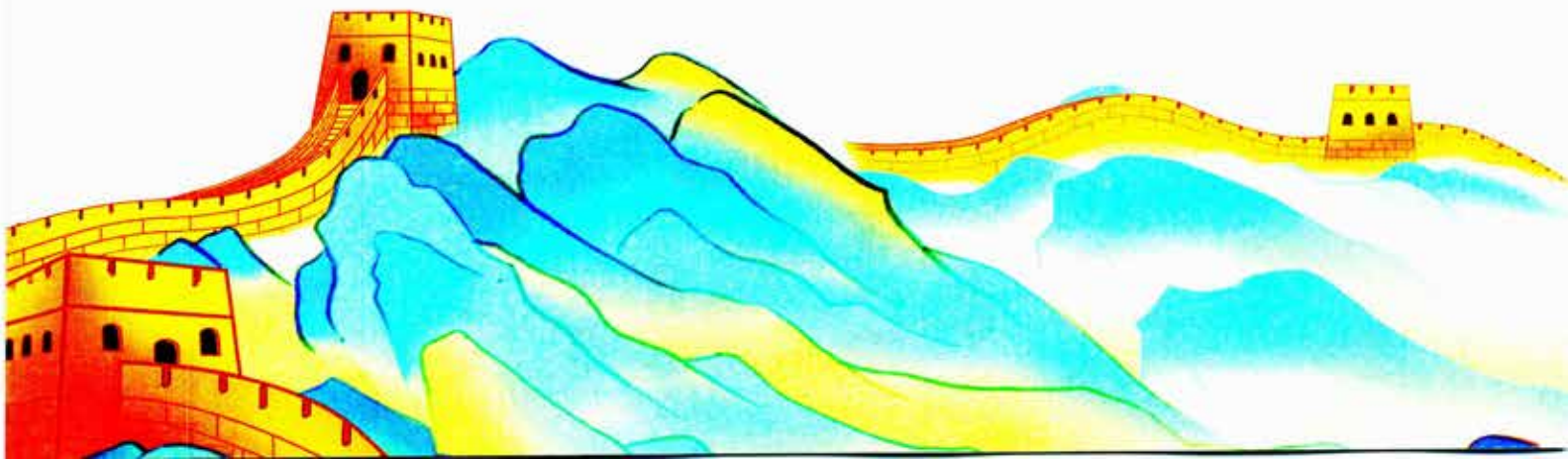
功崇惟志，业广惟勤。

——《尚书》



Preview

Patriotism can be manifested in the years of war or in the years of peace. In today's reform and opening up, our country still **needs patriotism to realize the Chinese Dream**. One of the exemplifiers of patriotism is the late scientist and geophysicist Huang Danian, whose expertise in deep earth exploration technology has helped China take the lead in a number of technical fields. His patriotic deeds and deep affection for the motherland have made him a role model for everyone, especially for the young, who may be experiencing "odyssey years" – a life stage of confusion and self-discovery. The young generation can draw inspiration from Huang's patriotism, professional dedication, and noble spirit **to shoulder the mission of realizing national rejuvenation**. As a college student, have you ever thought about what you would do to enrich your life and better serve the country?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Match the activities with the pictures below. Then think about what personal quality of the participants is reflected in these activities.

_____ 1 Volunteer to teach kids in rural areas

_____ 2 Watch a national flag-raising ceremony

_____ 3 Participate in a patriotic health campaign

_____ 4 Pay tribute to the revolutionary martyrs



2 Work in groups and brainstorm what other activities you can engage in to show your patriotism.

Text A

1 A film event commemorating the 40th anniversary of China's reform and opening up was held in Beijing. The event aimed to introduce a series of newly produced quality Chinese films and tell the inspirational stories of the Chinese people – how their lives have been transformed over the past four decades. One movie that depicts the life of a great geophysicist, Dr. Huang Danian, immediately caught the public's eye.

2 Born in 1958 in Nanning, Guangxi, Huang started to become interested in geophysics early in his childhood. Both his parents taught at a local geological institution and passed the passion down to their son. In 1978, Huang was admitted to Changchun Institute



of **Geology** (now Jilin University) to study in the Department of Applied Geophysics. After completing his **undergraduate** and graduate studies, he stayed on to teach at the school. In his graduation album, Huang wrote, "It is the responsibility of our generation to **rejuvenate** the Chinese nation."



Geological Museum of Jilin University

3 In 1992, Huang went to Britain for further studies. Before going abroad, Huang said, "I will definitely bring back advanced foreign technology!" He earned his doctor's degree in geophysics four years later, finishing top of his class. He then joined a British geophysical service company in Cambridge as a senior geophysicist.

4 During his stay in Britain, Huang remained committed to the motherland, and his contacts with his **alma mater** had never been broken. He often flew back to China to attend academic meetings or **seminars** related to his field. In 2008, Huang decided to give up his position in Britain and returned home with his wife in 2009. The decision was neither a **random** choice nor an impulse. For him, no matter how successful he was abroad, the biggest satisfaction would be improving his home country.

5 Upon his return to China, he was **entrusted** to work at Jilin University as a full-time professor and chief scientist in a branch of China's biggest deep earth exploration program. Over 400 nationwide scientists took part in the **multidiscipline** program, which aimed to install high-tech cameras on aircraft, ships, and satellites that would enable scientists to see through the earth's **crust** without digging into it.

6 Wasting no time, he holed up in his newly set-up laboratory. For seven years, days and nights, Huang worked racing against time, often with only two to three hours of sleep a day. To **maximize** his research time, he **typically** caught late-night flights at the last minute for meetings with his team members. Even his driver became accustomed to driving the scientist to the airport at midnight. The office building where Huang worked was supposed to be completely locked up by night, but since he left very late so often, the security guard would beg him to "leave on time".

7 Many of his co-workers called him a **workaholic**, while he thought he was more like a "**lunatic**". His students remembered how Huang's **explicit** words **resounded** in the office: "China is in **urgent** need of 'lunatics' if it is to become a stronger country." "It would be an honor if I could be one of them," he added.

8 The lunatic's madness paid off. During his seven years working in China, Huang coached 18 **doctoral** candidates and 26 graduate students. Moreover, he and his team helped China greatly narrow its **gap** with developed countries in obtaining accurate data on deep earth exploration. They created a number of China's No. 1s, filling a number of technical gaps for China's sky **survey**, ground detection, and sea exploration.

9 Huang began **fainting** frequently while working tirelessly for his dream. He posted on social media, "Living a day, I am gaining a day. The day I fall, bury me where I fall." On November 29, 2016, Huang fainted again and was sent to the hospital. He was later found to have cancer, with **tumors** spreading to his stomach and **liver**. Obviously, as he was constantly working, he missed the key window for treatment. During his last days, Huang still answered students' questions, assigned tasks, and wrote recommendation letters. "Ideally, I want to be a pioneer who makes sacrifices," Huang said during the last interview of his life. "I hope I can do something to make scientific work easier for future Chinese people."

10 On January 8, 2017, at the age of 58, Huang closed his eyes forever. His two assistants sat on chairs quietly in his office as if they were waiting for Huang to return from a trip. The ringing of the telephone interrupted the quiet. They picked up the phone and began sobbing, "He is gone." A bright star of science fell, leaving the science community in grief.

11 Some people left the motherland and never came back, but Huang chose to return to his motherland **resolutely** with an ardent heart. Some people **chased** fame and a comfortable life, but Huang always had the motherland in mind and never cared about his personal wealth and interests.

12 **Patriotism** had been **embedded** deeply in Huang's bones. As a strategic scientist, he **fulfilled** his dream of rejuvenating the Chinese nation with his **exceptional** achievements.

(*847 words*)

New words

▲ **strategic** /strəˈtiːdʒɪk/ *a.*
1 relating to fighting wars 战略性的；战略上的
2 done as part of a plan, esp. in a military, business, or political situation 战略（性）的；策略（上）的

▲ **anniversary** /ˌænəˈvɜːsəri/ *n.* [C] a date on which sth. special or important happened in a previous year 周年纪念（日）

▲ **series** /ˈsɪəriːz/ *n.* [C, usu. sing.] (*pl.* **series**)
1 a group of events or actions that are planned to happen one after the other（有计划的）系列（事件）
2 **(~ of sth.)** several events or actions of a similar type that happen one after the other 连续发生的同类事件；一系列（或连串）事件

geophysicist /ˌdʒiːəʊˈfɪzɪsɪst/ *n.* [C] a scientist who studies geophysics 地球物理学家

geophysics /ˌdʒiːəʊˈfɪzɪks/ *n.* [U] the study of the movements of parts of the earth, and the forces involved with this, including the weather, the oceans, etc. 地球物理（学）

▲ **geological** /ˌdʒiːəˈlɒdʒɪkəl/ *a.* relating to geology or the features of the earth's surface 地质学的；地形的

▲ **geology** /dʒiˈɒlədʒi/ *n.* [U] the study of the rocks, soil, etc. that make up the earth, and of the way they have changed since the earth was formed 地质（学）

▲ **undergraduate** /ˌʌndəˈgrædʒuət/ *n.* [C] a student at college or university, who is working for their first degree（在读的）大学（本科）生

rejuvenate /rɪˈdʒuːvəneɪt/ *vt.*
1 make sth. work much better or become much better again 使（某事物）变得更有活力；使（某事物）恢复活力
2 make sb. look or feel young and strong again 使（某人）变得年轻；使（某人）恢复活力

alma mater /ˌælmə ˈmɑːtə/ *n.* [sing.] the school, college, or university that sb. went to 母校

▲ **seminar** /ˈsemənɑː/ *n.* [C]
1 a class on a particular subject, usu. given as a form of training 研讨会；培训会
2 a class at a university or college for a small group of students and a teacher to study or discuss a particular subject（大学里师生分组进行专题讨论的）研讨班

random /ˈrændəm/ *a.* happening or chosen without any definite plan, aim, or pattern 随意的；任意的；随机的

entrust /ɪnˈtrʌst/ *vt.* make sb. responsible for doing sth. important, or for taking care of sb. 委托；交付

▲ **discipline** /ˈdɪsɪplɪn/ *n.*
1 [C] an area of knowledge or teaching, esp. one such as history, chemistry, and mathematics that is studied at a university（尤指大学的）专业、科目
2 [U] a way of training sb. so that they learn to control their behavior and obey rules 训练；管教

multidiscipline /ˌmʌltiˈdɪsɪplɪn/ *n.* [U] an approach or method which involves several disciplines 多学科

crust /krʌst/ *n.* [C, U] the hard outer layer of the earth（地球的）地壳

▲ **maximize** /ˈmæksəmaɪz/ *vt.*
1 increase sth. as much as possible 使增加到最大限度
2 make the best use of sth. 充分利用；最大限度地利用

▲ **typical** /ˈtɪpɪkəl/ *a.*
1 happening in the usual way 一贯的；平常的
2 having the usual features or qualities of a

particular group or thing 典型的；有代表性的

typically /ˈtɪpɪkli/ *ad.* in the way that a particular type of thing usu. happens 一般；通常

workaholic /ˌwɜːkəˈhɒlɪk/ *n.* [C] (*infml.*) sb. who chooses to work a lot, so that they do not have time to do anything else 醉心于工作的人；工作狂

lunatic /ˈluːnətɪk/ *n.* [C] sb. who behaves in a crazy or very stupid way – often used humorously 疯狂的人，愚笨的人（常为幽默用法）

▲ **explicit** /ɪkˈsplɪsɪt/ *a.* expressed in a way that is very clear and direct 清楚明确的；直截了当的

resound /rɪˈzaʊnd/ *vi.* (of a sound, voice, etc.) fill a place with sound（声音、嗓音等）回响，回荡

▲ **urgent** /ˈɜːdʒənt/ *a.* very important and needing to be dealt with immediately 紧急的；急迫的；需迅速处理的

▲ **doctoral** /ˈdɒktərəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*) done as part of work for the university degree of doctor 博士（学位）的

▲ **gap** /gæp/ *n.* [C] a big difference between two situations, amounts, groups of people, etc.（大的）差距，差额，差别

▲ **survey** /ˈsɜːveɪ/ *n.* [C]
1 an examination of an area of land in order to make a map of it（绘制地图前对某地的）勘测，测量，测绘
2 a set of questions that you ask a large number of people in order to find out about their opinions or behavior 调查

▲ **faint** /feɪnt/
vi. suddenly become unconscious for a short time 晕倒；昏厥
a. feeling weak and as if you are about to become unconscious because you are very ill, tired, or hungry（因生病、疲倦或饥饿而）虚弱的

▲ **tumor** /ˈtjuːmə/ *n.* [C] a mass of diseased cells which might become a lump or cause illness 肿瘤

▲ **liver** /ˈlɪvə/ *n.* [C]（人体的）肝脏

▲ **resolute** /ˈrezəluːt/ *a.* doing sth. in a very determined way because you have very strong beliefs, aims, etc.（因有坚定的信念、明确的目标等而）坚决的，不屈不挠的

resolutely /ˈrezəluːtli/ *ad.* 坚决地；不屈不挠地

▲ **chase** /tʃeɪs/ *v.*
1 use a lot of time and effort trying to get sth. such as work or money 努力赢得；设法获得
2 quickly follow sb. or sth. in order to catch them 追逐；追赶；追捕

patriotism /ˈpeɪtriətɪzəm/ *n.* [U] love for your country and loyalty toward it 爱国主义

embed /ɪmˈbed/
vt. make sth. a fixed and important part of sth. else 使…扎根
v. put sth. firmly and deeply into sth. else, or be put into sth. in this way（使）嵌入；（把…）插入

▲ **fulfill** /fʊlˈfɪl/ *vt.*
1 do or achieve what was hoped for or expected 实现
2 do or provide what is necessary or needed 履行；执行；符合

▲ **exceptional** /ɪkˈsepʃənəl/ *a.*
1 unusually good 非常好的；杰出的
2 unusual and likely not to happen often 罕见的；不寻常的

Phrases and expressions

catch one's eye attract one's attention and make them look at sth. 吸引…的注意

pass sth. down give or teach sth. to people who are younger than you or live after you 把…传给后人；把…往下传

be admitted to be allowed to join an organization or a group such as a school 被允许加入；被接收入学

stay on continue to do a job or to study after the usual or expected time for leaving（在通常或预期的时间后）继续留下来工作（或学习）

remain committed to be completely loyal to one person, organization, etc., or give all your time and effort to your work, an activity, etc. 忠于（某个人、机构等）；全心全意投入（工作、活动等）

be entrusted to do sth. be assigned to be responsible for doing sth. important 被委托做

hole up (*also* **be holed up**) (*infml.*) hide somewhere for a period of time 躲藏

race against time try to do sth. very quickly due to limited time 争分夺秒；抢时间

in urgent need of needing or requiring sth. immediately 急需

pay off (*infml.*) (of a plan or an action, esp. one that involves risk) be successful and bring good results 成功；奏效；达到目的

miss the key window for sth. lose the best chance or time for a particular activity 失去…的最好时机

be embedded in (of ideas, attitudes, or feelings, etc.) be felt strongly and difficult to change（思想、态度、感情等）扎根于

Proper names

Changchun Institute of Geology 长春地质学院（现吉林大学）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What's the purpose of showing the series of newly produced Chinese movies?
2 What did Huang write in his graduation album?
3 Why did Huang go to Britain to further his studies after he worked for a while in China?
4 According to the text, what was China's biggest deep earth exploration program?
5 Why did Huang prefer to be called "lunatic" but not "workaholic" by his co-workers?
6 How did Huang and his team help China greatly narrow its gap with developed countries?
7 During his last days of life, what did Huang wish he could do for future Chinese people?
8 How did Huang show his love and patriotism for the country throughout his life?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What are the most important qualities we should learn from Huang Danian?
2 Why do you think Huang Danian worked tirelessly for the motherland?
3 If you were a student of Huang Danian, what would you want to say to him?
4 What's your opinion about the importance of patriotism in the years of peace?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

chase exceptional explicit
fulfill maximize random resolutely
strategic survey typically

1 According to medical doctors, if a patient's tumor is small, surgery is _____ performed to remove it.
2 These graduates brought deep-water ocean _____ technology to the region to help explore the areas.
3 Here is my suggestion in terms of writing process: Before you start writing an essay, just jot down _____ ideas to do brainstorming.
4 It is important for athletes to have rigorous physical and technical training to _____ their performance in sports competitions.
5 After successful completion of these courses, students _____ the academic requirements for their undergraduate studies.
6 Only three short straightforward words, but they were said so _____ that all the audience were impressed.
7 This position would ideally suit candidates who have exposure to working on key _____ projects, preferably in the area of geophysics.
8 Internship, which gives you valuable work experience, can offer you a(n) _____ opportunity to be competitive in the job market.
9 He understood that his _____ the dream was not for himself but for the people who had the same hopes and passions as him.
10 He gave us very _____ instructions on how to handle the new machine, so we all understood what he meant.

Word building



与动词结合构成名词。以这种方式构成的名词表示做这个动作的人或者用于做这个动作的器械工具。

cater		caterer
clean		cleaner
drive		driver
employ	>	employer
browse		**browser**
transmit		**transmitter**



与形容词结合构成名词。以这种方式构成的名词表示形容词所描述的状态或状况。

intense		intensity
secure		security
punctual	>	**punctuality**
pure		**purity**
regular		**regularity**



与表示状态或状况的名词或形容词结合构成动词。以这种方式构成的动词描述了产生上述状态或状况的过程。

maximum		maximize
real		realize
civil	>	**civilize**
material		**materialize**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

browser civilize materialize
punctuality purity regularity
transmitter

1 Though we have different viewpoints, I quite agree with what he says, "Great movies enlarge our world, _____ us, and make us more decent people."
2 In addition to being used for payment, the digital yuan also has a value in boosting low-carbon development so that carbon neutrality can _____ in everyday life.
3 According to the instructions, whether you use a _____ or an app, you can always schedule and reply to messages across multiple platforms.
4 Thanks to the airline's customer-focused approach, there has been a huge improvement in _____ and reliability.
5 A type of acid, featuring high _____ and high activity, from agricultural and forestry waste, has been industrialized and used for soil restoration in China.
6 The experiment shows us how a mosquito that is a relatively poor _____ of the virus can actually have a huge impact on human health.
7 Droughts have occurred in some parts of the world with increasing _____ in recent years due to disruptions to the water cycle.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A absolutely	F dictate	K process
B adequately	G geophysics	L prosperous
C aspirations	H imaginary	M rejuvenate
D compelling	I inspirations	N significant
E detect	J platforms	O tedious

Dear students,

My field falls within basic science research – the mobile platform detection technology. As an important research field of 1) _____, this technology is absolutely challenging. My work aims to develop mobile 2) _____ for ships and vehicles, use geophysical detection equipment and technology to 3) _____ multi-information, based on which to build models, and provide technical support for energy and mineral resources exploration. This technology can clearly 4) _____ what's down there two kilometers or more below the ground.

As China becomes a stronger and more 5) _____ nation, it needs many people who have studied abroad to return to the motherland and help with its modernization. I hope that we can together make 6) _____ contributions to the development of China's science and technology.

As the representative of your teachers, I would like to say that no matter whether your 7) _____ lead you to success or failure, no matter whether you are doing fine or not, and no matter whether your life is 8) _____ or boring, you will always be in our mind because we care about you. As you are about to graduate from college and join in efforts to 9) _____ our nation, we'll share the responsibilities and happiness with you.

How time flies! I still remember the time when I was standing where you are now. It's 10) _____ my pleasure to come back to my alma mater after I graduated 18 years ago. No matter how many ups and downs you'll go through, I hope you can remember our college and return as often as you can. We'll cheer you on! Go! Go!

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be entrusted to catch one's eye hole up
in urgent need of pass … down pay off
remain committed to stay on

1 When I was traveling in China, I would ride my bike slowly, take pictures of the things that _____, and talk to people.
2 As a senior assistant in the lab for quite a few years, I was thrilled to _____ teach lab techniques to the new students.
3 It was raining heavily, so she spent the whole afternoon _____ in her dorm room and reading.
4 We will build a closer partnership and _____ high-quality cooperation under the Belt and Road Initiative.
5 I went back to school to get my coaching certification, and my efforts and persistence _____ in the end.
6 She joined the lab as a summer student and then _____ to complete her fourth-year honors thesis before graduation.
7 The traditions that _____ from generation to generation will surely enrich our culture and be carried forward.
8 To fight against the common health crisis, China has made great efforts to help other countries _____ medicines.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Focusing on a comparison / contrast essay

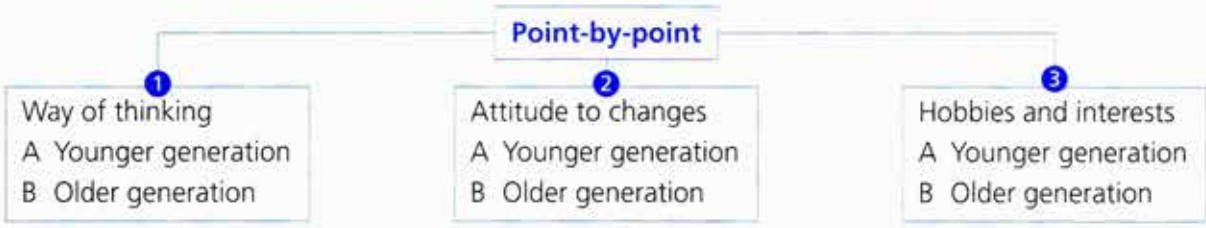
In this unit, you will learn another useful writing mode: comparison / contrast. You often compare and contrast two items or people in everyday life, such as two teachers, two jobs, or two ways to spend a weekend. To compare means to show the similarities, and to contrast means to show the differences.

There are some important points to remember when you write a comparison / contrast essay.

1 The items being compared or contrasted must be from the same category. In other words, they should be comparable. For example, you can compare a desktop with a laptop, but you may not compare a computer with a camera.

2 It is better to mention the points you would like to compare or contrast in the thesis statement so that your reader can know about the main idea of your essay right away. For instance, to compare two jobs, you may want to write a thesis statement like this: "It's not difficult to choose a job you prefer if you compare the job features of work environment, schedule flexibility, and opportunity for promotion." Here, the three points you're going to compare or contrast are clearly stated. It's beneficial not only for your reader but also for yourself because you can always follow the sequence to develop your ideas, making your writing well organized.

3 There are two patterns to organize the details of your essay: point-by-point and subject-by-subject. Here, *point* refers to one of the aspects you would use to develop your essay, and *subject* refers to the two items or people you want to compare or contrast. This unit will focus on the point-by-point pattern. For instance, to compare two generations, you may organize the details as follows.



4 The key to writing a coherent comparison / contrast essay is the appropriate use of comparison and contrast signal words. Signal words for comparison include *similarly, likewise, also, as, just as, like, similar to, alike, the same as, not only ... but also ..., both ... and ...*, etc. Signal words for contrast are *on the other hand, in contrast, however, in comparison, although, though, whereas, while, but, different from, unlike*, etc.

The writing pattern can be used for an entire text, or just part of a text, as is demonstrated by Para. 11 in Text A which describes two different attitudes to life.

Some people left the motherland and never came back, but Huang chose to return to his motherland resolutely with an ardent heart. (**Point 1**) *Some people chased fame and a comfortable life, but Huang always had the motherland in mind and never cared about his personal wealth and interests.* (**Point 2**)

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops ideas with the point-by-point pattern.

Topic
Huang Danian vs. Yuan Longping

Introduction
Thesis statement: Even though Huang and Yuan were different in certain ways, they are both regarded as national heroes.

Body
Point 1: Made great contributions to the country
- Huang Danian
- Yuan Longping

Point 2: Worked hard and always persevered
- Huang Danian
- Yuan Longping

Conclusion
Both Huang Danian and Yuan Longping are the heroes of our time.

Huang Danian and Yuan Longping are both internationally well-known scientists. Huang was a geophysicist, while Yuan was a plant scientist. Huang was born in southern China's Guangxi Zhuang Autonomous Region, and Yuan was born in northern China's Beijing. Huang died young, at the age of 58; Yuan passed away at the age of 91. Even though Huang and Yuan were different in certain ways, they are both regarded as national heroes.

First of all, they both made immeasurable contributions to the motherland. Huang, together with his team, not only developed the high-end equipment for China's oil production, but also installed the equipment on aircraft, satellites, and ships. Thanks to Huang and his devoted team, China is now very advanced in developing deep earth exploration equipment. Similarly, Yuan succeeded in cultivating the world's first high-yield hybrid rice strain in 1973, which was later grown on a large scale in China and other countries to substantially raise output. His discoveries in hybrid rice cultivation helped relieve famine and poverty across much of Asia and Africa.

In addition, they both worked tirelessly, demonstrating a strong character of perseverance. Huang worked like a robot, often forgetting to sleep and eat. He holed up in his office to do his research day and night, earning the deserved title "workaholic". Even though he was heading down a difficult research road, he never gave up his pursuit. In a similar manner, Yuan, despite his age, forged ahead with his research on rice. He often looked through tens of thousands of ears of rice, while walking barefoot through the fields. In addition to teaching farmers how to grow hybrid rice in different countries, he worked in partnership with the United Nations and the International Rice Research Institute for global food security.

To conclude, both Huang and Yuan are heroes of our time. Behind their tremendous contributions are their hard work and patriotic feelings toward the motherland. As college students, we should resolutely follow the path they paved for us and continue to chase the Chinese Dream.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The differences between the young generation and their parents' generation

Introduction

Thesis statement: Even though both generations have their good points, today's young people are more active in life and more adaptable to the changes of life than their parents.

Body

Point 1: Activeness in life

- Young people
- Their parents

Point 2: Adaptability to the changes of life

- Young people
- Their parents

Conclusion

Young people usually live in a more active and flexible way than their parents.

More topics

- The two people I admire
- The two cities I like best

Section B

Reading skills

Understanding figurative language

To make our language more interesting and entertaining, we often use figurative language. It compares and paints a picture for the reader. Figurative language can be confusing if it is understood literally. The ability to recognize and interpret or explain figurative language can help us fully understand a writer's point and sense the underlying humor.

There are different ways of using figurative language. Listed below are just the three most common ones.

1 Simile (明喻): a figurative expression which directly compares one thing to another by using the words *as* or *like*, such as "his beard is as white as snow" or "my heart is like a singing bird".
2 Metaphor (暗喻): a figurative expression in which the comparison is implied, without using *as*, *like* and the like. For example, the expression "the curtain of night fell upon us" tells us it's nighttime, though not directly.
3 Personification (拟人化): a figurative expression which compares non-human things to humans or gives non-human things qualities or abilities that only a human can have. Look at these two expressions: "lightning danced across the sky"; "my flowers were begging for water".

Now, let's take a look at the following examples from Text A.

- *For seven years, days and nights, Huang worked racing against time, often with only two to three hours of sleep a day.* (Para. 6)
- *Many of his co-workers called him a workaholic, while he thought he was more like a "lunatic".* (Para. 7)
- *A bright star of science fell, leaving the science community in grief.* (Para. 10)

We can see the first example is a personification because it uses a non-human thing "time" (clock) to compete with humans. The second example is a simile due to the word *like*. The third example is a metaphor for the reason that it compares a human to a bright star, implying that Huang Danian was a great scientist, just like a twinkling star in the night sky. The figurative meaning is thus obvious, though not directly said.

I Read the following sentences from Text B. Then explain the underlined figurative language with your own words and identify in which way it is used.

1 Today we have an equivalent need to recognize a new phase of life that comes after high school graduation, continues through college, and then leads to having a career and starting a family, the so-called odyssey years. (Para. 4)

2 Their confusion comes from the difficulties to make parents understand them and the fluid journey of discovery they need in this phase of their lives. (Para. 6)

_____

3 Nations around the world have witnessed similar trends toward delaying marriage and spending more years than ever shifting between higher education and settling down with a career and family. (Para. 10)

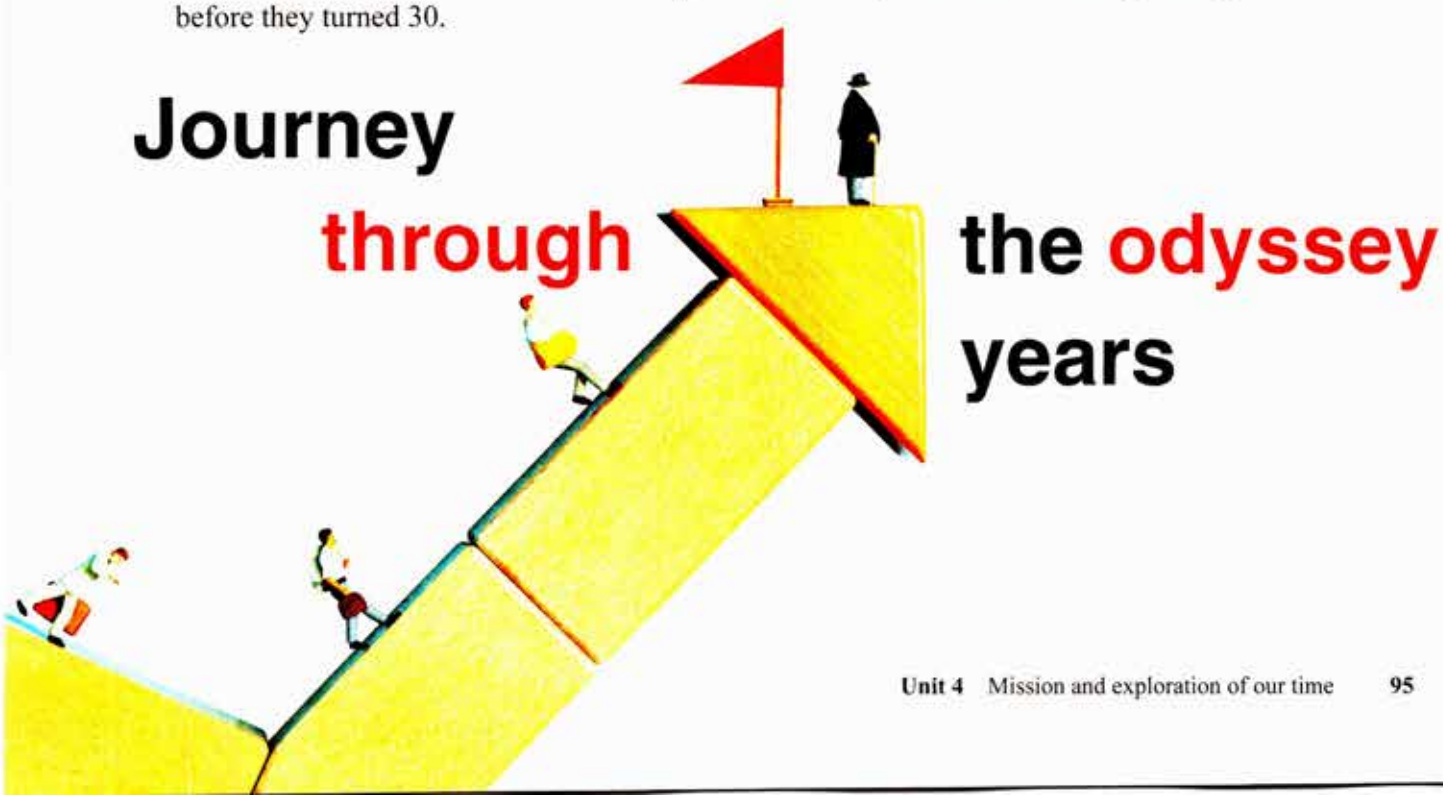
_____

Text B

1 Most of us know about the **phases** of life which we **label** to parallel different age groups: childhood, **adolescence**, adulthood, and old age. We think of **infancy** before childhood and middle age before old age, with each unique phase bringing its own **peculiar** set of challenges. These challenges can be overcome by **acquainting** ourselves with them, such as the child's need to learn, the adult's need to find the right career and build a family, and the senior's need for support and good health care.

2 Interestingly, ideas about the stages of life are changing.

3 In **previous** times, people didn't have a solid idea of childhood as being separate from adulthood. More than a hundred years ago, no one thought of adolescence. Until recently it was understood as a **norm** that children's **induction** to adulthood was completed as soon as they graduated from college. They would now find a **sensible** job which would lead to a career. Then during this career they would start a family, ideally before they turned 30.



4 Today we have an **equivalent** need to recognize a new phase of life that comes after high school graduation, continues through college, and then leads to having a career and starting a family, the so-called odyssey years. Recent trends show **radical** changes as young people are following a different agenda. They take breaks from school, live with friends, and often return to living with their parents. Similarly, they fall in and out of love, **quit** one job and try another, or even shift to a new career. So we need to recognize this new stage, the odyssey years, which many now consider to be an unavoidable stage in reaching adulthood.

5 People who were born prior to the 60s or 70s in the last century tended to frame their concept of adulthood based upon achieving certain accomplishments: moving away from home, becoming financially independent, finding the right **spouse**, and starting a family. But that emphasis on **stability** did not remain **static**. Today, young people are unlikely to do the same. During the odyssey years, a high **proportion** of young people are delaying marriage, childbearing, and even employment.

6 The odyssey years can **saddle** young people with enormous pressure to move forward quickly. As the **heir** and focus of their parents' expectations, hopes, and dreams, some react with rebellious and prideful attitudes and behavior toward their parents. They often **resent** the pressure they're feeling and keep a distance from their parents or even run away from home. Their confusion comes from the difficulties to make parents understand them and the **fluid** journey of discovery they need in this phase of their lives.

7 Likewise, their parents are feeling more anxious. They may make **allowances** for a **transition** phase from student life to adult life, but they become more worried when they see the transition of their grown children's lives moving away from their expectations and stretching from five years to seven years, and beyond. The parents don't even detect a clear sense of direction in their children's lives. They look at them and see the things that are being delayed.

8 It's hard to **predict** what's next. New **guidelines** haven't been established yet, and everything seems to give way to a less **permanent** version of itself. There's been a shift in the **status** and balance of power between the genders, too. In **conjunction** with women's growing **incentives** to attain higher education, college **completion** has now shifted in favor of women. Women have also gained **representation**, and many of them have become leaders at work and in society.

9 Apart from anything else, this has had an **implicit** effect on courtship. College graduates are not so anxious to get married. Their educational background has made them more **autonomous**. They would like to discover what kind of life they really want before settling down and having a family. Considering all of this, it's beneficial to know that even though graduates are delaying many things after college, surveys show they still hold highly traditional aspirations. For example, the **contemporary** generation rates parenthood even more highly than previous generations did!

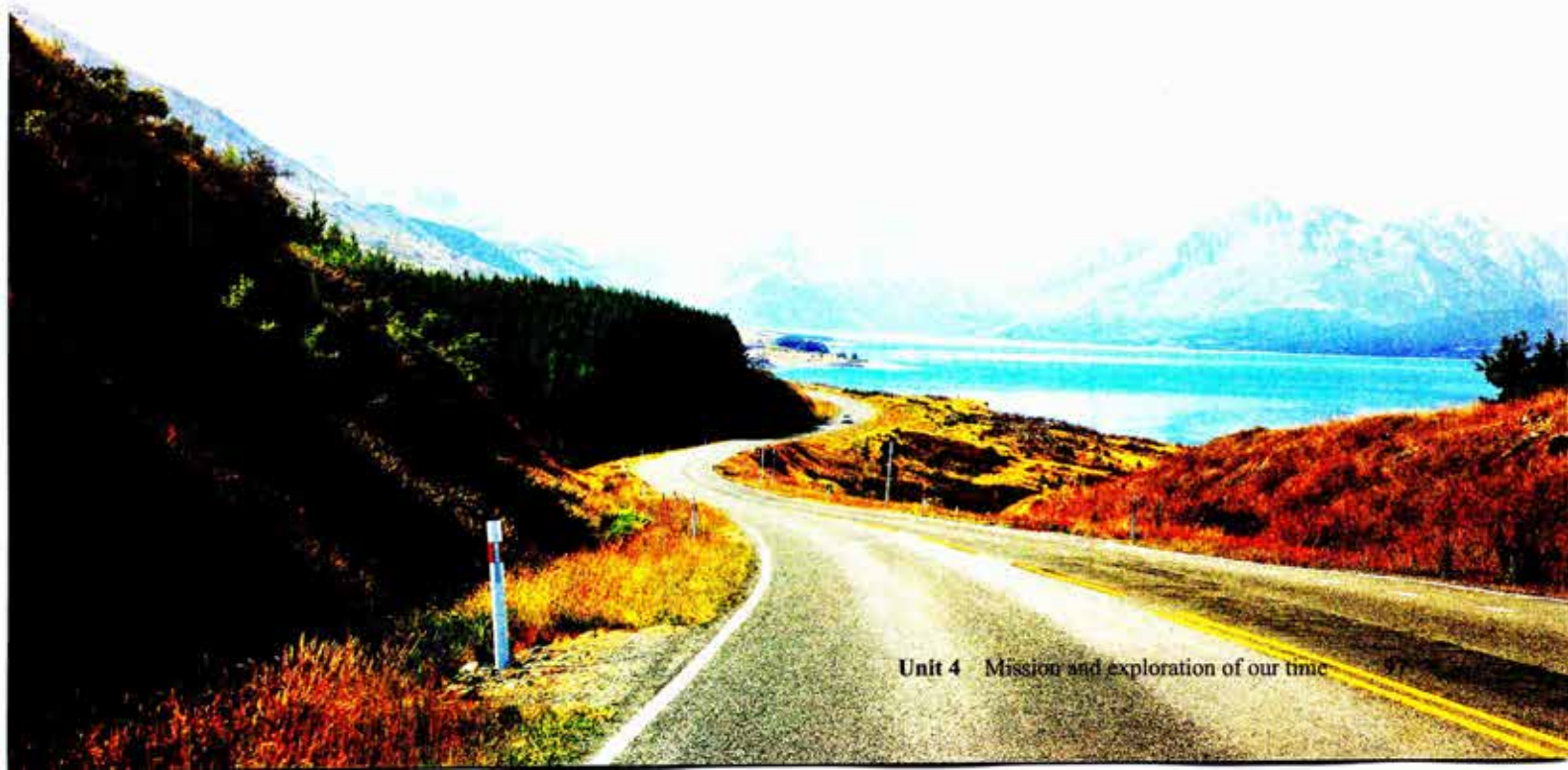
10 This new phase will likely grow more pronounced in the coming years. Nations around the world have **witnessed** similar trends toward delaying marriage and spending more years than ever shifting between higher education and settling down with a career and family. Nevertheless, graduates shouldn't be **deceived** into thinking they can back off simply because things have become more difficult. So, from the outset, keep your **résumé** professional and up-to-date.

11 To **reinforce** this essential message, success in moving through the odyssey years will come to those who don't expect to achieve their goals right away but know that they must have the strength, capacity, and confidence to endure over the long term. If you're a little late with your goals, don't feel like a failure! Stay strong, be positive, and keep focused! Someday you will look back and wonder at the vast changes as you passed through the odyssey years.

(*835 words*)

Culture notes

the odyssey years: a life phase which appears between adolescence and adulthood. The *Odyssey* is one of the two major ancient Greek poems attributed to the Greek author Homer. The poem mainly centers on the Greek hero Odysseus and his long journey home. For English speakers, *an odyssey* has become a special term for an epic journey and great struggle. And the term *the odyssey years* refers to the period when young people are wandering and exploring life to discover themselves.



New words

▲ **phase** /feɪz/ *n.* [C] one of the stages of a process of development or change 阶段；时期

▲ **label** /ˈleɪbəl/

vt. attach a label onto sth. or write information on sth. 贴标签于；用标签标明

n. [C] a piece of paper or another material that is attached to sth. and gives information about it 标签

adolescence /ˌædəˈlesəns/ *n.* [U] the time, usu. between the ages of 12 and 18, when a young person is developing into an adult 青春期

▲ **infant** /ˈɪnfənt/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) a baby or very young child 婴儿；幼儿

infancy /ˈɪnfənsi/ *n.* [U]

1 the period of a child's life before they can walk or talk 婴儿期

2 the time when sth. is just starting to be developed 初期；初创期

▲ **peculiar** /pɪˈkjuːliə/ *a.*

1 esp. true or typical of a particular person, thing, or situation 特别的；独特的

2 strange, unfamiliar, or a little surprising 奇怪的；异常的

▲ **acquaint** /əˈkweɪnt/ *vt.* (*fml.*) (**~ … with**) make sb. or yourself familiar with or aware of sth. 使熟悉；使了解

▲ **previous** /ˈpriːviəs/ *a.*

1 (*only before noun*) having happened or existed before the event, time, or thing that you are talking about now 以前的；先前的

2 (**the ~ day / chapter / owner, etc.**) the one that came immediately before the one you are talking about now 前一天 / 前一章 / 前一个主人等

▲ **norm** /nɔːm/ *n.*

1 [C] the usual or normal situation, way of doing sth., etc. 常态；标准；准则；规范

2 (**~s**) [pl.] generally accepted standards of social behavior 社会准则

induction /ɪnˈdʌkʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the introduction of sb. into a new job, company, official position, etc., or the ceremony at which this is done 就职；入门；就职仪式

▲ **sensible** /ˈsensəbəl/ *a.*

1 reasonable, practical, and showing good judgment 明智的；合理的；实际的；有判断力的

2 suitable for a particular purpose, and practical rather than fashionable 适当的；合理的；朴素实用的

▲ **equivalent** /ɪˈkwɪvələnt/

a. having the same value, purpose, job, etc. as a person or thing of a different kind 等值的；等同的；相当的

n. [C] sth. that has the same value, purpose, job, etc. as sth. else 等价物；等同物；对应物

▲ **radical** /ˈrædɪkəl/ *a.* (*usu. before noun*)

1 relating to the most basic and important parts of sth.; complete and detailed 根本的；彻底的；完全的

2 in favor of extreme and complete political or social change 激进的；极端的

▲ **quit** /kwɪt/ *v.* (**quit, quit**)

1 (*infml.*) leave a job, school, etc., esp. without finishing it completely 离开（工作岗位、学校等）；离任；辍学

2 (*esp. AmE*) stop doing sth., esp. sth. that is bad or annoying 停止做（尤指坏事或令人厌烦的事）；戒除

▲ **spouse** /spaʊs/ *n.* [C] (*fml.*) a husband or wife 配偶

▲ **stability** /stəˈbɪləti/ *n.* [U] a situation in which things happen as they should and there are no harmful changes 稳固；稳定

static /ˈstætɪk/ *a.* not moving, changing, or

developing 不动的；不变化的；不发展的；静（止）的

▲ **proportion** /prəˈpɔːʃən/ *n.*
1 [C, usu. sing.] a part of a number or an amount, considered in relation to the whole 部分；份额
2 [C, U] the relationship between two things in size, amount, importance, etc. 比例

saddle /ˈsædl/
vt. put a saddle on a horse 给（马）装鞍
n. [C] 1 a leather seat that you sit on when you ride a horse（马）鞍
2 a seat on a bicycle or motorcycle（自行车或摩托车的）车座

▲ **heir** /eə/ *n.* [C]
1 the person who has the legal right to receive the property or title of another person when they die 继承人
2 the person who will take over a position or job after you, or who does things or thinks in a similar way to you 继任人；接班人

▲ **resent** /rɪˈzent/ *vt.* feel angry or upset about a situation or about sth. that sb. has done, esp. because you think that it is not fair（因受委屈而）对…感到愤恨（或不满、憎恶）

▲ **fluid** /ˈfluːɪd/
a. a situation that is fluid is likely to change（形势）不稳定的，易变的
n. [C, U] a liquid 流体；液（体）

▲ **allowance** /əˈlaʊəns/ *n.*
1 [C, U] sth. that you consider when deciding what is likely to happen, what you should expect, etc. 考虑到的事情
2 [C] an amount of money that sb. receives regularly, in order to pay for the things they need 定期补贴；津贴

transition /trænˈzɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] the process of changing from one situation, form, or state to another 过渡；转变；变迁

▲ **predict** /prɪˈdɪkt/ *vt.* say that sth. will happen, before it happens 预言；预料；预测

▲ **guideline** /ˈgaɪdlaɪn/ *n.* [C, usu. pl.]
1 rules or instructions about the best way to do sth. 指导方针；指导原则
2 sth. that helps you form an opinion or make a decision（帮助某人形成观点或做出决定的）指导原则，参考

▲ **permanent** /ˈpɜːmənənt/ *a.* continuing to exist for a long time or for all the time in the future 长久的；永久的；永恒的

▲ **status** /ˈsteɪtəs/ *n.*
1 [U] sb.'s position in a profession or society, esp. compared with other people 社会地位（尤指与其他人相比）
2 [C, U] the legal position of a person, country, etc. 身份

▲ **conjunction** /kənˈdʒʌŋkʃən/ *n.* **(in ~ with)** working, happening, or being used with sb. or sth. else 与…共同；连同

▲ **incentive** /ɪnˈsentɪv/ *n.* [C, U] sth. that encourages you to work harder, start a new activity, etc. 刺激；动力；鼓励

▲ **completion** /kəmˈpliːʃən/ *n.* [U] the act or process of finishing sth.; the state of being finished and complete 完成；结束

▲ **representation** /ˌreprɪzenˈteɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [U] when you have sb. to speak, vote, or make decisions for you 代理；代表
2 [C] a painting, sign, description, etc. that shows sth. 描绘；表现

▲ **implicit** /ɪmˈplɪsɪt/ *a.* suggested or understood without being stated directly 含蓄的；未言明的

autonomous /ɔːˈtɒnəməs/ *a.*
1 (*fml.*) having the ability to work and make decisions by yourself without any help from anyone else 有自主能力的；自主的

2 (of a country, region, or organization) able to govern itself or control its own affairs （国家、地区或组织）自治的，有自治权的

▲ **contemporary** /kənˈtempərəri/ *a.*

1 belonging to the present time 当代的

2 alive or existing at the same time as a particular event or person 同时代的；当时的

▲ **witness** /ˈwɪtnəs/ *vt.*

1 be the place, period, organization, etc. in which particular events take place 是发生…的地点（或时间、组织等）；见证

2 see sth. happen, esp. a crime or an accident 目击，亲眼看见（尤指罪案或事故）

▲ **deceive** /dɪˈsiːv/ *vt.* make sb. believe sth. that is not true 欺骗

▲ **résumé** /ˈrezjʊmeɪ/ *n.* [C] (*BrE* **CV**) a short written account of your education and your previous jobs that you send to an employer when you are looking for a new job 个人简历

▲ **reinforce** /ˌriːənˈfɔːs/ *vt.*

1 give support to an opinion, idea, or feeling, and make it stronger 加强，强化（观点、思想或感觉）

2 make part of a building, structure, piece of clothing, etc. stronger 加强，加固（建筑的一部分、结构等）；使（衣物的某个部位）更结实

Phrases and expressions

take a break from stop doing sth. for a short period of time, esp. in order to rest or to focus one's energy elsewhere 中断；暂停

return to sth. change back to a previous state or situation 恢复（原状）

saddle sb. with sth. make sb. have a job or problem that is difficult or boring and that they do not want 使…承担（苦差事）

keep a distance from stay far enough away from sb. or sth. to be safe 与…保持距离

run away from leave a place, esp. secretly, in order to escape from sb. or sth.（尤指秘密地）（从…）逃跑，（从…）出逃

make allowance(s) for sth. consider sth., e.g. when you are making a decision or planning sth. 考虑到；估计到

give way to be replaced by sth. else 被…取代

have an effect on make a change in one person or thing 对…产生作用

deceive sb. into doing sth. trick sb. so as to make them do sth. 欺骗某人做某事

back off stop supporting sth., or decide not to do sth. you were planning to do 退出；放弃

wonder at feel surprised and unable to believe sth. 对…感到惊讶

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 What is the significance of knowing the different life stages?
- A We can find out the causes of some personal problems.
- B We can get familiar with the peculiar set of challenges.
- C We can understand the sequence of different age groups.
- D We can overcome the challenges of the different life stages.

2 What was understood as a norm for students traditionally?
- A Delaying their marriage after college.
- B Continuing with study after graduation.
- C Starting a family before finding an ideal job.
- D Having a job and starting a family right after college.

3 Why is the new life stage unavoidable for young people?
- A They don't know how to face challenges.
- B They lack motivation to move forward.
- C They are learning how to deal with stress.
- D They are following a new trend of lifestyle.

4 What do young people like to do in contrast to their parents?
- A They delay life exploration and initial employment.
- B They delay employment, marriage, and childbearing.
- C They lead a static lifestyle to avoid stress and challenges.
- D They lead a relaxing life with their family and friends.

5 How do some young people in their odyssey years react to their parents?
- A They display rebellious and prideful attitudes and behavior.
- B They display distant and resentful attitudes and behavior.
- C They show their confusion why parents don't understand them.
- D They show their anger why they have to bear so much stress.

6 How do the parents respond to their children's delay in doing things?
- A Encourage them to move on.
- B Look at them without any ideas.
- C Worry about their prolonged transition.
- D Try to detect a clear direction in their life.

7 What do surveys show about young people in their odyssey years?
- A Young people still hold highly traditional aspirations.
- B There would be a shift in the status between genders.
- C Success comes to those who achieve their goals right away.
- D The world has witnessed similar trends about young people.

8 What do the odyssey years mean to young people according to the text?
- A A time to establish their career.
- B A time to discover themselves.
- C A time to gain life experience.
- D A time to get the meaning of life.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Do you think the odyssey years could lead to self-discovery? Why or why not?
2 How can young people cope with this difficult time period – the odyssey years?
3 If your parents were anxious about your odyssey years, what would you do to relieve their anxiety?
4 How would you compare your life exploration with Huang Danian's?

Collocation



This unit addresses a new topic: mission and exploration of our time. Though Huang Danian left us, his noble spirit has greatly inspired the whole nation, especially college students who are engaged in life exploration. From Text A, you have learned quite a few collocations concerning Huang Danian, such as ***strategic scientist***, ***explicit words***, ***urgent need***, ***science community***, ***accurate data***, and ***rejuvenate the nation***. From Text B, you have learned some collocations about young people's journey of self-discovery, including ***peculiar challenge***, ***radical change***, ***unavoidable stage***, ***transition phase***, and ***traditional aspirations***.

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
unique	strong
inspirational	independent
stay	a dream
enormous	phase
financially	achievement
fulfill	choice
exceptional	story
random	pressure

4 Read the passage regarding Huang Danian. Complete it with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations.

There is a geophysical service company in Cambridge, England. Before returning to the motherland, Huang Danian, the Chinese 1) *sc*_____ *scientist*, worked there. He led his team to achieve various technological breakthroughs and obtained 2) *ac*_____ *data* on deep earth exploration.

However, Huang had never forgotten his commitment to the motherland and his mission to 3) *re*_____ *the nation*. At the end of 2009, he returned home with his family. It was not a 4) *ran*_____ *choice*. As a distinguished expert, he served as a full-time professor at his alma mater, Jilin University, and the chief scientist of the earth exploration project.

This project gathered more than 400 outstanding scientific and technical personnel from the 5) *s*_____ *community* across the country to carry out the research on two major issues: precise measurement technology and key equipment for deep earth exploration, both of which our country was in 6) *ur*_____ *need* of. Ever since then, the 7) *en*_____ *pressure* to narrow the technical gaps between China and developed countries became Huang and other personnel's motivation to work tirelessly.

By 2016, the research team led by him had made 8) *ex*_____ *achievements*, which were selected for a national exhibition, alongside achievements of many other famous scientists. Looking back on the 9) *pe*_____ *challenges* and hardships, he said calmly, "I am a product of the country. As long as the motherland needs me, I will go all out." What 10) *ex*_____ *words*!

Huang Danian is definitely one pillar of the motherland. He raced against time to 11) *f*_____ *the dream* to rejuvenate China and make the motherland shine. His 12) *in*_____ *story* will forever inspire us to forge ahead along the path he took – the best way to commemorate him.

Stories of China

The May Fourth spirit alive in China

The May Fourth Movement was a patriotic campaign launched in 1919 by young Chinese students and intellectuals to fight imperialism (帝国主义) and feudalism (封建主义). It is regarded as a mark of the beginning of a new historical stage, called "the new-democratic revolution". Young students and intellectuals played an important role in pursuing social transformation and national modernization over the past century.

Born and raised in the period of Chinese reform and opening up, today's young people are tech-smart, respectful of Chinese traditions, and objective when looking at Western culture. They are referred to as the Bird's Nest Generation (鸟巢一代), the Ice and Snow Generation, etc., signaling self-confidence, love of peace, patriotism, openness, and friendliness.

No matter how we label them, the Chinese youth have sent out the message that they are willing to take responsibility and make contributions to society. Since COVID-19 suddenly hit the country, they have done an amazing job, with a strong sense of responsibility and remarkable resilience (适应力). Many young people, including doctors, nurses, and rescue workers, rushed to the front line risking their own lives. Their conviction and dedication prove once again the promising future of the Chinese nation.



The young people at the ceremony marking the 100th anniversary of the founding of the CPC

The May Fourth spirit refers to patriotism, progress, democracy, and science, with patriotism at the core. Carrying on the May Fourth spirit in this new era, young Chinese people are also showing their patriotism by participating in volunteer work. They believe the experience of being a volunteer can teach them many things that they would otherwise never learn. For example, quite many young people offered to help earthquake victims in hospitals, despite the fact that some were frightened to see people who got severe injuries. They fought hard to overcome their fear in order to help patients.

Moreover, hundreds of thousands of college graduates have offered their services in the countryside. They have volunteered to be teachers in remote areas. Some of them went to villages to conduct social surveys but decided to stay and teach at village schools moved by the children's enthusiasm for learning.

All generations are marked by the time they live in. The task the Chinese youth are facing today is as exciting and challenging as that of their predecessors. Carrying the May Fourth spirit forward means that today's young people are advancing to build socialism with their unique characteristics. Thriving young people will lead to a thriving nation. The May Fourth spirit will continue to serve as the inexhaustible source of inspiration and motivation to the Chinese youth.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 丝绸之路（the Silk Road）是中国古代的交通线路网络，也是中国最早用于国际贸易和文化交流的渠道。

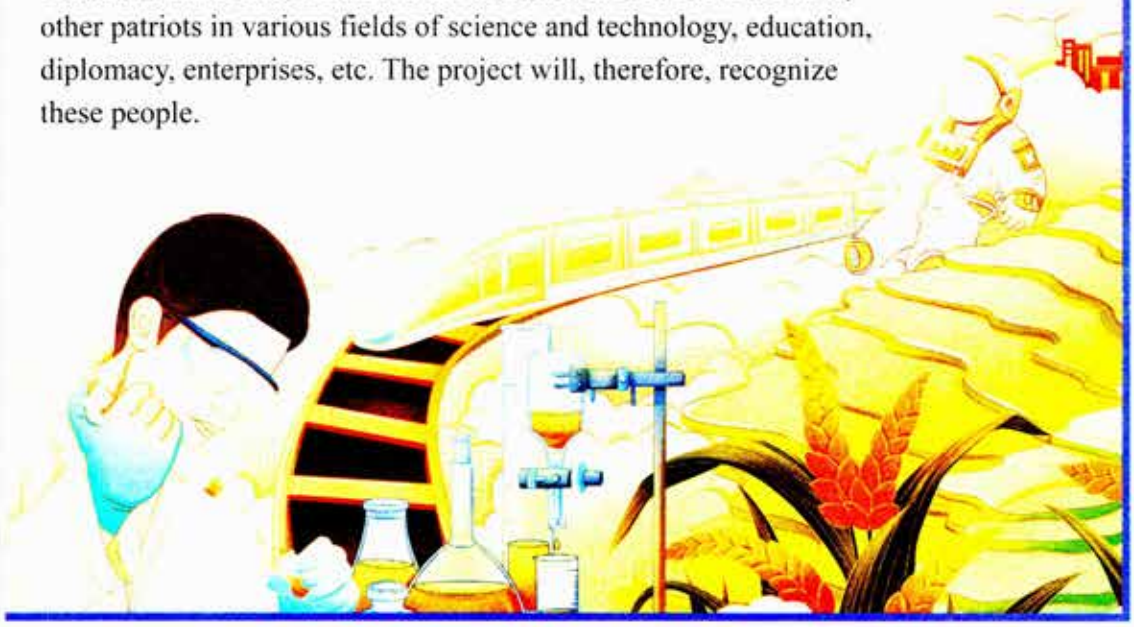
2 在古代，丝绸之路有效地促进了各国之间经济文化的交流，从而大大推动了世界文明的进程。

3 在新的历史条件下，中国提出了以合作共赢为核心的“一带一路”倡议（the Belt and Road Initiative），得到了沿线各国的积极响应。

Unit project

Writing a report on patriots in our society

This unit project is based on the topic of patriotism. Huang Danian set a wonderful role model for us with his high aspiration to rejuvenate China and his dedication to the motherland. In fact, there are many other patriots in various fields of science and technology, education, diplomacy, enterprises, etc. The project will, therefore, recognize these people.



Step 1 **Work in groups and share names of people you think could be deemed as patriots in various fields.**

Step 2 **Decide on one patriot about whom you will write a report. Search online for their patriotic deeds and achievements. Take notes if necessary.**

Step 3 **Write up a report about the patriot with specific details.**
Your report will include two main parts: what the patriot has done or achieved and what inspirations you get from their stories. For example, their stories have inspired you to acquire cutting-edge knowledge to stay internationally competitive. Or, someone like Zhang Guimei, a teacher who has made unusual efforts to help the children in remote mountains, has encouraged you to search for a career that will benefit society.

Step 4 **Go to your group and share what you've included in the report with others.**

Step 5 **Revise and finalize the report based on the feedback and suggestions from your group.**

Unit

5 Striving for financial health

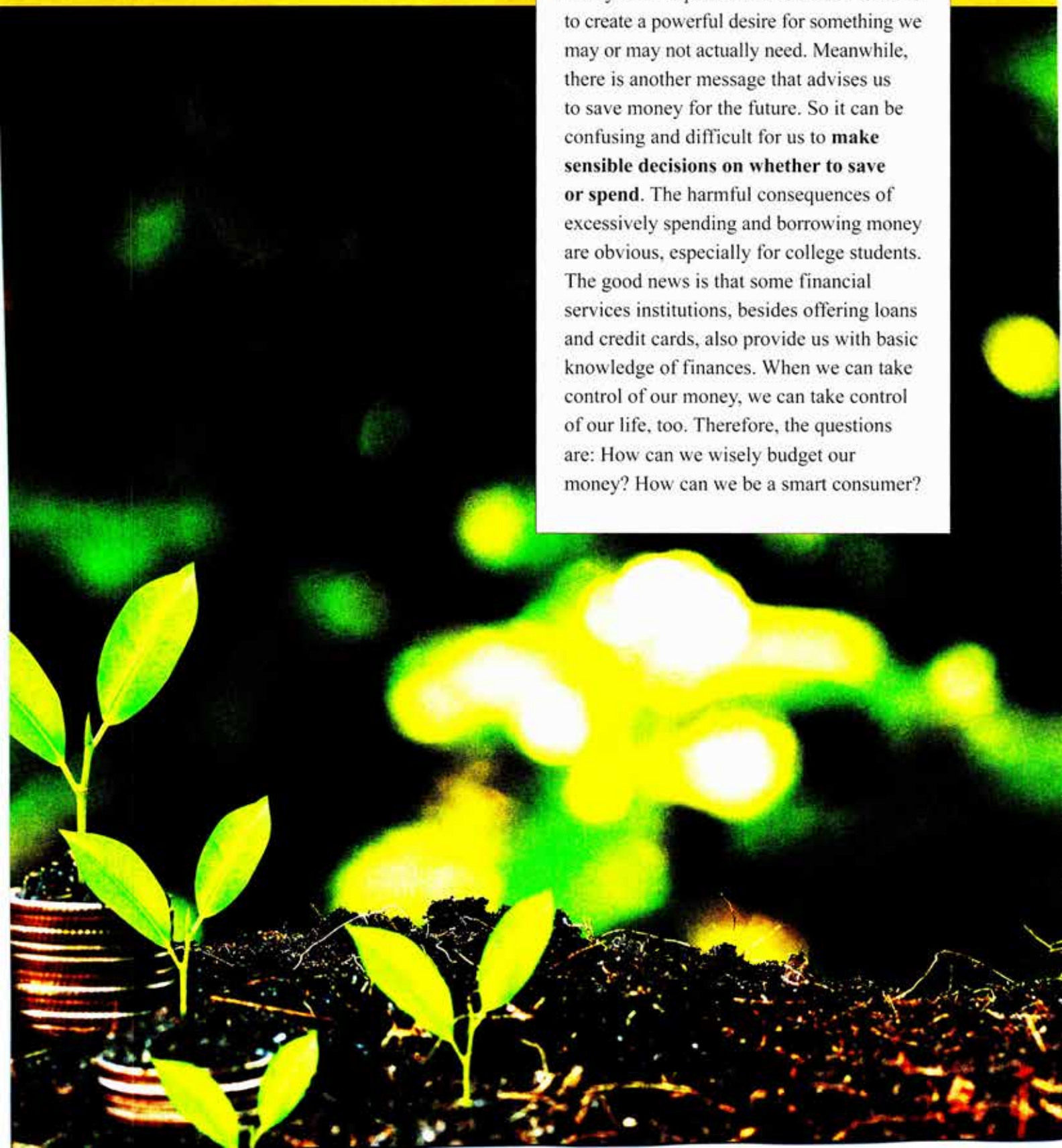
It is not the man who has too little, but the man who craves more, that is poor.

— Lucius Annaeus Seneca (*Roman philosopher and statesman*)



Preview

Today's society is full of tempting commercial advertisements to persuade us to buy various products. Their real motive is to create a powerful desire for something we may or may not actually need. Meanwhile, there is another message that advises us to save money for the future. So it can be confusing and difficult for us to **make sensible decisions on whether to save or spend**. The harmful consequences of excessively spending and borrowing money are obvious, especially for college students. The good news is that some financial services institutions, besides offering loans and credit cards, also provide us with basic knowledge of finances. When we can take control of our money, we can take control of our life, too. Therefore, the questions are: How can we wisely budget our money? How can we be a smart consumer?



Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Read the survey questions regarding spending habits and check (✓) all the responses that are true for you.

1 What is the main source of your daily expenses?

- ☐ A monthly allowance from parents.
- ☐ Income from a part-time job.
- ☐ Grants and scholarships.
- ☐ Student loans.
- ☐ Other: _____

2 What do you spend most of your money on at college?

- ☐ Food and other daily necessities.
- ☐ Books and other study materials.
- ☐ Exercise and entertainment.
- ☐ Clothing and cosmetics.
- ☐ Electronic products.
- ☐ Other: _____

3 Do you spend money based on your budget?

☐ Always. ☐ Sometimes. ☐ Never.

4 What do you usually do to save money?

- ☐ Buy things when they're on sale.
- ☐ Reduce the time spent shopping online.
- ☐ Adopt a habit of eating out less.
- ☐ Limit entertainment activities.
- ☐ Other: _____

2 Work in groups. Compare your responses and then discuss the following questions.

1 What do you have in common in the way you spend?
2 How do you differ in the way you save money?
3 What's your opinion about college students' spending habits?
4 How can you start managing your finances?

Text A

1 If living in the U.S., do you feel as confused and manipulated as I do with this question, "Should I spend or should I save?" I think that the messages we get from our environment seem to defy common sense and contradict each other. The government tells us to spend or we'll never get out of the recession. At the same time, we are encouraged to save more, or our country will be in grave danger. Banks offer higher interest rates so we increase savings. Then the same banks send us credit card offers so we can spend more.

2 Here's another familiar example. If we don't pay our credit card bill on time, we get demanding emails from the credit card company saying something like, "Your failure to pay is unacceptable. Make sure you pay immediately or a further penalty will apply." Then, as soon as we pay, we get a follow-up email in a charming tone telling us how valuable a customer we are and encouraging us to resume spending. Which depiction is correct, a failing consumer or a valued customer? The gap between these two messages is enormous.

3 The paradox is that every day we get two sets of messages at odds with each other. One is the "permissive" perspective, "Buy, spend, and get it now. You need this!" The other, which we could call an "upright" message, urges us, "Work hard and save. Suspend your desires. Avoid luxuries. Control your appetite for more than you truly need." This message comes to us from many sources: from school, from parents, and even from political figures who like to refer to the traditional values – hard work, family loyalty, and the capacity to postpone desires.

4 But the opposite message, advertising's permissive message that pushes us to spend, spend, spend, is also inescapable. Though sometimes **disguised**, the message is everywhere we look: on TV, in movies, on printed media and road signs, in stores, and on buses, trains and subways. Advertisements **invade** our daily lives. We are constantly surrounded by the message. Someone recently said, "The only time you can escape advertising is when you're in your bed asleep!"

5 Each advertisement is doing its **utmost** to influence our **diverse** buying decisions, from the breakfast cereal we eat to which **cruise** line we will use for our vacation. There is no shortage of ideas and things to buy! Now, of course, we don't remember exactly what the products were, but the essential message is **cemented** into our consciousness, "It's good to satisfy your desires. You should have what you want. You deserve the best. So, you should buy it – now!" A famous advertisement said it

Spend or save – the student's dilemma



perfectly, "I love me. I'm a good friend to myself. I do what makes me feel good. I used to put things off. Not anymore. Today I'll buy new ski equipment, look at new **compact** cars, and buy that camera I've always wanted. I live my dreams today, not tomorrow."

6 What happens as we take in these contradictory but explicit messages? What are the psychological and social consequences of this **campaign** to control our spending habits? On one hand, we want more things because we want to satisfy our material appetite. On the other hand, a little voice inside us **echoes** those upright messages: "Watch out, take **stock** of your life, and don't let your attention get **scattered**. Postpone your desires. Don't fall into debt. Wait! Retain control over your own life and it will make you stronger."

7 Anyway, many of the skills you need as a successful student can be applied to your finances. Consider your financial well-being as a key **ingredient** of your university education as money worries are extremely stressful and distracting. They can make you feel terrible and **hinder** your ability to focus on your **prime objective**: successfully completing your education.

8 How can you be a smart and educated consumer? Many schools, community organizations, and even some banks offer financial literacy classes. Consider **consulting** with your school's financial aid office or seeking **input** from your parents or other respected adults in setting up a **budget**. An additional option is finding a partner to help you stay on track and find pleasure in the **administration** of your own financial affairs. Most importantly, if you find yourself getting into financial trouble, don't let your **ego** get in your way; urgently get help with **tackling** your problem before it spins out of control and lands you in legal troubles.

9 All this will help you become an educated consumer and saver. As you learn to balance spending and saving, you will become the captain of your own ship, steering your life in a successful and productive direction through the **choppy** waters.

(*794 words*)

New words

▲ **dilemma** /dəˈlemə/ *n.* [C] a situation in which it is very difficult to decide what to do, because all the choices seem equally good or equally bad 进退两难的境地；困境

▲ **manipulate** /məˈnɪpjəleɪt/ *vt.*

1 make sb. think and behave exactly as you want them to, by skillfully deceiving or influencing them 操纵，控制（某人的思想和行为）

2 work skillfully with information, system, etc. to achieve the result that you want（熟练地）操作，使用（信息、系统等）

▲ **defy** /dɪˈfaɪ/ *vt.*

1 happen in a way that is different from what usu. happens or what you expect 违反

2 refuse to obey sb. or sth. 违抗；不服从

▲ **recession** /rɪˈseʃən/ *n.* [C, U] a difficult time when there is less trade, business activity, etc. in a country than usual（经济）衰退，萧条

▲ **grave** /greɪv/

a. so serious that you feel worried 严重的；沉重的

n. [C] the place in the ground where a dead body is buried 坟墓；墓穴

▲ **penalty** /ˈpenlti/ *n.* [C]

1 a punishment for breaking a law, rule, or legal agreement（因违反法律、规则或合约而受到的）惩罚，处罚

2 sth. bad that happens to you because of sth. you have done or because of the situation you are in 不利；害处

▲ **charming** /ˈtʃɑːmɪŋ/ *a.* very pleasing or attractive 迷人的；有魅力的；有吸引力的

▲ **tone** /təʊn/ *n.*

1 [C] the way your voice sounds, which shows how you are feeling or what you mean（说话的）语气，口气，腔调

2 [sing., U] the general feeling or attitude expressed in a piece of writing, a speech, an activity, etc.（作品、演讲、活动等的）基调，格调；气氛

▲ **resume** /rɪˈzjuːm/ *vt.* (*fml.*) start doing sth. again after stopping or being interrupted（中断之后）继续

▲ **odds** /ɒdz/ *n.* [pl.] **(be at ~ with)** be different from sth. when the two things should be the same（与…）有差异，相矛盾

▲ **permissive** /pəˈmɪsɪv/ *a.* not strict, and allowing behavior that many other people would disapprove of（对许多人反对的行为）纵容的，放任的

▲ **perspective** /pəˈspektɪv/ *n.*

1 [C] a way of thinking about sth. 看法；观点；视角

2 [U] a sensible way of judging and comparing situations so that you do not imagine that sth. is more serious than it really is（对事物的）合理判断，正确认识

▲ **upright** /ˈʌpraɪt/ *a.*

1 always behaving in an honest way 正直的；诚实的

2 standing or sitting straight up（站或坐得）笔直的；挺直的

▲ **urge** /ɜːdʒ/ *vt.*

1 advise sb. very strongly about what action or attitude they should take 竭力劝告；敦促；催促

2 (*fml.*) make sb. or sth. move by shouting, pushing them, etc. 推进；驱策

▲ **suspend** /səˈspend/ *vt.*

1 officially stop sth. from continuing, esp. for a short time 暂停；中止

2 make sb. leave their school or job for a short time, esp. because they have broken the rules（尤指因违规）使暂时停学（或停职）

▲ **luxury** /ˈlʌkʃəri/ *n.*

1 [C] sth. expensive that you do not need, but you buy for pleasure and enjoyment 奢侈品

2 [U] very great comfort and pleasure, such as you get from expensive food, beautiful houses, cars, etc. 奢华；奢侈

▲ **appetite** /ˈæpətaɪt/ *n.*

1 [C] a desire or liking for a particular activity 欲望；喜爱

2 [C, usu. sing., U] a desire for food 胃口；食欲

▲ **loyalty** /ˈlɔɪəlti/ *n.*

1 [U] the quality of remaining faithful to your friends, principles, country, etc. 忠诚；忠实；忠贞

2 [C, usu. pl.] a feeling of support for sb. or sth. 忠心；忠于…的感情

▲ **disguise** /dɪsˈgaɪz/ *vt.*

1 change the appearance, sound, taste, etc. of sth. so that people do not recognize it 掩盖，掩饰（某物的外表、声音、味道等）

2 change sb.'s appearance so that people cannot recognize them 装扮；假扮

▲ **invade** /ɪnˈveɪd/

vt. enter a place, esp. in large numbers or in a way that causes problems 进入；（尤指）涌入，大批进入

v. enter a country, town, or area using military force, in order to take control of it 武力入侵；侵略；侵占

▲ **utmost** /ˈʌtməʊst/

n. [sing.] the most that can be done 极度；极限；最大可能

a. (*also* **uttermost**) **(the ~ importance / respect / care, etc.)** the greatest possible importance, etc. 极为重要 / 尊敬 / 关心等

▲ **diverse** /daɪˈvɜːs/ *a.* very different from each other and of various kinds 不同的；多种多样的

▲ **cruise** /kruːz/

n. [C] a journey by sea, visiting different places, esp. as a holiday or vacation 乘船游览；航行

v. sail along slowly, esp. for pleasure 乘船游览

▲ **cement** /sɪˈment/ *vt.*

1 make a relationship, idea, etc. stronger or more certain 加强，巩固（关系、看法等）

2 (*also* **~ over**) cover sth. with cement 在…上抹水泥

▲ **compact** /kəmˈpækt/ *a.*

1 smaller than is usual for things of the same kind 小型的；袖珍的

2 packed or put together firmly and closely 紧密的；密集的

▲ **campaign** /kæmˈpeɪn/ *n.* [C] a series of actions intended to achieve a particular result relating to politics or business, or a social improvement （为取得某种政治、商业或社会目的而进行的）运动；（宣传）活动

▲ **echo** /ˈekəʊ/

vt. repeat an idea or opinion because you agree with it 附和（别人的观点）

vi. if a sound echoes, you hear it again because it was made near sth. such as a wall or hill （声音）回响；发出回声

▲ **stock** /stɒk/ *n.* **(take ~ of sth.)** think carefully about the things that have happened in a situation in order to decide what to do next （对某事）作出估计（或判断）；估量

▲ **scatter** /ˈskætə/ *vt.* throw or drop things so that they spread over an area 撒；撒播

scattered /ˈskætəd/ *a.* spread over a large area 散布的；分散的

▲ **ingredient** /ɪnˈgriːdiənt/ *n.* [C]

1 a quality you need to achieve sth.（完成某事的）要素，因素

2 one of the foods that you use to make a particular food or dish（烹调用的）成分；食材

▲ **hinder** /ˈhɪndə/ *vt.* make it difficult for sth. to develop or succeed 阻碍；妨碍

▲ **prime** /praɪm/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 most important 最重要的；主要的
2 of the very best quality or kind 质量最好的；第一流的

▲ **objective** /əbˈdʒektɪv/
n. [C] sth. that you are trying hard to achieve, esp. in business or politics（尤指商业或政治方面的）目的，目标
a. based on facts, or making a decision that is based on facts rather than on your feelings or beliefs 客观的；不带个人感情的

▲ **consult** /kənˈsʌlt/ *v.* go to sb. for information or advice 咨询；请教

▲ **input** /ˈɪnpʊt/ *n.*
1 [C, U] help in the form of ideas, advice, or information, used in a process or in making a decision（想法、建议或信息的）投入，输入
2 [U] information that is put into a computer（输入计算机的）信息

▲ **budget** /ˈbʌdʒɪt/
n. [C] the money that is available to an organization or person, or a plan of how it will be spent 预算
v. carefully plan and control how much money you spend and what you will buy with it 编制预算；把…编入预算；精打细算

▲ **administration** /ədˌmɪnəˈstreɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [U] the arrangements and tasks needed to control the operation of a plan or organization 管理；经营；行政
2 [C] the government of a country at a particular time（某一时期的）政府

ego /ˈiːgəʊ/ *n.* [C] the opinion that you have about yourself 自我；自我意识

▲ **tackle** /ˈtækəl/ *vt.* try to deal with a difficult problem 处理，对付（难题）

choppy /ˈtʃɒpi/ *a.* (of the sea, etc.) with a lot of small waves; not calm（海洋等）波浪起伏的；不平静的

Phrases and expressions

get out of escape from 摆脱

do one's utmost do sth. as well as one can by making a great effort 竭尽全力

no shortage of no lack of 不缺少；不缺乏

be cemented into be reinforced in 在…中加强（或巩固）

put sth. off delay doing sth. or arrange to do sth. at a later time or date 推迟；使…延期

take sth. in understand and remember new facts and information 领会；理解；记住

retain control over sth. keep sth. under control 保持对…的控制

consult with sb. seek advice from sb.; discuss with sb. 向…咨询（或请教）；与…商议

stay on track remain in a situation that is likely to lead to success 处在（可能通向成功的）轨迹上

get in one's way prevent sb. from doing what they want 妨碍；阻碍

spin out of control (of an activity or event) change very quickly and in an uncontrolled way（活动或事件）迅速失控

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 How do the messages we get contradict each other?
2 What are the two groups of customers called by the credit card company?
3 What is the upright message according to the text?
4 Why can't we escape from the permissive message of advertising?
5 Why does the author say that there is no shortage of ideas and things to buy?
6 How are people impacted by the two contradictory messages?
7 What does the author suggest students do to be financially healthy?
8 When will students steer their life in a successful and productive direction?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What do you think of the student's dilemma – to spend or to save?
2 What strategies do you know businesses use to attract consumers?
3 How do you know you're overspending and should be alert?
4 In what other ways can you handle your money wisely, in addition to the ways mentioned in the text?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

budget defy dilemma diverse
loyalty manipulate objective
perspective tackle urge

1 The _____ of the "upright" message is to ask people to save, while the "permissive" message asks people to spend.
2 If you find yourself in a(n) _____ about what is the right decision for your career, speak to a career counselor.
3 It is important for parents to listen to their children's opinion because they may have a very different _____ on the things they've seen.
4 To cater for the different tastes of athletes from all over the world, the organizers of the Beijing Winter Olympics prepared _____ dishes.
5 If you want to save money for a rainy day, making a(n) _____ is the first step you may want to take because it gives you a clear plan.
6 The Chinese legend goes that Yue Fei's mother tattooed four Chinese characters on his back to remind him of the importance of _____ to the nation.
7 When children are addicted to online games, they would often _____ their parents and stay online for hours every day.
8 The report goes on to _____ the technicians to take a more active role in developing the standards of artificial intelligence.

9 Many people have no defense against advertising techniques and are often _____ into buying certain products they don't need.

10 The organization has been working with local authorities and officials to _____ the problem of climate change.

Word building



与动词结合构成名词。具体说明请参阅 Unit 3 Word building 部分。

acquire		acquisition
anticipate		anticipation
confirm	>	**confirmation**
fascinate		**fascination**
install		**installation**



与名词结合构成形容词。具体说明请参阅 Unit 3 Word building 部分。

drama		dramatic
hero		heroic
climate	>	**climatic**
emphasis		**emphatic**
metal		**metallic**
photograph		**photographic**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

climatic confirmation emphatic
fascination installation
metallic photographic

1 He developed a(n) _____ with making coffee in different forms of pottery, so he set up a studio in Hangzhou to make various types of pottery.

2 There has been no official _____ that the documents are original, although different sources from the media suggest that they are.

3 This new center will help cultivate a better innovation and business environment for the _____ glass furniture industry.

4 Total construction of the shop took about 30 days including the _____ of the newly-imported machines.

5 According to a research article, _____ warming could affect the productivity of natural plants, largely due to decreased soil moisture.

6 This sentence is in a(n) _____ structure, so it's different from the normal sentence order we are familiar with.

7 A red-light camera is a device designed to collect _____ or video evidence of traffic violations by recording images.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A appetites	**F** manage	**K** regulated
B dilemma	**G** manipulated	**L** retain
C engage	**H** objectives	**M** suspend
D explicit	**I** particular	**N** sustain
E explosive	**J** perspectives	**O** urgent

To spend or save is a question which many people have in their mind. They are always in a(n) 1) _____ whether they should spend the money that they have earned or save that money for the future. Well, there is no 2) _____ answer to the question as different people have different 3) _____ on life, and that is the reason why some people tend to spend all their money while others 4) _____ control over their money.

People who spend all their money do not think much about the future. What they enjoy doing is to get pleasure from spending money. For example, if they like a(n) 5) _____ car, mobile phone, or laptop, they will buy it without giving it a second thought. For them, the most important thing is to satisfy their growing material 6) _____.

In the long run, saving helps people 7) _____ their personal finances as saving helps an individual better plan for future 8) _____ needs. From our everyday life, we can see that individuals who can 9) _____ their spending save money successfully. Instead of buying things on impulse, they delay their purchasing decision and are not easily 10) _____ by commercial ads. Individuals who have responsibility for their family or their loved ones often belong to this group.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

at odds with do one's utmost
put … off retain control over
spin out of control stay on track
take in take stock of

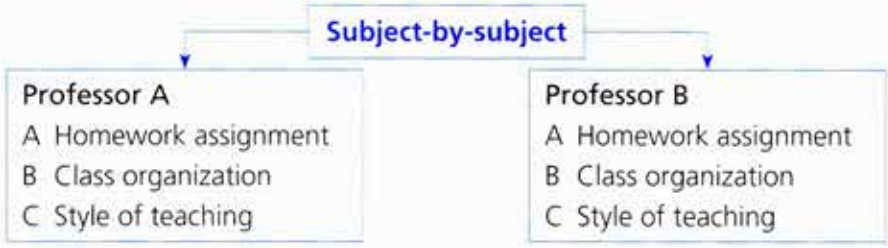
1 My friend planned to travel to Europe in August, but I advised him to _____ going till October when the weather is cooler.
2 The evidence obtained by the police was _____ the statement he provided but consistent with what the witness described.
3 To _____ its steady economic performance, China will work hard to ensure the supply of commodities and keep their prices stable.
4 The working team is well trained, so it has the ability to see, analyze, and react to issues before they _____.
5 Both experts and teachers say that children tend to _____ when they see their parents making similar efforts.
6 As she entered the most dynamic period of her career, Kylie _____ her success and the impact of her college education.
7 The chief executive is confident that current growth levels can be maintained since all the development projects _____.
8 It is very important for students to understand and _____ new information; besides, they should judge the information carefully.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Focusing more on a comparison / contrast essay

You learned how to write a comparison / contrast essay with the point-by-point pattern in Unit 4. This unit will elaborate more on this writing mode with a focus on the subject-by-subject pattern. Let's take a look at the diagram below to see how you can organize the details with the subject-by-subject pattern.



Unlike the point-by-point pattern, the subject-by-subject pattern requires you to talk about all the points at one time regarding Professor A, and then to compare or contrast all the points about Professor B following the same order. In this way, you show your reader the similarities or differences between these two professors. There are usually two body paragraphs when you use this pattern because each subject usually forms one body paragraph.

Now, let's look at Paras. 3-4 from Text A to see how the subject-by-subject pattern is used to compare the two sets of messages.

The paradox is that every day we get two sets of messages at odds with each other.

... The other, which we could call an "upright" message, urges us, "Work hard and save. Suspend your desires. Avoid luxuries. Control your appetite for more than you truly need." This message comes to us from many sources: from school, from parents, and even from political figures who like to refer to the traditional values – hard work, family loyalty, and the capacity to postpone desires. (Para. 3)

But the opposite message, advertising's permissive message that pushes us to spend, spend, spend, is also inescapable. Though sometimes disguised, the message is everywhere we look: on TV, in movies, on printed media and road signs, in stores, and on buses, trains and subways. Advertisements invade our daily lives. We are constantly surrounded by the message. Someone recently said, "The only time you can escape advertising is when you're in your bed asleep!" (Para. 4)

You can see how parallel points are presented in the comparison / contrast writing mode. Both paragraphs start with the illustration of their respective message: upright vs. permissive. Then they go on to list the sources – where these messages come from.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops ideas with the subject-by-subject pattern.

Topic

Thrifty people vs. spendthrifts

Introduction

Thesis statement: It's always interesting to compare these two groups of people who live entirely different lifestyles.

Body

Subject A: People who live thriftily

- Go shopping when things are on sale
- Try every means to conserve electricity
- Seldom eat at restaurants

Subject B: People who live lavishly

- Go shopping at will
- Never conserve electricity
- Often eat at fancy restaurants

Conclusion

People have different lifestyles and some are thriftier than others.

While it is good to enjoy spending money, some people may prefer saving money for the future. They are grouped as thrifty people, whereas people who don't care about saving can be called spendthrifts. It's always interesting to compare these two groups of people who live entirely different lifestyles.

Thrifty people tend to use their money very carefully. They often say, "A penny saved is a penny earned." So they don't go shopping unless there is a sale on the things they need. By doing this, they can usually save about 30 percent of the money they would otherwise have to spend. Similarly, they often conserve electricity. For example, they don't often use air-conditioning in summer; instead, they use electric fans. Finally, they don't often eat out at restaurants. They calculate that by cooking at home they can probably save a large sum of money each month.

In contrast, spendthrifts often spend money carelessly and lavishly. They never wait for a sale if they want to shop. They go shopping anywhere and anytime they want. Also, they never think about saving electricity to reduce their bill. They like to have their air-conditioning on 24 hours a day in summer. Moreover, they often eat out and prefer going to fancy restaurants. They never care whether they can save money by eating at home or by only ordering the specials offered at restaurants.

In conclusion, people have different lifestyles and some are thriftier than others. The most important thing is that people should choose a lifestyle that is meaningful to them and can make them feel happy.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

Bryan and Peter's different spending habits

Introduction

Thesis statement: Even though Bryan and Peter are close friends, their spending habits are very different.

Body

Subject A: Bryan's spending habits

- Only spends money when necessary
- Saves money whenever he can

Subject B: Peter's spending habits

- Often spends money on expensive items
- Never saves money for the future

Conclusion

Bryan and Peter are very different in the way they spend money.

More topics

- Two different lifestyles
- My two best friends

Section B

Reading skills

Understanding denotation and connotation

Both denotation and connotation refer to the meanings of words. Denotation is the literal meaning of a word, the one we find in a dictionary. Connotation, on the other hand, is the implied meaning of a word, the one a word suggests to us, or what it makes us feel or think. For the word *die*, for example, the denotation is "stop living". But in the sentence "Some die at 30 but are not buried until they're 70", the word *die* connotes "stop living spiritually" or "stop growing intellectually". Take the word *storm* in two respective sentences for another example: 1) *According to the weather forecast, there will be a storm tonight*; 2) *What he said provoked a storm of debate*. You can easily figure out that the meaning of the word *storm* in the first sentence is denotation, while its meaning in the second sentence is connotation, because one is the word's meaning in a dictionary and the other is the word's meaning from one's mind. So connotation contains the implications and associations that a word may carry, in contrast to its denotative meanings.

The important thing is that you need to be aware of the context in which the words appear and their connotations. Generally speaking, the more you perceive the connotations of words, the better you understand what a writer wants you to feel or think. Read carefully the following sentences from Text A, and pay attention to the underlined words. These words have clear connotations as well as denotations.

Example 1

Here's another familiar example. If we don't pay our credit card bill on time, we get demanding emails from the credit card company saying something like, "Your failure to pay is unacceptable. Make sure you pay immediately or a further penalty will apply." (Para. 2)

Denotation: expecting to have things exactly the way you want them, especially in a way that is not fair

Connotation: The word implies that these emails sent by the credit card company are rigid and unfriendly, which makes people feel pushed and annoyed.

Example 2

Advertisements invade our daily lives. We are constantly surrounded by the message. (Para. 4)

Denotation: to enter a place, especially in large numbers or in a way that causes problems

Connotation: It connotes a sense of forcefulness and it also has an implied meaning of being overwhelming, resented, and unwanted.

I Read Text B and pay attention to the underlined words in the following sentences. Then write their denotations and connotations. The first one has been done for you.

1 After all, a major feature of college life in the U.S. is limited finances, so free stuff is like gold. As a college student, I felt entitled to my share! (Para. 1)

Denotation: a valuable soft yellow metal that is used to make coins, jewelry, etc.

Connotation: It implies how anxious the author was to get something free. He felt so excited about it, as if he had found gold.

2 I moved closer to scout out the situation. (Para. 2)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

3 To my sheer amazement, plastic freedom made its way into my mailbox a few weeks later. (Para. 3)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

4 With my artificial sense of security, I bought a guitar, a fishing rod, long-stem roses for my girlfriend, a brand-new wardrobe, a sophisticated new calculator, and countless other trifles I felt I "absolutely needed". (Para. 4)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

5 Friends would call and invite me for dinner, but my finances would prohibit any expenses, so I'd decline every time. I would manufacture excuses for why I always said no to their offers. (Para. 7)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

6 A simple matter of credit card debt caused me to drive everything I cared about from my life. I felt emotionally crippled and financially bankrupt! (Para. 7)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

7 I choked on every word, and I hesitated on the number. I felt physical pain when I looked her in the eye. (Para. 8)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

8 If this does not change, many students, like myself, will suffer the consequences of the illusion of a seemingly free but staggeringly expensive $3,000 dictionary. (Para. 10)

Denotation: _____

Connotation: _____

Text B

1 I remember a day some years back, one of the first days of a new semester in college. People were tossing balls, passing out **catalogs**, and handing out free stuff. I was completely charmed by all the activity. After all, a major feature of college life in the U.S. is limited finances, so free stuff is like gold. As a college student, I felt **entitled** to my share!



2 I moved closer to **scout** out the situation. In my mind, I heard my mother **issue** her famous line: "There is no such thing as free stuff!", as the student behind the table urged me to receive a brand-new dictionary. My mom's voice was quickly **filtered** out as I reached out to claim my gift. I was handed a form instead. Once I completed the credit card application, I was told, I would receive a free dictionary. With the confidence that a **probe** of my finances would reveal the **sheer** weakness of my **profile**, I completed the form and **submitted** it.

3 To my sheer amazement, plastic freedom made its way into my mailbox a few weeks later. At first, I was shocked that these huge credit card **corporations** trusted me, a struggling student holding two minimum wage part-time jobs and paying monthly **installments** on a **purchased** computer. But the credit card company seemed to know more than I did, so I accepted the card and decided it was perfect to develop my own credit just as so many had done before me.

4 My first purchases were **tame**: a T-shirt, vitamins, or a CD, as if I hadn't had the card. Soon, however, I began to buy things that I wanted. With my artificial sense of security, I







bought a guitar, a fishing **rod**, long-**stem** roses for my girlfriend, a brand-new **wardrobe**, a sophisticated new calculator, and countless other **trifles** I felt I "absolutely needed". I began to **accumulate** debt.

5 Things got worse when I lost one part-time job and with it my **funds** grew even smaller, like those now long-dead roses. I began taking cash advances just to eat. There was **barely** enough money from my paychecks to cover basic **ongoing** living expenses, and satisfying the minimum monthly payment on the card was impossible. Now, the **principal** balance doubled due to late payment penalties and other **sanctions** that the credit card issuer **imposed** in accordance with the contract.

6 Usually, I'm not a person who takes things too seriously. I always see the positive side of **negative** situations, but the **gravity** of my credit card debt crisis had left me in despair. My parents provided the tuition for school, so I believed it was my responsibility to take care of everything else in my life. I owed them more than I could possibly imagine, **specifically** their **vision** of a boy becoming a truly autonomous man. Now, I was letting them, and myself, down. Every time my mom called to chat, she always asked if I needed money. I knew her heart would break if I had said "Yes", so I shrugged it off and hid everything from her.

7 I began to lose interest in many activities in which I'd become involved. Friends would call and invite me for dinner, but my finances would **prohibit** any expenses, so I'd decline every time. I would **manufacture** excuses for why I always said no to their offers. My dirty little secret began to tear at my emotional stability. Soon, calls from friends became more infrequent, meeting new people was out of the question, and my mom began exclaiming she didn't know why she even **bothered** to call me. A simple matter of credit card debt caused me to drive everything I cared about from my life. I felt emotionally **crippled** and financially **bankrupt**!

8 After graduation, I finally explained my financial distress to my mother. It had been several years since my awful money issues began, so I believed the wound had been fairly well **healed**. However, the **blend** of **disgust** and embarrassment I felt when I explained my credit card debt was **torture**. I choked on every word, and I hesitated on the number.

I felt physical pain when I looked her in the eye. There was nothing more terrifying to me than **exemplifying** a parent's nightmare. The time had come to move toward a solution. At that moment, I felt the negativity I had brought into my life began to dissolve.

9 Recently I learned that I'm not an **isolated** case, not the only college student to suffer from credit card **chaos**. In a time of sky-high tuition costs, many students fall to the temptation of easily accessible credit cards. They are left with **tremendous** amounts of debt before their lives have even truly begun.

10 Credit card is not the criminal. However, there is a suspicion that credit card companies have provided students with access to debt because they allow young, ignorant consumers without sufficient funds to undertake financial responsibility. To **remedy** this situation, the screening procedures must become more **severe**, and college campuses should be free of credit card marketers. If this does not change, many students, like myself, will suffer the consequences of the **illusion** of a seemingly free but **staggeringly** expensive $3,000 dictionary.

(*872 words*)

Culture notes

cash advance: a service provided by most credit card issuers. The service allows cardholders to withdraw cash up to a certain limit, either through an ATM or over the counter at a bank. The interest rate and additional fees charged for credit card cash advances are much higher than those charged for credit card purchases.

principal balance: the amount unpaid on a loan that needs to be repaid to clear the debt. It does not include any future interest, possible charges, or service fees. In other words, the principal balance is equal to the full amount of money initially borrowed minus what has already been paid, not including any of the interest and fees that need to be paid. Generally speaking, the principal balance won't increase, but the total balance will if the borrower gets late payment penalties and other sanctions such as the higher rate for not being able to pay the minimum. When the text says "the principal balance doubled due to late payment penalties and other sanctions", it means the current total balance accumulated to twice as much as the initial principal.

New words

▲ catalog /ˈkætəlɒg/
n. [C] (*AmE*) (*also* **catalogue**) a complete list of things that you can look at, buy, or use, e.g. in a library or at an art show 目录
vt. (*AmE*) (*also* **catalogue**) make a complete list of all the things in a group 为…编目录；把…列入目录中

▲ entitle /ɪnˈtaɪtl/ *vt.* give sb. the official right to do or have sth. 使有权利；使有资格

▲ scout /skaʊt/
vt. (*also* ~ **out**) examine a place or area in order to get information about it 对（某地）进行侦察
vi. (*also* ~ **around / round**) look for sth. in a particular area（在某地区）寻找

▲ issue /ˈɪʃuː/
vt. officially make a statement, give an order, warning, etc. 发表（声明）；颁布，发出（命令、警告等）
n. [C] a subject or problem that is often discussed or argued about, esp. a social or political matter that affects the interests of a lot of people（尤指社会或政治方面的）议题，争论的问题

▲ filter /ˈfɪltə/ *vt.* pass sth. through a filter to remove particular things contained in it 过滤

probe /prəʊb/
n. [C] a complete and careful investigation of sth. 探究；详细调查
v. ask questions in order to find things out, esp. things that other people do not want you to know 调查；打探；探究

▲ sheer /ʃɪə/ *a.* (*only before noun*) used for emphasizing the amount or degree of sth. 纯粹的；全然的；绝对的

profile /ˈprəʊfaɪl/
n. [C] a short description that gives important details about a person, group of people, or place 人物简介；传略；（某地方的）概况
vt. write or give a short description of sb. or sth. 写…的传略（或概况）

▲ submit /səbˈmɪt/
vt. give a plan, piece of writing, etc. to sb. in authority for them to consider or approve 呈送，提交，呈递（计划等）
v. (*fml.*) agree to obey a rule, a law, or the decision of sb. in authority（使）遵守；（使）服从

▲ corporation /ˌkɔːpəˈreɪʃən/ *n.* [C] a big company, or a group of companies acting together as a single organization 大型公司；企业集团

▲ installment /ɪnˈstɔːlmənt/ *n.* [C] one of a series of regular payments that you make until you have paid all the money you owe（分期付款中的）一期付款

▲ purchase /ˈpɜːtʃɪs/
vt. (*fml.*) buy sth. 购买
n. [C, U] (*fml.*) sth. you buy, or the act of buying it 购买（物）

▲ tame /teɪm/ *a.*
1 (*infml.*) dull and disappointing 平淡的；枯燥乏味的
2 (of animals, birds, etc.) not afraid of people, and used to living with them（兽、鸟等）养驯的，驯服的

▲ rod /rɒd/ *n.* [C]
1 a long thin pole used with a line and hook for catching fish 钓竿
2 a long thin pole or bar 杆；竿；棒

▲ stem /stem/ *n.* [C]
1 the long thin part of a plant, from which leaves, flowers, or fruit grow（植物的）茎，梗，柄

2 the long thin part of a wine glass, vase, etc., between the base and the wine top（葡萄酒杯、花瓶等的）颈，柄，脚

wardrobe /ˈwɔːdrəʊb/ *n.* [C]
1 the clothes that sb. has（某人拥有的）全部衣服
2 (*BrE*) a piece of furniture like a large cupboard that you hang clothes in 衣柜；衣橱

▲ **trifle** /ˈtraɪfəl/ *n.* [C] sth. unimportant or not valuable 琐事；无价值的东西

▲ **accumulate** /əˈkjuːmjəleɪt/
vt. gradually get more and more money, possessions, knowledge, etc. over a period of time 积累；积聚
vi. gradually increase in numbers or amount until there is a large quantity in one place 堆积；聚集

▲ **fund** /fʌnd/ *n.*
1 (~s) [pl.] money 资金；现金
2 [C] an amount of money that is collected and kept for a particular purpose 基金；专款

▲ **barely** /ˈbeəli/ *ad.*
1 only with great difficulty or effort 勉强才能
2 almost not 几乎不

▲ **ongoing** /ˈɒnˌgəʊɪŋ/ *a.* continuing, or continuing to develop 继续进行的；不断发展的

▲ **principal** /ˈprɪnsəpəl/
n. [sing.] the original amount of money that is lent to sb., not including any of the interest 本金
a. (*only before noun*) most important 最重要的；主要的

sanction /ˈsæŋkʃən/ *n.*
1 [C] (*fml.*) a form of punishment that can be used if sb. disobeys a rule or law 处罚；惩罚
2 (~s) [pl.] official orders or laws stopping trade, communication, etc. with another country, as a way of forcing its leaders to make political changes（对某国的）制裁

▲ **impose** /ɪmˈpəʊz/ *vt.*
1 force people to accept a rule, punishment, tax, etc. 强制推行；强制实行
2 force sb. to have the same ideas, beliefs, etc. as you 将（想法、信仰等）强加（于某人）

▲ **negative** /ˈnegətɪv/ *a.* harmful, unpleasant, or not wanted 有害的；不良的

▲ **gravity** /ˈgrævəti/ *n.* [U]
1 (*fml.*) the extreme and worrying seriousness of a situation（局势的）严重性
2 the force that causes sth. to fall to the ground or be attracted to another planet 重力；引力

▲ **specifically** /spəˈsɪfɪkli/ *ad.*
1 used when you are adding more exact information 说明确些；具体来说
2 relating to or intended for one particular type of person or thing only 特定地；具体地；专门地

▲ **vision** /ˈvɪʒən/ *n.*
1 [C] an idea of what you think sth. should be like 构想；设想；念头
2 [U] the ability to see 视力

▲ **prohibit** /prəˈhɪbɪt/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) make sth. impossible or prevent it from happening 使不可能；阻止
2 say that an action is illegal or not allowed 禁止

▲ **manufacture** /ˌmænjəˈfæktʃə/ *vt.*
1 invent an untrue story, excuse, etc. 编造（虚假情况、借口等）
2 use machines to make goods or materials, usu. in large numbers or amounts（用机器大量）生产，制造

▲ **bother** /ˈbɒðə/ *v.*
1 make the effort to do sth. 费心；麻烦；因…操心
2 make sb. feel slightly worried, upset, or concerned（使）担心；（使）生气；（使）苦恼

cripple /ˈkrɪpəl/ *vt.* hurt sb. badly so that they cannot walk properly 使跛；使瘸

▲ **bankrupt** /ˈbæŋkrʌpt/ *a.*

1 without enough money to pay what you owe 倒闭的；破产的

2 completely lacking a particular good quality 缺乏（某种美德）的；沦丧的

▲ **heal** /hiːl/

v. become healthy again; make sth. healthy again（使）康复，复原

vt. cure sb. who is ill / sick; make sb. feel happy again 治疗（病人）；使又愉快起来

▲ **blend** /blend/ *n.* [C]

1 a mixture of different things that combine together well（不同事物的）融合

2 a product such as tea, tobacco, or whisky that is a mixture of several different types 混合品（或物）

▲ **disgust** /dɪsˈgʌst/ *n.* [U]

1 a very strong feeling of not liking sth. 反感；厌恶

2 a strong feeling of anger about sth. that is very bad or immoral 愤慨

▲ **torture** /ˈtɔːtʃə/

n. [C, U] severe physical or mental suffering（身心所受的）折磨，煎熬

vt. hurt a person deliberately in a very cruel way, esp. as a punishment or in order to make them say sth. 拷打；拷问；对…施酷刑逼供

▲ **exemplify** /ɪgˈzemplɪfaɪ/ *vt.* (*fml.*)

1 be a very typical example of sth. 是…的典型（或典范）

2 give an example of sth. 举例说明

▲ **isolate** /ˈaɪsəleɪt/ *vt.* separate one person, group, or thing from other people or things 孤立；隔离

isolated /ˈaɪsəleɪtɪd/ *a.*

1 happening only once or existing only in one place 个别的；孤立的

2 (of buildings and places) far away from any others（建筑物或地方）孤零零的，偏远的

▲ **chaos** /ˈkeɪɒs/ *n.* [U] a situation in which everything is happening in a confused way and nothing is organized or arranged in order 大混乱；紊乱；无秩序状态

▲ **tremendous** /trɪˈmendəs/ *a.*

1 very big, fast, powerful, etc. 巨大的；极快的；强有力的

2 excellent 极好的；很棒的

▲ **remedy** /ˈremədi/

vt. correct or improve sth. 改正；补救；改进

n. [C] a way of dealing with or improving an unpleasant or difficult situation 处理方法；改进措施；补偿

▲ **severe** /sɔˈvɪə/ *a.*

1 very strict or extreme 非常严格的；严厉的

2 extremely bad or serious 极为恶劣的；十分严重的

▲ **illusion** /ɪˈluːʒən/ *n.* [C] a false or wrong belief or idea 幻觉；错觉；错误观念

stagger /ˈstægə/

vt. make sb. feel very surprised or shocked 使（某人）惊愕（或震惊）

vi. walk or move unsteadily, almost falling over 蹒跚；摇摇晃晃地走

staggeringly /ˈstægərɪŋli/ *ad.* in a way that is very shocking or surprising 令人极其震惊地

Phrases and expressions

pass sth. out give sth., such as books or papers, to everyone in a group 分发

be / feel entitled to (do) sth. be given the right to have or do sth. 有权利获得某物；有资格做某事

urge sb. to do sth. strongly suggest that sb. do sth. 敦促某人做某事；力劝某人做某事

filter sth. out remove words, information, etc. that you do not need or want 滤除（不需要的文字、信息等）

in accordance with (*fml.*) according to a rule, system, etc. 按照

in despair feeling that you have no hope at all 绝望地

shrug sth. off treat sth. as unimportant and not worry about it 对…满不在乎；对…不屑一顾

hide sth. from sb. deliberately keep sth. unknown to sb. 对某人隐瞒某事

lose interest in sth. stop being interested in 对…失去兴趣

tear at pull violently at sb. or sth. 撕扯

out of the question definitely not possible or not allowed 不可能的；不允许的

suffer from be badly affected by a very difficult or unpleasant situation 受…损害；遭受

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Why did the author feel entitled to his share of the free stuff?
- A He was more interested in a new dictionary.
- B He was more interested in getting free stuff.
- C He believed the free stuff was for everyone in urgent need.
- D He believed the free stuff was for every student on campus.

2 What made him complete the form and submit it at last?
- A The thought that he wouldn't qualify for the credit card.
- B The confidence that he would certainly get a credit card.
- C The deep doubt about what his mother often told him.
- D The curiosity to find out whether he had good credit.

3 What was the reason for his surprise when he received a credit card?
- A He had a poor credit score and history.
- B He was financially rather weak with two part-time jobs.
- C He was not interested in getting a credit card at all.
- D He was more used to cash than plastic credit cards.

4 What was his motive to buy the things he felt he "absolutely needed"?
- A He wanted to show them off to his friends.
- B He wanted to make his girlfriend happy.
- C He wanted to get a sense of financial freedom.
- D He wanted to prove his purchasing power to others.

5 Why did he think that he was letting his parents down?
- A He owed his parents too much money.
- B He concealed everything from his parents.
- C He let his parents pay the tuition for him.
- D He didn't live up to his parents' expectations.

6 What made him feel emotionally crippled?
- A Everything he cared about was taken away from him.
- B His mom wouldn't care about his financial situation.
- C His friends often turned down his invitations.
- D No one wanted to make friends with him.

7 Why did he say it was torture to explain his credit card debt to his mom?
- A He was afraid that his mom would blame him.
- B He didn't dare to talk and meet his mom's eyes.
- C He realized it was a nightmare for his mom.
- D His mom couldn't understand his words.

8 What might be the intent of credit card companies according to the text?
- A To lend college students money for their financial problems.
- B To provide college students with access to money for school.
- C To get huge profit from college students' accumulated debts.
- D To let college students know it's always fine to borrow money.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Should college students be issued a credit card? Why or why not?
2 What are the possible reasons for college students to fall into debt?
3 What can college students do if they've already accumulated debts?
4 What can be the consequences of giving credit cards to college students?

Collocation

More language exercises

This unit raises a new topic: spending habits. As a college student, you must often ask yourself the question, "Should I spend or save?" Some collocations in this unit, therefore, have much to do with this topic such as *suspend a desire*, *retain control*, *buying decision*, *financial trouble* in Text A and *limited finances*, *accumulate debt*, *late payment*, *artificial sense*, *financial distress* in Text B. Many collocation pairs in this unit are practically useful, especially those with the *ad.* + *a.* form.

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
seemingly	accessible
barely	bankrupt
easily	expensive
absolutely	autonomous
financially	need
completely	crippled
truly	free
staggeringly	enough
emotionally	charm

4 Read the transcript of a lecture to a financial literacy class. Complete it with appropriate collocations from the texts. You are provided with the first letter(s) for each of the collocations.

The psychology of spending and saving is a fascinating subject. Through understanding why you spend and why you save, you will more easily handle your 1) *financial dis*_____. That's why I'm really pleased to be able to share this lecture today to help you avoid being in 2) *financial tr*_____! While there is nothing wrong with spending money, going too far can quickly make you 3) *financially ban*_____. There are three key motivating factors behind spending money.

Most people are motivated by having fun, either alone or with others. With 4) *see*_____ *free* products advertised on the Internet or TV, they find it's hard to 5) *sus*_____ their *desires*. Even though there are many ways to have fun for free, a lot of people still enjoy 6) *ea*_____ *accessible* plastic freedom. They feel that the more they spend, the better time they will have.

Sometimes, when people are 7) *emo*_____ *crippled*, they may think that spending money will make them feel better. While this may give them some 8) *ar*_____ *sense* of satisfaction, soon they will have buyers' regrets as they realize that spending money couldn't in fact make them 9) *tr*_____ *autonomous*. And worse yet, they could end up with money worries.

Other times, people are motivated to spend their limited finances because they are 10) *com*_____ *charmed* by a gift for a special occasion such as their friend's birthday. It can be very easy for them to buy 11) *sta*_____ *expensive* gifts in situations like this. Anyway, their 12) *bu*_____ *decisions* are not based on their budget. They buy things out of their artificial feelings.

Stories of China

PROJECT HOPE



Do you know about Project Hope? It's a social welfare program founded by the China Youth Development Foundation and the Central Committee of the Communist Youth League of China in October 1989. Its mission is to mobilize (动员) non-governmental financial resources inside and outside of China to provide and improve education in remote and not fully developed areas.

For the past few decades, Project Hope has raised funds to help countless poor children continue with their studies. It has also built thousands of Hope Elementary Schools and provided abundant equipment for their mini-libraries. Moreover, the program has provided funding for training village school teachers.

About 80 percent of Project Hope's schools and kids are in China's less-developed western and central regions. Out of every 100 rural elementary schools, about 7 are Hope Schools. Hope Internet Schools have also been built to provide distance education to rural teachers and students. What is more, a considerable number of college and middle school students have received Project Hope scholarships. Consequently, Project Hope has become one of the country's best known and most successful social welfare programs.

Jinzhai Hope Elementary School in Anhui Province was the first to be established under Project Hope. In 1990, when it was still under construction, the school received its first donation – 0.4 yuan – from Chai Peiying, an elementary student living a few hundred miles away. Zhou Huosheng, a teacher in Kunshan, Jiangsu Province, sent his first donation in 1993 after reading about the school in the press. Since then, he has contributed 480,000 yuan, helping support more than 1,300 students.



As well as giving donations, people have also helped with teaching for the project. Sun Yongqi started to teach art there in 1991. "Back then, the school was not as well-equipped as it is today, but it already had the best facilities in the area," he said. A two-story building with 27 classrooms housed 500 students, mainly from the neighborhood, along with 30 teachers. Today, the school has become larger. Classrooms feature high-tech multimedia equipment, and the number of teachers and students is steadily increasing.

Yu Gan, a teacher at the school for about 40 years, recalled, "When the new school was ready, the students rushed into the classrooms with roars of laughter, and they were excited to find that it had access to electricity. Some of them wouldn't get up from the new chairs and desks. I wrote a lot on the new blackboard that day, much more than usual."

With the rapid development of China's economy, the central government has increased investment in elementary education to ensure that compulsory education (义务教育) is free to all. Thanks to the investment and the donations from millions of people at home and abroad, more and more children are now receiving formal education at school.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 中庸思想（Doctrine of the Mean）是儒家思想的核心之一，"中"不是折中，而是处理事情时的一种适度的（moderate）方法。

2 孔子主张，应该通过自身修养（self-cultivation）把中庸思想融入日常行为中，使之成为一种美德。

3 一直以来，中庸思想为民族精神的构建、智慧的传播和文化的发展发挥着不可估量的（immeasurable）作用。

Unit project

Reporting on Chinese college students' spending habits

Many recent stories circulating among students are associated with finance, due to students' overuse of their credit card or monthly allowance. This could cause distress and distraction from their academic work. Therefore, this unit project will ask you to report on Chinese college students' spending habits.

Step 1 **Work in groups and design a questionnaire regarding college students' spending habits.**

Your questionnaire can be in different forms such as open-ended questions, multiple-choice questions, or True / False questions. Make sure the questions are appropriate and meaningful, including:

- How they spend their pocket money
- Why they sometimes get into financial distress
- What they can do to solve financial problems
- From whom they can seek help for their problems
- How they can stay in good shape financially

Step 2 **Divide each group into pairs, and each pair interviews five or six students on campus to find out their spending habits. It's better to interview some seniors so that the information can be more complete and valid.**

Step 3 **Share your interview findings in your group, analyze the spending habits of the students interviewed, and give suggestions to students, especially freshmen, about how to make good use of their money and avoid financial trouble. Take notes while discussing the interview results.**

Step 4 **Report to the class your findings, analysis, and suggestions. Toward the end, the class comment on each presentation and vote for the most impressive one.**

Unit 6

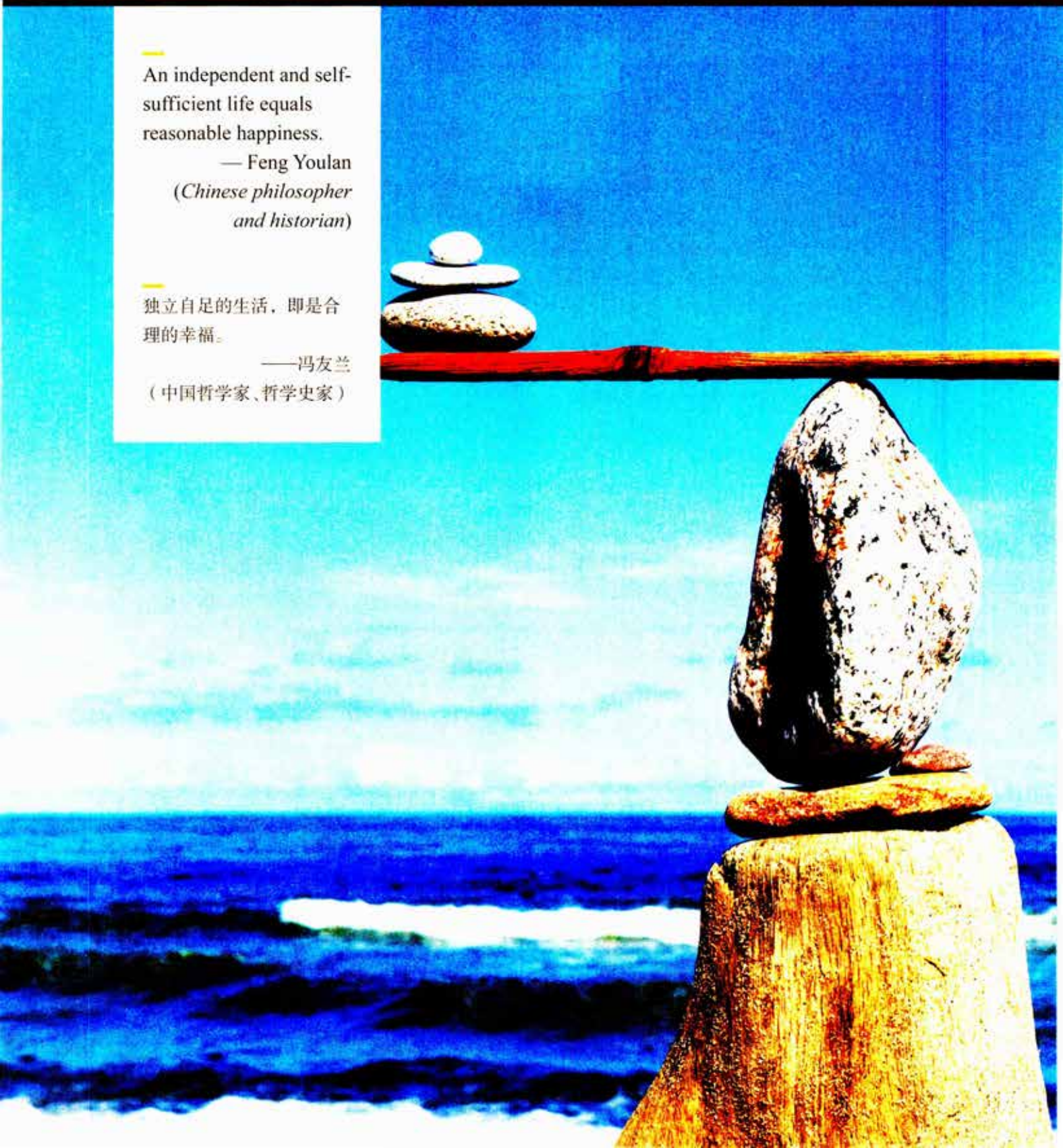
Less is more

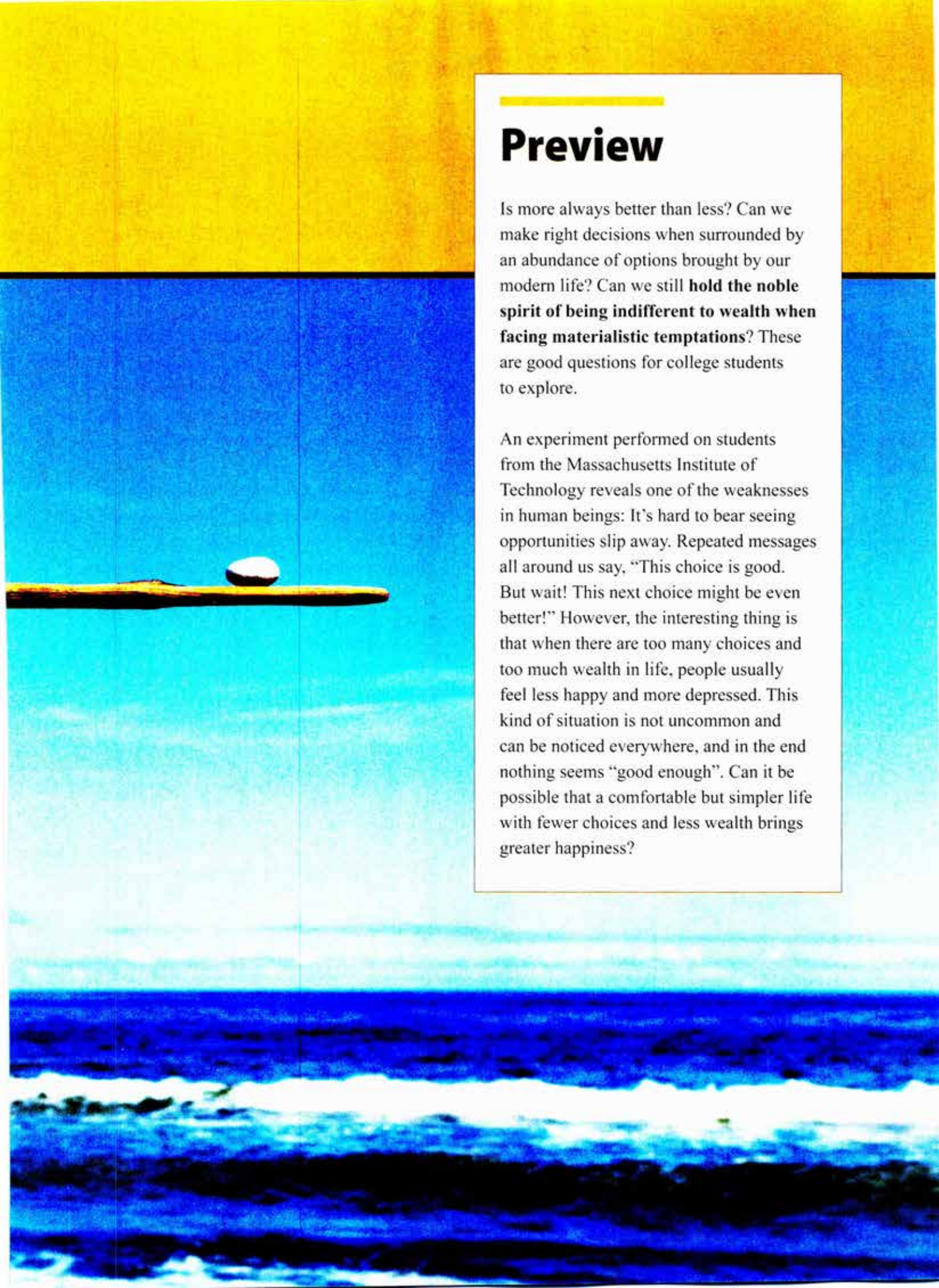
An independent and self-sufficient life equals reasonable happiness.

— Feng Youlan
(*Chinese philosopher and historian*)

独立自足的生活，即是合理的幸福。

——冯友兰
（中国哲学家、哲学史家）





Preview

Is more always better than less? Can we make right decisions when surrounded by an abundance of options brought by our modern life? Can we still **hold the noble spirit of being indifferent to wealth when facing materialistic temptations**? These are good questions for college students to explore.

An experiment performed on students from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology reveals one of the weaknesses in human beings: It's hard to bear seeing opportunities slip away. Repeated messages all around us say, "This choice is good. But wait! This next choice might be even better!" However, the interesting thing is that when there are too many choices and too much wealth in life, people usually feel less happy and more depressed. This kind of situation is not uncommon and can be noticed everywhere, and in the end nothing seems "good enough". Can it be possible that a comfortable but simpler life with fewer choices and less wealth brings greater happiness?

Section A

Pre-reading activities

1 Listen to a talk about how to be indifferent to wealth. Then choose the correct answer to each of the following questions.

Audio clip

_____ 1 What is the biggest risk of money excitement?

_____ 2 What can financially successful people fail to do?

_____ 3 What helps people redirect their money excitement?

_____ 4 What is bigger and more important than money?

_____ 5 What does the speaker say at the end?

A Focusing on achieving something bigger and more important.

B Viewing wealth or an abundance of material goods as the goal.

C Find an amount of money that they think would qualify as "enough".

D Be indifferent to wealth in order to have a happy and fulfilled life.

E Devotion, contribution, and sacrifice, for society and the country.

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 In your opinion, why is money excitement dangerous?

2 Why do you think chasing wealth is only a short-term goal?

3 Why can indifference to wealth help achieve happiness and fulfillment?

Text A

1 The next time you're deciding between **rival** options, one which is primary and the other which is **secondary**, ask yourself this question: "What would Xiang Yu do?"

2 Xiang Yu was a Chinese **imperial** general in the third century B.C.E. who took his troops across the Zhang River on a **raid** into enemy **territory**. To his troops' astonishment, he ordered their cooking pots crushed and their sailing ships sunk.

3 He explained that he was imposing on them a necessity for attaining victory over their **opponents**. What he said was surely motivating, but it wasn't really appreciated by many of his **loyal** soldiers as they watched their **vessels** sink and tents go up in flames. But the **genius** of General Xiang Yu's **conviction** would be **validated** both on the battlefield and in modern social science research. General Xiang Yu was a rare exception to the norm, a **veteran** leader who was highly respected for his many conquests and who achieved enormous success.





4 He is featured in an **enlightening publication**, which introduces a fascinating **investigation** into predictably irrational human behavior, such as the tendency for keeping **multiple** options open. Most people can't **marshal** the will for painful choices, including students at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). In an experiment that investigated decision-making, hundreds of students from MIT couldn't bear to let their options vanish, even though it was clear that they would **profit** from doing so.

5 The experiment **revolved** around a game that **eliminated** the excuses we usually have for refusing to let go. In the real world, we can always say, "It's good to **preserve** our options." Want a good example? A teenager is exhausted from soccer, ballet, piano and language lessons, but her parents won't stop any one of them because they might come in handy someday!

6 In the experiment **sessions**, students played a computer game that provided cash behind three doors appearing on the screen. The rule was that the more cash you earned, the better player you were, given a total of 100 clicks. Every time the students first opened a door by clicking on it, they would use up one click but wouldn't get anything. However, each subsequent click on that door would earn them a **fluctuating** sum of cash, with one door always revealing more than the others. The important part of the rule was that each door switch, even having no cash value, would also use up one of the 100 clicks. Therefore, the winning strategy was to quickly check all the three doors first and then keep clicking on the one with the seemingly highest rewards.

7 While playing the game, the students noticed a **modified** visual **element**: Any door left unclicked for a short while would **shrink** in size and vanish. Since they already understood



the game, they should have ignored the vanishing doors. Nevertheless, they hurried to click on the lesser doors before they vanished, trying to keep them open. As a result, they wasted so many clicks rushing back to the vanishing doors that they lost cash in the end. Why were the students so **attached** to the lesser doors? They would probably **protest** that they were **clinging** to the doors to keep future options open, but that isn't the true factor.

8 Instead of the excuse to **maintain** future options open, **underneath** it all the students' desire was to avoid the immediate, though **temporary**, pain of watching options close. Closing a door on an option was experienced as a loss, and the students were willing to pay a big price to avoid the emotion of loss. In the experiment, the price was easily measured in lost cash. In life, the **corresponding** costs, such as wasted time or missed opportunities, are usually less obvious.

9 As is stated in the publication, "Sometimes these doors are closing too slowly for us to see them vanishing. We may work more hours at our jobs without realizing that the childhood of our sons and daughters is slipping away."

10 So, what can be done to **restore** the balance in our lives? One answer is to implement more **prohibitions** on overbooking. We can work to reduce options on our own, **delegating** tasks to others and even giving away ideas for others to pursue. In marriage, we create a situation where we promise not to keep options open. We close doors and announce to others that we've closed them. We should make a conscious effort to lessen our **load** (resign from **committees**, **prune** holiday card lists, rethink hobbies, etc.) and remember the lessons of door closers like Xiang Yu.

11 In other words, we are encouraged to **discard** those things that seem to have **outward** merit in favor of those things that actually enrich our lives. We are naturally **prejudiced** to believe that more is better, but the experiment conducted at MIT provides a **dose** of reality that strongly suggests otherwise.

12 What price do we pay for trying to have more and more in life? What pleasure and satisfaction can be derived from focusing our energy and attention in a more concentrated fashion? Surely, we will have our **respective** answers.

13 Consider these important questions: Will we have more by always increasing our options or will we have more with fewer, carefully chosen options? What doors should we close in order to allow the right windows of opportunity and happiness to open?

(*892 words*)

New words

▲ **rival** /ˈraɪvəl/
a. (*only before noun*) competing, conflicting, opposing 竞争的；对抗的
n. [C] a person, group, or organization that you compete with in sport, business, a fight, etc. 对手；竞争者

▲ **secondary** /ˈsekəndəri/ *a.* not as important as sth. else 次要的；从属的

▲ **imperial** /ɪmˈpɪəriəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*) relating to an empire or to the person who rules it 帝国的；皇帝的

▲ **raid** /reɪd/
n. [C] a short attack on a place by soldiers, planes, or ships, intended to cause damage but not take control 突袭；袭击
vt. visit a person or place without warning to look for criminals, illegal goods, drugs, etc. 突击搜捕；突然搜查

▲ **territory** /ˈterətəri/ *n.*
1 [C, U] land that is owned or controlled by a particular country, ruler, or military force 领土；版图；领地
2 [U] land of a particular type（某种特定的）地区，地带

▲ **opponent** /əˈpəʊnənt/ *n.* [C]
1 sb. who you try to defeat in a competition, game, fight, or argument（竞争、比赛等的）对手，敌手
2 sb. who disagrees with a plan, idea, or system and tries to stop or change it 反对者

▲ **loyal** /ˈlɔɪəl/ *a.* always supporting your friends, principles, country, etc. 忠贞的；忠实的；忠诚的

▲ **vessel** /ˈvesəl/ *n.* [C]
1 (*fml.*) a ship or large boat 船；舰
2 a vein in your body 血管

▲ **genius** /ˈdʒiːniəs/ *n.*
1 [U] a very high level of intelligence, mental skill, or ability, which only a few people have 天资；天赋
2 [C] sb. who has an unusually high level of intelligence, mental skill, or ability 有天赋的人；天才

conviction /kənˈvɪkʃən/ *n.*
1 [C] a very strong belief or opinion 坚定的信仰（或主张）
2 [U] the feeling of being sure about sth. and having no doubts 深信；坚信；肯定

▲ **validate** /ˈvælədeɪt/ *vt.*
1 (*fml.*) prove that sth. is true or correct, or make a document or agreement officially and legally acceptable 证实；使生效；使合法化
2 make sb. feel that their ideas and feelings are respected and considered seriously 使得到认同

▲ **veteran** /ˈvetərən/
a. very experienced and skilled in a particular activity 经验丰富的；老练的
n. [C] sb. who has been a soldier, sailor, etc. in a war 老兵；退伍军人

▲ **enlightening** /ɪnˈlaɪtnɪŋ/ *a.* (*fml.*) giving information so that you can understand sth. better 富有启发性的

▲ **publication** /ˌpʌblɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C] a book, magazine, etc. 书；刊物；著作；出版物
2 [U] the process of printing a book, magazine, etc. and offering it for sale 出版

▲ **investigation** /ɪnˌvestɪˈgeɪʃən/ *n.* [C] an official attempt to find out the truth about or the cause of sth. such as a crime, accident, or scientific problem（对犯罪、事故、科学问题等进行的正式的）调查，侦查

▲ **multiple** /ˈmʌltəpəl/ *a.* (*only before noun*) many, or involving many things, people, events, etc. 包括（或涉及）多个人（或物、事件等）的；多的；多种的

▲ **marshal** /ˈmɑːʃəl/ *vt.*
1 organize your thoughts, ideas, etc. so that they are clear, effective, or easy to understand 整理（思路、想法等）
2 organize all the people or things that you need in order to be ready for a battle, election, etc. 调集，集结（力量）

▲ **profit** /ˈprɒfɪt/
v. (*fml.*) be useful or helpful to sb. 有益于；对（某人）有好处
n. [C, U] money that you gain by selling things or doing business, after your costs have been paid 利润；收益；盈利

▲ **revolve** /rɪˈvɒlv/ *v.* move around like a wheel, or make sth. move around like a wheel（使）旋转

▲ **eliminate** /ɪˈlɪməneɪt/ *vt.* completely get rid of sth. that is unnecessary or unwanted 消除；根除

▲ **preserve** /prɪˈzɜːv/ *vt.*
1 make sth. continue without changing 保持；维持
2 save sth. or sb. from being harmed or destroyed 维护，保护，保存（使免受破坏）

▲ **session** /ˈseʃən/ *n.* [C]
1 a period of time used for a particular activity, esp. by a group of people（尤指一批人参加某项活动的）一段时间
2 a formal meeting or group of meetings, esp. of a law court or parliament 正式会议；（法院的）开庭；（议会的）会议

▲ **fluctuate** /ˈflʌktʃueɪt/ *vi.* change frequently in size, amount, quality, etc. esp. from one extreme to another（大小、数量、质量等）波动；（在…之间）起伏不定

▲ **modify** /ˈmɒdɪfaɪ/ *vt.* change sth. slightly, esp. in order to improve it or to make it less extreme 改动；修改；更改

▲ **element** /ˈeləmənt/ *n.* [C]
1 one part or feature of a whole system, plan, piece of work, etc., esp. one that is basic or important 基本部分；要素
2 a substance that consists of only one type of atom 元素

▲ **shrink** /ʃrɪŋk/ *v.* **(shrank, shrunk)**
1 become or make sth. smaller in size or amount（使）缩小，减少，收缩
2 become smaller, or make sth. smaller, through the effects of heat or water（使）缩小；（使）收缩

▲ **attach** /əˈtætʃ/
v. **(be ~ed to)** like sb. or sth. very much, because you have known them or had them for a long time 喜欢（或依恋）
vt. fasten or connect one object to another 系；绑；贴；固定；连接；附上

▲ **protest** /prəˈtest/
vt. state very firmly that sth. is true, when other people do not believe you 坚持声称；力言
v. come together to publicly express disapproval or opposition to sth.（公开）反对，抗议

▲ **cling** /klɪŋ/ *vi.* **(clung, clung)** hold on tightly to sb. or sth. 抓紧；紧握；紧抱

▲ **maintain** /meɪnˈteɪn/ *vt.*
1 make sth. continue in the same way or at the same standard as before 保持；维持
2 make a level or rate of activity, movement, etc. stay the same 保持

▲ **underneath** /ˌʌndəˈniːθ/ *prep.*
1 used for describing what sb. or sth. is really like, despite how they may seem 在…里面；在…背后

2 directly under another object or covered by it （掩盖）在…下面

▲ **temporary** /'tempərəri/ *a.* continuing for only a limited period of time 暂时的；临时的

▲ **corresponding** /ˌkɒrə'spɒndɪŋ/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 having similar qualities or a similar size, position, etc. to sth. else 相似的；对应的；相符合的；对等的
2 caused by or connected with sth. you have already mentioned 相应的；由此引起的

▲ **restore** /rɪ'stɔ:/ *vt.*
1 make sth. return to its former state or condition 使恢复
2 bring back a positive feeling that a person or group of people felt before 恢复（某种乐观的情绪）

▲ **prohibition** /ˌprəʊhə'bɪʃən/ *n.*
1 [C] a law or rule that stops people from doing sth. 禁令；禁律
2 [U] the action of officially preventing sth. from being done 禁止

▲ **delegate**
v. /'delɪgeɪt/ give part of your power or work to sb. in a lower position than you（向下级）授（权）；委托（权限）；下放（权力）
n. /'delɪgət/ [C] sb. who has been elected or chosen to speak, vote, or take decisions for a group 代表

▲ **load** /ləʊd/ *n.* [C]
1 the amount of work that a person or machine has to do（一个人或一台机器的）工作量，负荷
2 a large quantity of sth. that is carried by a vehicle, person, etc.（车辆、人等的）负载物

▲ **committee** /kə'mɪti/ *n.* [C] a group of people chosen to do a particular job, make decisions, etc. 委员会

prune /pru:n/ *vt.*
1 get rid of sth. that you do not need or want, esp. in order to reduce the size or cost of sth.（尤指为缩减规模或降低成本）削减，裁减
2 (*also* ~ **sth. back**) cut off some of the branches of a tree or bush to make it grow better 修剪（树枝）

▲ **discard** /dɪs'kɑ:d/ *vt.* get rid of sth. 扔掉；弃置

▲ **outward** /'aʊtwəd/ *a.* (*only before noun*)
1 relating to how a person or situation seems to be, rather than how it really is 外表的；表面的
2 directed toward the outside or away from a place 朝外的；向外的

▲ **prejudice** /'predʒədɪs/
vt. influence sb. so that they have an unfair or unreasonable opinion about sb. or sth. 使有偏见；使有成见
n. [C, U] an unreasonable dislike of or preference for a person, group, custom, etc., esp. when it is based on their race, religion, sex, etc. 成见；偏见

prejudiced /'predʒədɪst/ *a.* having an unreasonable dislike of or preference for sb. or sth., esp. based on their race, religion, sex, etc. 带成见的；有偏见的；偏爱的

▲ **dose** /dəʊs/ *n.* [C]
1 an amount of a particular quality 一份；一点
2 the amount of a medicine or drug that you should take（药物的）剂量

▲ **respective** /rɪ'spektɪv/ *a.* (*only before noun*) belonging or relating separately to each of the people or things already mentioned 各自的；分别的

Phrases and expressions

go up in flames suddenly begin burning in a way that is difficult to control 突然着火；失火

an exception to sth. sth. or sb. that is not included in a general statement or does not follow a rule or pattern …的例外

be featured in be an important part of a show, exhibition, or magazine, etc. 是…的主要内容；在…中被专题介绍

profit from get sth. useful from a situation 从…中受益

revolve around have sth. as a main subject or purpose 以…为主题（或目的）；围绕

be exhausted from be extremely tired from sth. or doing sth. 因…精疲力尽；因…疲惫不堪

come in handy be useful 有用处

pay a big price (to do / for sth.) experience sth. bad or unpleasant as a result of a decision or mistake（为…）付出很大代价

be measured in sth. be judged or assessed by sth. 用…来衡量

make a … effort to do sth. do sth. with a certain kind of effort 付出…的努力做某事

in a … fashion in a particular way 以…方式

Proper names

Xiang Yu 项羽（公元前 232— 公元前 202，中国秦末起义军领袖）

Zhang River 漳河（故名漳水，源出山西，流经河北、河南之间）

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) 麻省理工学院（美国）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What was the purpose of the order given by General Xiang Yu?
2 What was the purpose of the experiment done at MIT?
3 What was the winning strategy of playing the computer game?
4 What was the real reason that the students tried to keep the lesser doors open?
5 Why are the costs often less obvious in life than in the experiment?
6 What does the text suggest about the way to keep the balance in our life?
7 What does the experiment conducted at MIT suggest?
8 What is the message that the text tries to send out?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What do you think about General Xiang Yu's order to his troops?
2 How do you evaluate the experiment on human behavior done at MIT?
3 In what way is the experiment similar to General Xiang Yu's order?
4 In your opinion, why are people reluctant to see their options vanish?
5 How can people make the right decisions when facing different choices?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

discard eliminate enlightening
maintain modify prejudiced
prohibition restore rival

1 People participating in problem-solving activities are often willing to _____ their methods to work out solutions.
2 We are two neighboring countries, and we shouldn't be _____, or a threat to each other, but partners.
3 The film _____ its position as the critics' favorite so far for its surprising and inspiring plot.
4 Though many things have changed in our culture, our commitment and sense of responsibility have never been _____.
5 The Act primarily attempts to add criminal _____ against using the Internet to do anything illegal or unlawful.
6 He's been obsessed with the idea that we are _____ against him, but actually we have been treating him fairly.
7 The doctor says that the regular use of this device can help with sleeping disorders, and healthy sleep patterns can be _____ eventually.
8 Studying the humanities has been enjoyable and _____, providing me with a new and different perspective on the world.
9 We should stay committed to openness, _____ all barriers to the development of productivity, and steer globalization in the right direction.

Word building

-al

可以与名词结合构成形容词。以 -y 结尾的名词构成相关形容词时，末尾变为 -ical。另外，它也可以与动词结合构成名词，表示动词描述的动作或过程。其他相关说明，请参阅 Unit 1 Word building 部分。

tradition		traditional
astronomy		**astronomical**
deny		**denial**
horizon	>	**horizontal**
proportion		**proportional**
renew		**renewal**

-ity

与形容词结合构成名词。以这种方式构成的名词通常表示形容词所描绘的状态或状况。

flexible		flexibility
functional		functionality
odd		oddity
affordable	>	**affordability**
extreme		**extremity**
relative		**relativity**

4 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

affordability astronomical denial
extremity horizontal proportional
relativity renewal

1 I don't appreciate his reply as it was in part a(n) _____ of the criticism and in part an attempt to change the nature of the issue.
2 China has provided medical aid for many countries and has promised to contribute to the accessibility and _____ of vaccines in other developing countries.
3 Several _____ telescope projects have been launched in Qinghai Province to help scientists make breakthroughs in the field of space exploration.
4 The detection of the wave fulfilled the prediction of the general theory of _____ and opened a new window to exploring space.
5 Even in the _____ of his terrible situation, he could not deny that there was something beautiful about life, school, and friends.
6 You may apply for financial aid but can only receive an amount that is _____ to your workload: the courses you're taking.
7 As construction progresses, workers check _____ and vertical levels to ensure that both walls are exactly up to the design requirements.
8 Many provinces in China have carried out the protection and _____ of traditional villages and rural cultures.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A agenda	**F** massive	**K** preserve
B deserve	**G** modify	**L** proclaims
C discarded	**H** motivate	**M** profits
D disproved	**I** notify	**N** revolve
E implement	**J** passive	**O** sensible

Being simple is not necessarily about having less. It can be about having more: more time, more enjoyment, more accomplishment, and more of what 1) _____ you. If some activities don't bring you any benefits, doing less or none of them makes sense, because it may eventually do harm to you to 2) _____ all of them. The purpose of being simple is to remove what's not important.

To understand what should be 3) _____, try to think of activities as either assets or "obligations". An asset is something that is valuable. One 4) _____ example is learning to manage your money. A little more broadly, an asset is anything that can strengthen and 5) _____ you, moving you closer to your goals. However, the "obligations" are a kind of 6) _____ debt, anything that weakens you, moves you farther from your goals, provides negative stress, and creates anxiety.

Then how can you 7) _____ the idea of being simple? Think about your daily activities and set a(n) 8) _____. You list your daily routines such as paying bills and planning a birthday party for a friend. Don't just 9) _____ around your hobbies. Ask yourself if the activities get you closer to your goals. If not, 10) _____ the list – remove what is unnecessary and concentrate on what is more important for you.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be attached to	be exhausted from
be featured in	be measured in
come in handy	go up in flames
pay a big price	revolve around

1 The cell phone has become an important part of our life, and we _____ it so much that we carry it anywhere we go.
2 The support our volunteers provide to the community and society cannot _____ purely practical terms.
3 Please don't forget the Tourist Guide, which should _____ when you travel to different places in Asia and Europe.
4 I can't believe you left the oven on! It's too dangerous since the house might _____.
5 I think students would _____ or miss many opportunities if they don't try hard and don't acquire the knowledge taught at college.
6 If you _____ travel and trying to adjust to a new time zone, you may not be ready to face the challenge of the new environment yet.
7 Though they are not discussed in this particular article, these topics _____ other articles and publications.
8 Class discussions next week will _____ the importance of love, communication, and a close relationship between parents and their children.

Structure analysis and writing

Structure analysis

Focusing on a cause-and-effect essay

In this unit, you'll learn how to write a cause-and-effect essay. Each day you face situations that require cause-and-effect analysis. Some are daily events; others mark important life decisions. When you analyze causes, you ask the question *why*. If you think about the question, you will probably come up with one or more reasons to explain a certain behavior. In this case, you have analyzed the causes. Similarly, when you analyze effects, you ask the question *what*. You usually consider what could be the possible results or consequences of some action. By doing this, you have explained the effects. Very often, multiple causes have a single effect while multiple effects may be the result of one single cause. Look at the examples:

Causes
1 Like business in high school
2 Relatively easier to land a job
3 Feel good with numbers

↓

Effect
Choose accounting as my major

Cause
Reduced working hours

↓

Effects
1 Lower monthly income
2 More time to study
3 More time with family

Since it is hard to include both causes and effects in an essay of 120 words, you are required to focus on either causes or effects instead of both. To write such an essay, it is important to follow these guidelines below.

1 **Have a clear understanding of causes and effects.**
Causes should answer the question: Why did something happen? Effects must explain: What happened or will happen because of something? Look at the following two examples:

Example 1
There are several reasons why living out of campus makes attending class somewhat difficult.
- Less sleep time
- More temptations to skip class
- More distractions from studying

Example 2
Attending college has somehow changed my personality in positive ways.
- More confident
- More knowledgeable
- More communicative

2 **Write an effective thesis statement.**
Make sure you clearly discuss causes or effects in the thesis statement. You're encouraged to list the causes or effects in your thesis statement so that your reader can easily predict what you will discuss in the essay. Look at the examples:

- Celebrated actors lead stressful lives because they have too little privacy, too much pressure, and too little time for themselves. (**Focus on causes**)
- Working longer hours produces some negative effects on people's lives: less time with family, extra stress at work, and serious harm to health. (**Focus on effects**)

3 **Use necessary cause or effect transitions.**
Include appropriate transitions between paragraphs to make your ideas flow more smoothly. Transitions indicating causes include *since, the first reason is, because, another reason is.* Transitions indicating effects include *result in, another effect is, consequently, therefore.*

4 **Give factual details to support your thesis statement.**
Try to use factual supporting details to develop your essay topic so that your points are more convincing to your reader. Also, the details should be presented in order of importance, i.e. arrange the information from least to most important or vice versa.

5 **Conclude the essay by summarizing the causes or effects.**
Give a brief summary of the causes or effects in your conclusion, followed by your final evaluation or comments, whether positive or negative. They can be an opinion, a prediction, a warning, a suggestion, or an appeal.

Now, let's take a look at the analysis of the causes of students' loss in the computer game in Paras. 7-8 from Text A.

While playing the game, the students noticed a modified visual element: Any door left unclicked for a short while would shrink in size and vanish. Since they already understood the game, they should have ignored the vanishing doors. Nevertheless, they hurried to click on the lesser doors before they vanished, trying to keep them open. As a result, they wasted so many clicks rushing back to the vanishing doors that they lost cash in the end. (Para. 7)

Instead of the excuse to maintain future options open, underneath it all the students' desire was to avoid the immediate, though temporary, pain of watching options close. Closing a door on an option was experienced as a loss, and the students were willing to pay a big price to avoid the emotion of loss. (Para. 8)

You can see there are two main reasons that resulted in students' loss in the computer game: 1) They were unwilling to see any doors vanishing from their computer, afraid they might lose some chance to win; 2) They couldn't bear immediate, though temporary, emotional pain of watching options close. Similarly, if you want to analyze effects, you can follow the same structure.

Structured writing

Read the sample essay and see how it develops in the cause-and-effect pattern.

Topic
Why people make poor decisions

Introduction
Thesis statement: There are two major reasons for poor decisions.

Body
Cause 1: Tend to be irrational
Cause 2: Lack reliable information

Conclusion
People make poor decisions because they are sometimes irrational or simply lack complete information.

People are confronted with choices every day. Sometimes they get them right and sometimes wrong. Why do people sometimes decide poorly? In my opinion, there are two major reasons for poor decisions.

The first reason for poor decision-making is that people tend to be irrational when making a decision. Consider a simple example. When people choose a cell phone service provider, they need to look at objective ratings for customer service. However, if someone they know and respect or love says he or she had a bad experience with a particular cell phone service provider, they tend to give that one opinion more weight than any of the thousands of consumer reviews. Consequently, they may make a bad choice which can lead to post-decision regret.

Another important reason for people to make a poor decision is a lack of reliable information. In the real world, the information available to people is rarely perfect or complete, so it's hard for them to predict the consequence of their choices. One typical example is when people buy a used car. For whatever reason, the buyer may fail to get the complete information about the used car, such as its repair or service records. Therefore, they can't estimate the true value of the vehicle. As a consequence, they might end up making a poor decision.

To conclude, people make poor decisions because they are sometimes irrational or simply lack complete information. To make wise decisions, people always need to have a "cool" mind to be rational and do sufficient research to be informed.

7 Write an essay of no less than 120 words on one of the following topics. One topic has an outline that you can follow.

Topic

The causes of people's irrational behavior

Introduction

Thesis statement: Irrational behavior is caused by various factors but two stand out.

Body

Cause 1: Uncontrolled emotions

Cause 2: Too much stress

Conclusion

Uncontrolled emotions and too much stress can result in irrational behavior.

More topics

- Why some people are materialistic
- The negative consequences of being materialistic

Section B

Reading skills

Reading between the lines

Reading between the lines means making inferences about the author's ideas from what is written and from what is not written. Authors don't always express their thoughts directly, but they give you hints or clues that help you "read between the lines". Using these clues to have a deeper understanding of your reading is called "inferring". When you infer, you go beyond the surface details to see other meanings that the details suggest or imply. When the meanings are not stated clearly in the text, they may be implied or suggested. This means that you have to work with the author to discover their meanings.

Reading between the lines usually requires close, careful reading of the entire text, rather like detective work! By using contextual clues, common sense, and your background knowledge, by connecting ideas and drawing conclusions, by forming and testing ideas about what the author is trying to say, you can "fill in the blanks" and discover the author's real meaning. That's a big part of what effective reading is all about.

Example 1

The next time you're deciding between rival options, one which is primary and the other which is secondary, ask yourself this question: "What would Xiang Yu do?" (Para. 1)

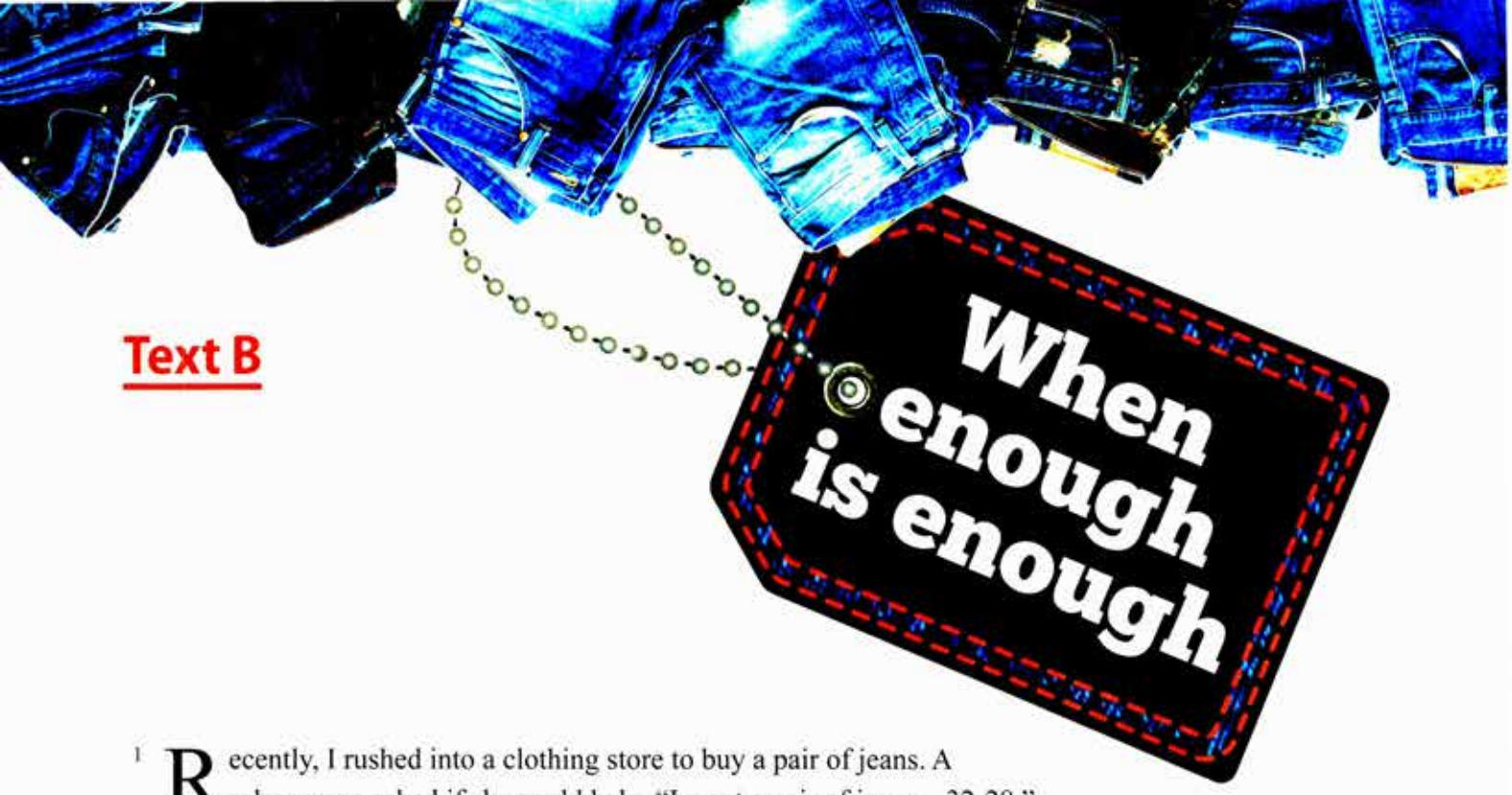
Question: What inference can you make from the question "What would Xiang Yu do?"
Possible answer: The question suggests that Xiang Yu was very intelligent in making difficult choices.

Example 2

Will we have more by always increasing our options or will we have more with fewer, carefully chosen options? What doors should we close in order to allow the right windows of opportunity and happiness to open? (Para. 13)

Question: What can be inferred from the first question?
Possible answer: The question indirectly provides the answer that we will have more with fewer, carefully chosen options.

I Read Text B and answer the questions between the paragraphs using contextual clues, common sense, and your background knowledge. Then compare your answers with a classmate's to see if you understand the author's meaning in the same way.



Text B

1 Recently, I rushed into a clothing store to buy a pair of jeans. A salesperson asked if she could help. "I want a pair of jeans – 32-28," I said in haste.

Q1 Why did the author respond to the salesperson in haste?

2 "Do you want slim fit, easy fit, relaxed fit, baggy, or extra baggy?" she **ventured**. "Do you want stone-washed, **acid**-washed, **button**-fly or regular-fly, faded or regular?"

3 I stopped. I didn't have a **hint**, not the **remotest** idea of what she had asked, so I said, "I just want regular jeans. You know – the kind that used to be the only kind."

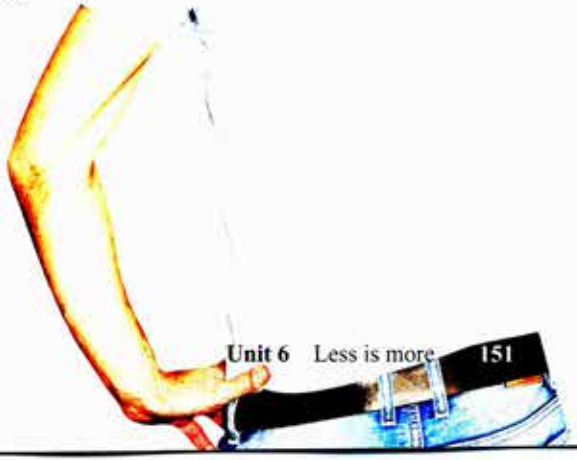


4 She pointed in the right direction. The trouble was, with all those options **distributed** in front of me, I wasn't sure what I wanted. So, I tried on pair after pair of jeans for almost two hours – trying to decide. It wasn't a big decision and little depended on my choice, but I was **convinced** that one pair had to be just right for me.

Q2 What can you infer from these paragraphs about buying jeans?

5 The jeans I chose were fine, but this simple **transaction** provoked a strong reaction in me. Buying a new pair of pants shouldn't **render** someone a **wreck**! Purchasing jeans was once an easy choice; now it's become a complex decision.

Q3 How do you think the author felt about his purchasing experience?



6 Choices in modern life have increased tremendously. A typical store in 1900 had only a few dozen **categories** with one or two options per category. Modern supermarkets have 50,000 to 60,000 items in thousands of categories. Looking for hair-care products? There are more than 350 types of shampoo and conditioners. Need a painkiller? There are almost 100 options. Toothpaste, anyone? You have 40+ types to choose from!

Q4 What does the paragraph intend to tell us?

7 It's true that **enforced** restrictions with very limited or no choices make life dull, and having options does increase our sense of liberation and control. However, my jeans purchase **highlights** a different problem. As options increase out of control, people often begin to feel their life is falling apart. They are overloaded, overwhelmed and feel their life growing **vacant**, without meaning.

Q5 What message does the author want to send out?

8 We all **rely** on common sense to guide us, and the **implication** is that increasing choice should always increase happiness. Surprisingly, the opposite is true. Scientists **verify** that an overabundance of choice tends to bring a **subtraction** in well-being and happiness.

9 The measure of happiness in many countries has been going downhill. Of course, no one believes that a single factor explains this, but accumulating evidence from psychological research **indicates** that the explosion of choices and tremendous increases in material possessions play a primary role.

Q6 What is indirectly said in these two paragraphs?



10 Increasing expectations seem to be part of the problem. The **penetrating** message of modern times seems to be: "The more we control our own fate, the more we expect to control it. The more we have, the more we want to have!" We expect to be able to have a life that is fulfilling, exciting, and prosperous! We **transfer** our high expectations to our **property**, our **residences**, and our families – expecting them to be outstanding and beautiful.

11 Some people believe they should never have to settle for material possessions that are just "good enough". Their trademark is that they expect and accept only the best. Researchers call this group "maximizers". Their thoughts are **dominated** by an ever-increasing desire for more and a focus on the highest quality. Studies show that maximizers are less **optimistic** and more depressed about their lives than others who are willing to settle for slightly less.

12 I have a friend who makes going out to dinner a nightmare. He struggles to select a dish, going in a circular motion between one option and another, trying to find the best option. Some students behave the same way when looking for jobs, as they worry excessively about which job option to choose **lest** they **overlook** the "perfect" job!

Q7 What is the author's point of view implied in these paragraphs?

13 We are told we're in the "driver's seat", when it comes to organizing and planning our lives. If we fail, it's our own fault and we can only **accuse** ourselves. However, it is unhealthy to combine **overwhelming** expectations and options, plus a tendency to blame ourselves for failures.

14 The success of 21st-century life turns out to be a bitter-sweet **controversy** and paradox. People have what they say they want. They're floating in a vast ocean of choices and material goods but finding they're still unfulfilled. Enough is never enough.

Q8 What inference can you draw from these two paragraphs?

15 Let's pause and **angle** a bright light from the past into our modern times. Over 2,000 years ago, the famous Chinese philosopher Laozi **prescribed**, "Be content with **whatsoever** you have; **rejoice** in the way things are. When you realize there is nothing lacking, the whole world belongs to you." And he added this **precaution**: "He who knows that enough is enough will always have enough."

16 Use your college years to stir your heart and renew your life. **Withstand** the pressure of too many choices to acquire more than you need. **Specify** what truly matters to you and what does not. Learn when enough is enough, and you will **trace** a path of contentment throughout your life.

(829 words)

New words

▲ venture /'ventʃə/
vt. say or do sth. in an uncertain way because you are afraid it is wrong or will seem stupid 小心地说；谨慎地做
vi. go somewhere that could be dangerous 冒风险（去某处）

▲ acid /'æsɪd/
n. [C, U] 酸（一种化学物质）
a. having a sharp sour taste 酸的；酸味的

▲ button /'bʌtn/ *n.* [C]
1 a small round object that is used for fastening clothes by pushing it through a hole 纽扣；扣子
2 a small object that you press to make a machine start working or perform a particular action 按钮

▲ hint /hɪnt/
n. [C] sth. that you say or do to suggest sth. to sb., without telling them directly 暗示；提示
v. suggest sth. in an indirect way so that sb. can guess your meaning 暗示；示意

▲ remote /rɪ'məʊt/ *a.*
1 **(not have the ~est idea / interest / intention, etc.)** (*esp. BrE*) used to emphasize that you do not know sth., are not interested in sth., do not intend to do sth., etc. 一无所知 / 毫无兴趣 / 毫无打算等
2 far from towns or other places where people live 偏僻的；偏远的

▲ distribute /dɪ'strɪbjuːt/ *vt.*
1 spread sth. over an area 使分布；散布
2 share things among a group of people, esp. in a planned way（尤指有计划地）分发、分配、发放

▲ convince /kən'vɪns/ *vt.*
1 make sb. feel certain that sth. is true 使确信；使信服
2 persuade sb. to do sth. 说服；劝服

convinced /kən'vɪnst/ *a.* certain that sth. is true 确信的；信服的

▲ transaction /træn'zækʃən/ *n.* (*fml.*)
1 [C] a business deal or action, such as buying or selling sth. 交易；业务；买卖
2 [U] the process of doing business（业务等的）办理、执行

▲ render /'rendə/ *vt.*
1 cause sb. or sth. to be in a particular condition 使成为；使变得；使处于（某种状态）
2 (*fml.*) give sth. to sb. or do sth., because it is your duty or because sb. expects you to 给予；提供

▲ wreck /rek/ *n.* [C]
1 (*infml.*) sb. who looks or feels very ill or tired 病重的人；疲惫不堪的人
2 a vehicle or ship that has been destroyed or badly damaged 严重损毁的交通工具；沉船

▲ category /'kætəgəri/ *n.* [C] a group of people or things that are all of the same type 类别；种类；范畴

▲ enforce /ɪn'fɔːs/ *vt.*
1 make sth. happen or force sb. to do sth. 强迫实行；迫使
2 make people obey a rule or law 执行、实施（法律）

enforced /ɪn'fɔːst/ *a.* happening because of a situation that you cannot control or prevent 被迫的；强制的

▲ highlight /'haɪlaɪt/ *vt.*
1 make a problem or subject easy to notice so that people pay attention to it 突出；强调
2 mark written words with a special colored pen, or in a different color on a computer（用彩笔）标出；（在计算机上用不同颜色）突出显示

▲ vacant /'veɪkənt/ *a.*
1 spent in idleness or inactivity 空虚的

2 not filled or occupied; available to be used 空的；未被占用的

▲ **rely** /rɪˈlaɪ/ *v.* **(~ on / upon)**

1 trust or depend on sb. or sth. to do what you need or expect them to do 信任；信赖

2 depend on sth. in order to continue to live or exist（为生活或生存而）依赖

▲ **implication** /ˌɪmplɪˈkeɪʃən/ *n.* [C, U] a suggestion that is not made directly but that people are expected to understand or accept 含意；暗示

▲ **verify** /ˈverɪfaɪ/ *vt.* (*fml.*)

1 state that sth. is true 证明；证实

2 discover whether sth. is correct or true 核对；核实

▲ **subtraction** /səbˈtrækʃən/ *n.* [C] the process of taking a number or amount from a larger number or amount 减；减法

▲ **indicate** /ˈɪndɪkeɪt/ *vt.*

1 show that a particular situation exists, or that sth. is likely to be true 表明；显示

2 say or do sth. to make your wishes, intentions, etc. clear（说或做某事）表明（意向等）

▲ **penetrate** /ˈpenətreɪt/

vt. (*fml.*) succeed in understanding sth. 洞察；了解

v. enter sth. and pass or spread through it, esp. when this is difficult 进入；渗入；刺入；穿过；穿透

penetrating /ˈpenətreɪtɪŋ/ *a.*

1 showing an ability to understand things quickly and completely 有洞察力的；思维敏锐的

2 **(~ look / eyes / gaze, etc.)** a look, etc. which makes you feel uncomfortable and seems to see inside your mind 锐利的目光 / 眼睛 / 凝视等

▲ **transfer** /trænsˈfɜː/ *vt.*

1 stop giving your time or support to one person or thing and give it to another 转移（时间或支持）

2 move money from one account or institution to another 把（钱）转到另一账户（或机构）上

▲ **property** /ˈprɒpəti/ *n.*

1 [U] the thing or things that sb. owns 所有物；资产；财产

2 [C, U] a building, a piece of land, or both together 房产；地产；房地产

▲ **residence** /ˈrezɪdəns/ *n.*

1 [C] (*fml.*) a house, esp. a large or official one 住宅；住所；（尤指）宅邸，官邸

2 [U] legal permission to live in a country for a certain period of time（在某国的）居住权，居留许可

▲ **dominate** /ˈdɒmɪneɪt/ *v.* control sb. or sth. or have more importance than other people or things 支配；控制；主宰

▲ **optimistic** /ˌɒptəˈmɪstɪk/ *a.* believing that good things will happen in the future 乐观的；乐观主义的

▲ **lest** /lest/ *conj.*

1 used to show that sb. is afraid or worried that a particular thing might happen 唯恐；生怕

2 in order to make sure that sth. will not happen 免得；以免

▲ **overlook** /ˌəʊvəˈlʊk/ *vt.*

1 not notice sth. or not see how important it is 忽视；忽略

2 forgive sb.'s mistake, bad behavior, etc. and take no action 不计较，宽恕（某人的过失、坏行为等）

▲ **accuse** /əˈkjuːz/ *vt.* say that you believe sb. is guilty of a crime or of doing sth. bad 控告；指控；指责

▲ **overwhelming** /ˌəʊvəˈwelmɪŋ/ *a.*

1 very large or greater, more important, etc. than any other 巨大的；压倒性的

2 having such a great effect on you that you feel confused and do not know how to react 难以抗拒的；令人不知所措的

▲ **controversy** /ˈkɒntrəvɜːsi/ *n.* [C, U] a serious argument about sth. that involves many people and continues for a long time（涉及很多人且历时很久的）争论，辩论；争议

▲ **angle** /ˈæŋgəl/ *vt.*

1 make sth. point in a particular direction, esp. one that is not directly in front of you 使…指向一定的角度

2 present information from a particular point of view or for a specific group of people 从（某个角度）报道；为（某一群体）提供信息

▲ **prescribe** /prɪˈskraɪb/ *vt.*

1 (*fml.*) state officially what should be done in a particular situation 规定；指定

2 say what medicine or treatment a sick person should have 开（药）；给…开处方

▲ **whatsoever** /ˌwɒtsəʊˈevə/

pron. (*very fml.*) whatever 任何事物；无论什么

ad. used to emphasize a negative statement 丝毫，任何（用于强调否定句）

rejoice /rɪˈdʒɔɪs/ *vi.* feel or show that you are very happy 喜悦；欣喜

▲ **precaution** /prɪˈkɔːʃən/ *n.* [C] sth. done to protect people or things against possible harm or trouble 预防；防备；警惕

▲ **withstand** /wɪðˈstænd/ *vt.* **(withstood, withstood)** be strong enough not to be harmed or destroyed by sth. 承受住；顶住；抵住

▲ **specify** /ˈspesɪfaɪ/ *vt.* state sth. in an exact and detailed way 具体指明；明确说明；详述

▲ **trace** /treɪs/ *vt.*

1 follow the footprints, track, or trail of sth. 追寻；追踪

2 find the origins of when sth. began or where it came from 追溯；追查

Phrases and expressions

rush into hurry into; move or go into some place very quickly 冲进；奔进

in haste (*fml.*) quickly or in a hurry 匆忙地；急忙地

try sth. on put on a piece of clothing to see if it fits you or if it suits you, esp. in a shop（尤在商店里）试穿，试戴

be / get / run, etc. out of control be or become impossible to manage or control 失去控制；无法管理

fall apart have so many problems that it is no longer possible to exist or function 破裂；崩溃

go downhill gradually become worse 走下坡路；每况愈下

settle for accept sth. even though it is not the best, or not what you really want 勉强接受；将就

be depressed about feel unhappy about sth. 对…感到沮丧

struggle to do sth. try extremely hard to achieve sth. 努力做；奋力做

Proper names

Laozi 老子（春秋时思想家、道家学派的创始人）

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

2 Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1 Why did the author try on pair after pair of jeans for almost two hours?
- A He wanted to buy several pairs.
- B He enjoyed trying on a few pairs before buying one.
- C He had a difficult time deciding which pair he should buy.
- D He just wanted to find out more about different types of jeans.

2 What does the author's experience of purchasing jeans tell us?
- A Store shopping is usually more tiring.
- B Store shopping is preferred by people.
- C Too many choices cause more trouble.
- D Too many choices are more convenient.

3 How do people feel about the increasing number of options?
- A They are happy with more options.
- B They think it's still too difficult to follow the trend.
- C They get an increased sense of liberation and control.
- D They start to see their life as empty and meaningless.

4 What do people assume when they use their common sense, according to Para. 8?
- A More choices bring more happiness.
- B More choices bring more opportunities.
- C Increasing choices decrease happiness.
- D Increasing choices decrease greed for more.

5 What's the main reason for the decrease of happiness in many countries?
- A The limited choice and the downturn of the economy.
- B The unlimited options that people can easily choose from.
- C Increasing expectations people have for material possessions.
- D The unlimited choices and the increase in material possessions.

6 What is the author's message in Para. 10?
- A People have become greedier.
- B People who want more end up with less.
- C There is a limit to people's material desires.
- D There is no end to pursuing a fulfilling life.

7 How come "maximizers" are depressed about their lives?
- A They don't want things which are just good enough.
- B They feel too good about themselves.
- C They care too much about other people.
- D They only want to be slightly better.

8 Why does the success of 21st-century life turn out to be a paradox?
- A People think that enough is never enough.
- B People feel happy with their limited possession.
- C People know that more money means less happiness.
- D People have more choices than before but feel unhappier.

Critical thinking

3 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Why do you think people feel unhappy when given too many options?
2 Why does the author say "Enough is never enough" for some people?
3 Do you think modern life provides more convenience? Why or why not?
4 In your opinion, what kind of life is fulfilling and prosperous?

Collocation

More language exercises

College students often have difficulties making decisions. Because of their ***increasing expectations*** (Text B) and ***strong reaction*** (Text B) to their seemingly vanishing opportunities, they are sometimes ***predictably irrational*** (Text A), afraid opportunities may ***slip away*** (Text A). It's true that many times they have to make a ***complex decision*** (Text B) and ***painful choice*** (Text A) from ***rival options*** (Text A) or ***multiple options*** (Text A). However, ***accumulating evidence*** (Text B) shows, based on their ***carefully chosen*** (Text A) options, that students seem to be ***naturally prejudiced*** (Text A) to believe more is better. What can they do to ***restore the balance*** (Text A) in their lives?

Warm-up: According to the collocations from the texts, match the words in Column A with the ones in Column B.

Column A	Column B
conscious	choice
winning	pain
limited	effort
remotest	role
temporary	strategy
primary	idea

4 Read the panel presentation on decision-making. Fill in the blanks with appropriate collocations from the texts, using the words in brackets as clues.

In my opinion, making a decision implies that there are several options for us to think about. Sometimes, we have to choose from 1) _____ (*competitive choices*), and in such a case we want not only to identify as many of these 2) _____ (*unpleasant choices*) as possible, but also to choose the one that has the highest probability of success. To achieve this goal, every 3) _____ (*cautiously selected*) decision must be made in the light of a preset standard. Also, "Do it" and "Don't do it" do not qualify as 4) _____ (*a set of choices*). Only "Do this" and "Do something else" really qualify.

— *Steven*

Theoretically, the 5) _____ (*successful method*) of decision-making is to sufficiently reduce uncertainty to allow a reasonable choice to be made. However, many of us are 6) _____ (*expectedly unreasonable*). We can't bear to let any opportunities vanish nor can we even stand the 7) _____ (*momentary suffering*). We have a tendency to seek more information than required to make a(n) 8) _____ (*complicated decision*). However, when too much information is sought and obtained, rather than 9) _____ (*restricted options*), several problems can arise.

— *Judy*

That's absolutely true. For example, when so much information is available, our decision-making ability actually declines because the information can no longer be managed even with 10) _____ (*intended effort*). A major problem caused by information overload is forgetfulness. We are 11) _____ (*born prejudiced*) to believe that more is better. However, when too much information is packed into our memory, especially in a short period of time, some of the information that was received earlier will be pushed out. Therefore, 12) _____ (*increasing proof*) shows that more is not necessarily better.

— *Jason*

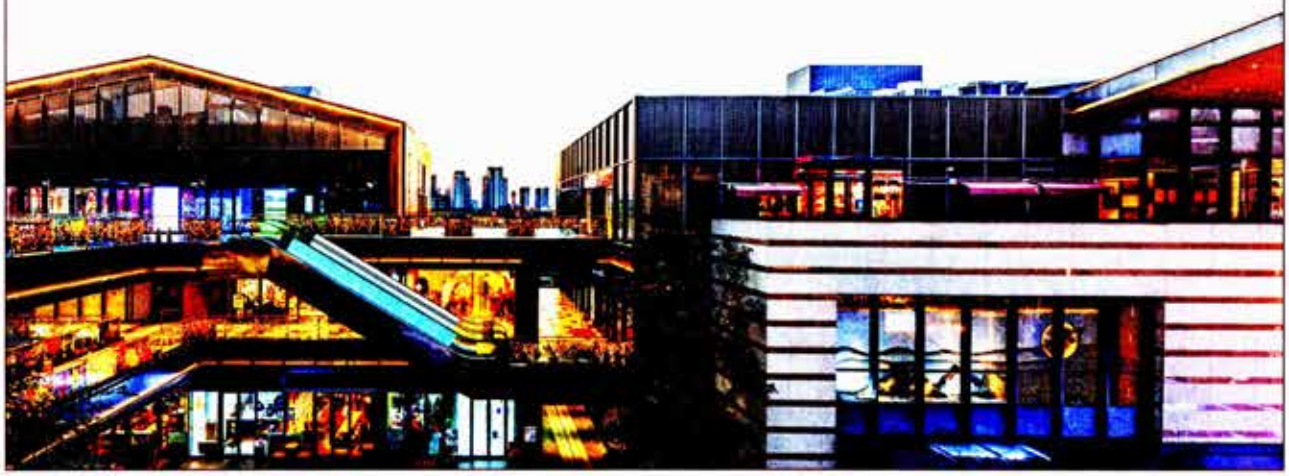
Stories of China



China is in for a mall (购物中心) boom. With the rise of online shopping, some big companies are moving fast into offline spaces to help remake traditional retailing (零售). They believe there is still plenty of room for malls to gain customers, especially in second- and third-tier cities. But most importantly, companies need to be innovative and provide customers more than just shopping.

This is exactly what some Chinese tech companies are doing. They have reportedly been building their own offline stores as they seek to enrich the real-world shopping experience with technology and convenience. These offline stores have made their offline and online shopping experience as smooth as possible. Whenever customers shop at a store, the store keeps their information and then offers them the option to get the same products delivered to their doorstep in the future. This way, these companies smoothly connect both businesses.

Other e-commerce companies operate their businesses very creatively. For example, some



fresh-food supermarkets allow customers not only to buy products but also to get them cooked on the spot. Usually, about 75 percent of the products in these supermarkets are fresh food, and most can be bought online via a specific mobile app and delivered within a short time. Some supermarkets even support payment via facial recognition. Offline fresh-food supermarkets are popular among e-commerce businesses, who can easily handle the changing domestic retail industry by blending online and offline shopping.

Besides, companies are using different tools to attract and retain customers. For example, shoppers can try on clothes and cosmetics (化妆品), get discounts on items they searched online, and receive store discount information and store location on their mobile phones.

These shopping malls also offer customers a wonderful experience by expanding their kids' section and entertainment options.

While online shopping is popular and consumers become more critical, these steps show that businesses are not afraid to encourage innovation and tryout. Therefore, malls that offer more than just shopping will have a better future; malls that fail to progress, however, will fade away.

Exercises

Translation

Translate the following sentences into English.

1 国民幸福指数（Gross National Happiness Index）用以衡量人们的幸福感，还能反映一个国家或地区的经济发展水平和居民生活水平。

2 随着中国经济的高速增长，中国政府越来越重视人民群众的生活质量和国民幸福指数。

3 不断改善人民群众的生活条件，让他们得到更多实惠，将促进国民幸福指数不断提升。

Unit project

Performing a short play: What should we strive for in our life?

Have you ever thought about what's worth our efforts to strive for in our life? Surely, people have different life goals to achieve. Some want to be rich, but chasing wealth for the sake of wealth is likely to get people emotionally bankrupt. To some other people, a dream is more important than wealth because when they accomplish their dream, they get personal satisfaction.

In this unit, each group will perform a short play on the topic of what we should strive for in our life. You will act out a particular role to tell the class what decision you've made and why you have made that decision.

Step 1 **Work in groups and make up a real-life situation for your short play.**
Decide on a real-life setting, such as a get-together at a coffee shop with your friends. Make sure your play is entertaining and lively.

Step 2 **Assign everyone a particular role in that situation.**
Think about any role you would like to play, such as a school teacher teaching a group of students in some remote mountains, or a medical worker taking care of patients in ICU.

Step 3 **Spend 4-5 minutes brainstorming what you want to say on the "stage" – the plot.**
Don't forget to identify yourself first, and then go on with your decision and the reasons for your decision. To illustrate, please see the following talk:

Since I'm a school teacher, what I often think about is how I can better share my knowledge with students and how I can help students maximize their learning. I could have been teaching in a big city, but I decided to teach in a remote area. Some people, including my relatives and friends, didn't understand why I made this seemingly irrational decision. Some even considered my decision silly. However, to me, I made the right choice. The reason is very simple: It's my aspiration. I feel good when chasing my dream and doing what I'm passionate about.

Step 4 **Share with others in your group what you will say.**
After getting the feedback from your group, you may revise the plot. Remember, it's a good chance for you to practice writing and improve your critical thinking skills.

Step 5 **Rehearse 2-3 times in the group and then act out your short play in front of the class.**
It's better for you to remember the lines, but in case you forget what you've prepared, you can always make it up on spot.